

FRIDAY, JULY 3, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

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Happening today

● **LOK SABHA** Speaker Om Birla will inaugurate a two-day orientation programme for the newly elected members of the West Bengal Assembly.

● **MINISTER OF** State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita and Bihar Governor Syed Ata Hasnain will travel to Iran to represent India at the state funeral for Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



NATION

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MUMBAI: MAN DIES AFTER FALLING INTO MANHOLE; CIVIC BODY SUSPENDS 4 OFFICIALS

WORRY OVER USERS ACCESSING BLOCKED SITES

Govt looks at stricter rules for VPN providers: Office in India, appoint compliance officials

Soumyarendra Barik

New Delhi, July 2

THE CENTRE is working on an expansive legal framework to curtail virtual private network (VPN) providers that could require them to establish a local India presence and appoint key personnel to serve as a liaison with the government, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

This comes after a controversial directive in 2022 by the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (Cert-In) which required VPN service providers to store a vast amount of customer data, including their names, email IDs, contact numbers and IP addresses.

However, a new legal framework is now being seen as necessary due to an implicit acknowledgement that the 2022 directives may not have been able to yield satisfactory results. The primary concern that the

E. EXPLAINED

Why VPN?

VPN services allow users to mask their IP addresses and browse the Internet via servers located elsewhere. So, users can browse the web anonymously and also visit content that has been blocked in India by using a VPN server located outside the country.

government has is that VPNs are being increasingly used by people to get around the blocking of apps and online content.

The new framework could require VPN operators to establish offices in India and hire compliance officers who can address grievances raised by

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EXPRESS special

‘We are helpless’: In Morbi, BJP minister’s brothers join protest over compensation for land lost to Adani power transmission infra

Farmers on indefinite hunger strike in Patidar heartland, 35 panchayat heads support protest; Govt says ‘continuous discussions’ on, ‘good decision’ soon

Ritu Sharma

Jetpar (Morbi), July 2

IN BURNING 40-degree heat, about a hundred individuals, half of them women, sit under a *shamiana*. At the *dayro*, or local folk gathering, there is music and horse parades, snapshots of the culture of Gujarat’s Zalavad region, of which Morbi and Surendranagar are part.

The people in the gathering have come together to protest. Some of the men have tonsured heads. A small but growing number of protesters have been on a hunger strike since June 17; some have needed medical attention.

The majority of the protesters are Patidar farmers — and they want higher compensation for the use of their land



Bharatbhai Amrutiya (in white) and Rakeshbhai Shival Amrutiya (in black), brothers of Gujarat Minister Kantilal Amrutiya, at the protest site in Morbi’s Jetpar village. RITU SHARMA

for high-voltage transmission infrastructure for power from the Khavda Renewable Energy Zone in Kutch district.

The towers for the high-tension power transmission cables are being installed by

Halvad Transmission Ltd, a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) of Adani Energy Solutions Ltd (AESL), the country’s largest private-sector power transmission and distribution company.

Protests against the high-

tension transmission line and towers began at several places in the state on June 9, and were concentrated in Morbi district, where farmers claim they are the “worst affected” by the project.

On June 15, the Gujarat Congress launched a statewide protest rally in Gandhinagar, and one of the party’s demands was aligned with the agitation in Morbi. A good number of Morbi farmers have been seen in the rally that is currently progressing through other districts.

The ruling BJP is yet to engage seriously with the protesters, but it has remained careful to not be seen as being against them. Morbi, the Patidar-dominated epicenter of the agitation, has historically

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MOVE TO DEEPEN MARITIME, DEFENCE COOPERATION IN THE INDO-PACIFIC

Modi flags trust amid turmoil, Takaichi underlines: ‘Build ties as brother, sister’



PM Narendra Modi with his Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi at Rashtrapati Bhavan, Thursday. RENUKA PURI

Economic security, energy resilience as pillars, India and Japan unveil raft of measures to deepen bilateral relations

Divya A & Deeptiman Tiwary

New Delhi, July 2

POSITIONING ECONOMIC security and energy resilience as the defining pillars of the next phase of their bilateral ties, India and Japan Thursday unveiled a raft of initiatives in this direction amid shifting geopolitics and global energy disruptions owing to the West Asia crisis.

These include a joint roadmap on economic security, a new framework on mobility, and an artificial intelligence (AI) partnership.

“In the environment of global turbulence today, mutual trust is our biggest strategic

asset,” Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in his joint media statement alongside visiting Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi.

Takaichi linked the new initiatives to the changing geopolitical environment, saying both countries faced challenges arising from “economic weaponisation and non-market practices” and needed to urgently build resilient critical mineral supply chains.

Addressing Takaichi as his younger sister, and welcoming her on her first visit to India as Prime Minister, Modi said, “The economies of India and Japan are complementary. From cul-

tural values to modern technology, there is similarity in our thinking and approach as well.”

“And above all, the foundation of our relations rests on unbreakable mutual trust,” he said, reflecting the growing convergence between the two countries.

Takaichi said that both leaders were on the same page to develop this relationship as brother and sister. She also noted that in the area of energy security impacted by the West Asia situation, both Japan and India bear the responsibility to provide for region-wide energy security.

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From strategic stockpiling to AI ecosystem, roadmap is rolled out

Divya A

New Delhi, July 2

IN THE wake of global energy supply disruptions, India and Japan Thursday came out with a joint statement on energy resilience during the visit of Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi, expressing their shared intention to work together as responsible powers and major energy-consuming countries in Asia.

The two sides also advanced cooperation “to enhance the resilience and competitiveness of

EXPLAINED

HOW INDIA AND JAPAN CAN DEEPEN THEIR BUSINESS TIES

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both countries in the field of AI”. The aim is to bring about innovation and growth in both countries, in order to build a safe, secure, trustworthy, inclusive, human-centric, sustainable, accountable, and in-

novation-oriented AI ecosystem, the joint statement on AI said.

Towards energy resilience, both sides highlighted the importance of regional initiatives to strengthen energy resilience, such as India’s support for energy security in South Asia and Japan’s Partnership On Wide Energy and Resources Resilience (POWER Asia).

Following discussions between Modi and Takaichi, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and the Japanese

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Ram temple footage shows five of eight held removing and hiding cash bundles

Agency claims it had no say in hiring counting staff, names came from bank



Faizabad Bar Association lawyers demand FIR against Trust general secretary Champat Rai, member Anil Mishra and official Gopal Rao at Ram Janmabhoomi Police Station in Ayodhya, Thursday. PTI

Deeptiman Tiwary

New Delhi, July 2

EXPLAINED

HOW TEMPLES DEAL WITH DONATIONS

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CLOSED-CIRCUIT television footage recovered from the Ram temple in Ayodhya shows at least five of the eight men arrested for the alleged theft of donated funds removing and hiding cash during the counting process.

Sources in Ayodhya police said thorough scanning of 45 days of footage from the temple’s Pilgrim Facility Centre showed five counting personnel removing bundles of notes and hiding them in their clothes or socks.

Meanwhile, the agency through which the counting personnel were hired has claimed

that it did not scout for the men, and that these names were recommended for appointment by the State Bank of India where the donated money was deposited. Sources said police have already searched premises linked to the accused seen removing donation money and recovered cash. Police have so far recovered nearly Rs 80 lakh.

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POLITICS

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TRINAMOL REBELS MEET EC, POLL PANEL SEEKS RESPONSES OF BOTH SIDES

Bombay HC: Why can’t citizens protest Govt decisions... being made slaves by slapping cases

Justice Jamdar sets aside externment order, says police are public servants

Omkar Gokhale

Mumbai, July 2

SETTING ASIDE A Mumbai Police externment order against a political activist, the Bombay High Court Thursday observed that merely arranging a morcha or a protest against “certain decisions” of the BJP-led government at the Centre could not be a ground for externment, affecting the person’s fundamental rights.

Referring to a plea by 49-year-old Saeed Ahmad Abdul Wahid Chaudhary, who said he was general secretary of the So-



Justice Madhav J Jamdar of the Bombay High Court

cialist Democratic Party of India (SDPI) and had been externed for a year, the single-judge bench of Justice Madhav J Jamdar asked police if citizens were

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● 38-YEAR-OLD BABITA DHAKAD, WHO WAS IN TOUCH WITH JeM OPERATIVES, DEVELOPED AN EMOTIONAL CONNECTION WITH THE IDEOLOGY... HAVING BEEN DISILLUSIONED WITH SOCIETY: INVESTIGATORS

‘Curious’ to ‘Jaish link’: Behind the arrest of Jaipur woman with a secret online life

Hamza Khan

Jaipur, July 2

THE CASE of a Jaipur woman allegedly establishing contact with the top leadership of the banned Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) has left investigators searching for answers — not just about the alleged links, but also about how an ordinary resident of the city’s outskirts ended up in conversations with one of the most wanted terror networks.

In the narrow lanes of a recently developed residential colony off Tonk Road in Jaipur, neighbours describe Babita Dhakad, 38, as a quiet woman

whom they rarely spotted outside the home. And when they did, there was nothing out of the ordinary about her. But then, her alleged online journey into extremist circles remained invisible even to those immediately around her: her family had no idea about the late-night conversations that investigators now say became

the foundation of a probe into her alleged links with JeM. On June 22, Rajasthan’s Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) arrested her under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

According to investigators, Babita’s purported disillusion-

ment with life and society at large may have led her to establish such contacts. She had gotten married in 2017, but the marriage barely lasted a month. Having completed a computer course in the same year, she used to spend a lot of time on the internet, they say.

Over a year ago, she started interacting with “jihadi and anti-national” social media pages, handles and profiles, which, officials say, was simply “borne out of curiosity.”

“She used to watch their videos and found them to be brave and charismatic,” an official told *The Indian Express*.

However, as she allegedly started going deeper and



Babita Dhakad was arrested by Rajasthan’s ATS under UAPA on June 22.

deeper into the ideology, she liked and interacted with the social media pages associated

with JeM, Pakistan’s Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI), and Tehrik-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), among others, “especially liking the pages with guns as the profile picture”, an officer said.

“She had joined over 300 such groups on social media. From there, she exchanged numbers and also started chatting with some of the persons behind these groups on WhatsApp and Facebook Messenger,” the officer said, adding that contacts from Pakistan and Afghanistan were allegedly found on her phone.

Online ‘friendships’

“Essentially, she was lured by

a person who kept praising her beauty, her eyes, etc. As conversations went long into the night, she grew close and eventually wanted to get married to the person who identified himself as Abu Ubaidah, a close associate of JeM founder and leader Masood Azhar,” the officer said.

Another person she had allegedly been in touch with someone claiming to be Yusuf Azhar, alias Mohammed Salim, Masood Azhar’s brother-in-law, the officer added. However, as per Indian security agencies, Yusuf was killed in the strikes carried out on May 7 last year, as part of Operation Sindoor in the aftermath of the terror attack in Pahalgam that took

place on April 22.

“During their video calls, Ubaidah used to keep his face covered, saying he can’t reveal his face for safety reasons. As she wanted to get married to him, a ‘ceremony’ was arranged with a Muslim cleric where she was asked to recite a *kalma* for conversion, and she was given an Islamic name, Khadija. She was also taught about namaz,” the officer said.

Investigators said she “developed an emotional connection with the ideology... having been left out and disillusioned with her own society”. For example, they said one of the pages she had liked was ‘*Duniya Dhokebaaz*’ (world is de-

ceitful). And through the chats, she allegedly found validation from persons she considered “brave warriors”, they said.

She perhaps “thought that she would have a better life in Pakistan and wanted to travel there too”, the officer said. She had completed her BA, but didn’t have a job. Moreover, her divorce case and a case of dowry harassment were also pending. She had been living with her parents ever since her separation.

Subsequently, she was told that she could be brought to Pakistan via the Nepal-Saudi Arabia-UAE route. However, when she told them she didn’t

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Cow slaughter ban order: Tamil Nadu govt moves SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

THE TAMIL Nadu government has moved the Supreme Court challenging a Madras High Court order directing it to ensure that no cow is slaughtered in the state.

The plea, filed on June 9 through the state's counsel, Jayasree Narasimhan, said the May 27 high court order has imposed a blanket ban on cow slaughter even in the designated slaughterhouses, and this is unsustainable in law. The state said the original plea only raised the question of whether cows and calves could be sacrificed in places not designated as slaughterhouses on the occasion of Bakri Eid, but a division bench of the high court went further and ordered an absolute and blanket ban.

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government contended that the high court order goes against the provisions of the Tamil Nadu Animal Preservation Act, 1958, which allows the slaughter of cows aged over 10 years if a competent authority declares them unfit for work and breeding.

The state also argued that even legislations such as the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960, the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Slaughter House) Rules, 2001, the Tamil Nadu Urban Local Bodies Act, 1998 and the Tamil Nadu Urban Local Bodies Rules, 2023, do not impose any total ban on slaughter but only prescribe conditions for it.

The high court's action, it argued, amounts to judicial law-making. The appeal also contested the HC's conclusion that the relevant authorities had conceded the veracity of the averments in the petitioner's affidavit filed in support of his writ petition. It said the state's stand was that it had already taken necessary action to prevent slaughter in public places and that any sacrifice would be allowed only in confined spaces, away from the public.

Coimbatore resident K Surya Prasanth had approached the high court alleging that authorities had made arrangements for the ritual sacrifice in areas not designated as slaughterhouses. Though he submitted a representation to the authorities, it was not considered, following which he moved the high court.

In its counter-affidavit before the HC, the state police had said that officials visited the scene and inspected the place designated for cow slaughter. The authorities concerned had erected a temporary shed for conducting the slaughter in a non-public area, without causing any obstruction to traffic or offending the religious sentiments of persons belonging to other communities, the counter-affidavit added.

In its judgment, the high court bench of Justices G R Swaminthan and V Lakshminarayanan cited Article 48 of the Constitution of India, saying that it mandated that the State shall take steps to prohibit the slaughter of cows and calves and other milch and draught cattle.

'Floating' exam papers: Bihar officials deny negligence, blame rain

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, July 2

AFTER A viral video purportedly showed bundles of examination papers floating in Bihar's Buxar district, the district education department claimed the footage was recorded while the papers were being distributed amid sudden rainfall. It dismissed social media claims of negligence, saying the quarterly examinations were conducted as scheduled.

The video showed bundles of exam papers inside a water-logged premises, with people trying to remove them. Several social media posts claimed the footage showed Class 9, 10 and 12 question papers floating in water in Buxar.

The incident came amid reports of question paper leaks in various examinations, fuelling concerns over negligence.

While acknowledging that the bundles seen in the video were question papers and answer sheets being distributed to schools, the district education department on Thursday said reports by several news channels, portals and social media platforms linking the visuals to negligence in the district's education system were "completely baseless and misleading".

"The claim that sealed bundles of quarterly examination question papers and

answer sheets for Classes 9, 10 and 12 were found floating in rainwater is factually incorrect," an officer said. The department added that the examination material remained "completely safe" and that the examinations were conducted smoothly according to schedule.

Explaining the sequence of events, the department said question papers and answer booklets for the July 2026 quarterly examinations had reached the district by June 27. "Because MP High School in Buxar had been designated as a centre for the police constable recruitment examination on June 28, the examination material was shifted and stored securely in the building of Rajkiya Buniyadi Vidyalaya, Buxar, as a precautionary measure," the official said, adding that schools across the district began collecting question papers and answer sheets on June 30.

"During the distribution process, packets meant for different schools were being sorted and loaded into vehicles for transportation when heavy rain began unexpectedly."

The district education department said the visuals were recorded during this distribution process after it started raining, and were alleged circulated by "anti-social elements" to defame the department and spread false rumours by portraying negligence.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Modi and Takaichi

"You called me a beautiful younger sister, Prime Minister Modi. But at the small meeting before the big meeting, we confirmed that we are on the same page and develop this relationship as brother and sister," she said.

"Japan and India must leverage our respective strengths to become stronger and more prosperous together in the midst of international affairs in disarray. The establishment of such an inter-complementary cooperative relationship has become ever more important," she said.

The two sides also moved to deepen maritime and defence cooperation in the Indo-Pacific with plans for more naval exercises, defence technology collaboration, and an early convening of the India-Japan 2+2 ministerial dialogue.

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0f>

Stressing that "economic security is shared security and energy transition is shared opportunity", Modi said India and Japan had prepared a joint roadmap to strengthen supply chain resilience in semiconductors, quantum technologies, and advanced materials. He said the two countries had also launched an initiative to build 1,000 biogas and organic fertiliser plants in India, complementing the Centre's GOBARdhan programme, besides expanding cooperation in batteries, green hydrogen and nuclear energy.

"As both countries face challenges such as economic weaponisation and non-market practices, we need to urgently build resilience in our critical minerals supply chains," Takaichi said, announcing the move that is aimed at tackling China's monopoly on critical minerals.

Jaipur woman

have a visa or even a passport, and that it would require money as well. "They told her they would send her money through crypto. The plan was to arrange for illegal travel," an investigator said. However, police said no such monetary exchange had taken place before her arrest.

ATSP Manish Tripathi had said at the time of her arrest that her "suspicious" activities on social media had drawn police's attention, and when they looked deeper, they found that she was allegedly carrying out "anti-national" activities online.

Officials now say that while they had been tracking her online activities, key evidence in the case was established when it was found she was in contact with some phone numbers that had been linked to a "sensitive" FIR registered in J&K in 2016.

The case against Babita has been lodged under UAPA sections 38 (offence relating to membership of a terrorist organisation) and 39 (offence relating to support given to a terrorist organisation), as well as BNS section 238, which deals with causing the disappearance of evidence.

Investigators say she had not been given a "task" yet, and had not shared any confidential information either, having been caught in primary stage of the operation. However, Babita had allegedly also purchased some SIM cards, which were being used by others for WhatsApp.

Investigators described her as "ultra radicalised" and "a big potential threat". Her neighbours say on the few occasions they saw her, their interactions were limited. As for her parents, police say they had no clue about her late-night chat or video calls. SP Tripathi said, "Investigation revealed she was in touch with certain foreign nationals who work towards hurting India's sovereignty. They were seeking to gain information through her to spread terrorism in India."

Morbi protest

played a key role in both regional elections and national political movements.

Sixty-five-year-old Ramjibhai Nanjibhai Bhadja says almost 70% of his 12-bigha landholding in Jetpar village of Morbi district will be used for a transmission tower and cables. His land lies next to the state highway that runs north into Kutch, and is currently valued at almost Rs 40 lakh per bigha. Once the power infrastructure comes up, he expects its value to crash.

While farmers like Ramjibhai will not lose possession of their lands, they expect the construction will make it impossible to cultivate – and unattractive to buyers. And the compensation they are being offered for this loss is a pittance, they say – for his 8.3 bigha, he will get only about Rs 30 lakh, Ramjibhai told *The Indian Express*.

"We are sitting on a hunger strike out of helplessness," said Ramjibhai's older son Amitbhai. "The state government is paying no attention to our demands. Several farmers including young children and women have been detained at protest sites over the past few days," Amitbhai said.

Morbi district SP M N Patel said the farmers had not taken permission for the protest, yet police had been going easy on them since "it's a sensitive issue". "Some farmers were de-

Roadmap rolled out

Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry will cooperate on the strategic stockpiling ecosystem.

"Cooperation will focus on mechanisms related to national stockpiling systems and reserves, including industry stockpiles; and coordination regarding arrangements with producing countries, besides emergency response and market stabilisation," said a statement by the MEA.

The two sides reaffirmed the importance of cooperation to address shared challenges of energy availability and affordability, through supply assurance, enhancing resilience and creating mechanisms to mitigate volatility, thereby strengthening the voice of oil and gas-consuming countries, the MEA said.

The joint statement on energy resilience also highlighted the importance of resilient, self-reliant, and efficient maritime transport of oil and gas as a critical pillar of energy security for both countries.

New Delhi and Tokyo will also hold discussions under the India-Japan Joint Working

group on critical minerals.

She also referred to disruptions in global energy markets arising from the situation in West Asia and announced the launch of a bilateral dialogue to strengthen India's petroleum stockpiling system. Japan, she said, would continue to support India's bid for membership of the International Energy Agency.

On the joint roadmap for economic security, Modi said, "Through this, we will strengthen supply chain resilience in strategic areas such as semiconductors, quantum, and advanced materials."

According to the Ministry of External Affairs, the talks delivered concrete progress on key priorities. Both sides adopted three landmark documents: Joint Declaration on Economic Security, Joint Statement on Cooperation in the field of Artificial Intelligence, Joint Statement on Energy Resilience.

Takaichi also noted the

alignment between India's MAHASAGAR policy and Japan's vision of a free and open Indo Pacific. "Prime Minister Modi positions the ocean as a shared space that supports regional stability and growth and is promoting the MAHASAGAR Initiative for countries across the Indian Ocean to defend their sovereignty and the sea through their own efforts; this is perfectly aligned with FOIP (Free and Open Indo Pacific policy)," she said, referring to the vision first mooted by the late Japanese Prime Minister Shinzo Abe in 2016.

"We agreed to deepen the strategic cooperation between Japan and India to achieve such common goals. Expansion of maritime security cooperation is especially important for regional peace and stability," she said, adding that Japan and India must leverage their respective strengths to become stronger and more prosperous together.

ment, and to improve public services delivery, the MEA said.

Meanwhile, in the economic sector, India and Japan aimed to deepen their trade and strategic partnership by setting a target of mobilising 10 trillion yen in Japanese investment into India over the next decade.

Modi said the investment partnership was gaining momentum, with 120 new business agreements signed over the past year and Japanese investments worth around \$10 billion committed to India.

Takaichi said that cooperation between the two countries included co-creation of economic growth of both India and Japan through investment and innovation collaboration.

"This is economic growth. I am committed to realising a strong economy and aiming to enhance Japan's supply capability and technological capabilities through investment in 17 strategic areas. PM Modi launched Viksit Bharat, a national goal to become a developed nation by 2047 and is strongly driving India's growth. In this way, we share the goal of making our countries strong and prosperous through investments in the future," she said.

murdabad'... Why can't citizens raise such slogans and why extermination orders for such slogans?" Justice Jamdar said.

Cautioning the police, he said they were servants of the public and not that of top government functionaries.

Petitioner Chaudhary had challenged the December 3, 2025 extermination order of Deputy Commissioner of Police (Zone 6-Chembur area). He had been externed for a year.

Chaudhary's plea claimed that the extermination proceedings began with a show cause notice in October 2025 on the basis of multiple FIRs registered against him between 2019 and 2024 relating to protests.

Advocates Payoshi Roy and Ibraheem Harbat, appearing for Chaudhary, had submitted that all the FIRs were registered against the petitioner under IPC

Section 188 (disobedience to order duly promulgated by public servant) for protests he organised or participated in including those related to the government's decisions on the CAA and NRC, the issue of the Babri Masjid, and the sealing at the Gyanvapi mosque. Roy said Chaudhary was externed for organising or participating in protests without giving him an opportunity to prove himself innocent.

In his order, Justice Jamdar described the Mumbai Police action as "mala fide" and observed that "citizens have freedom to express their opinion" and "live with dignity" as per Articles 19 and 21 of the Constitution. Setting aside the extermination order, he said the action against the petitioner for "merely opposing certain decisions" of the Central government "affects his fundamental rights".

best to resolve the issue. But it seems there is no interest from the higher-ups [in the government]," Rakeshbhai said. "Both of us (Kantilal and Rakeshbhai) are hurt. I am a farmer and it is my duty to support the farmers. I have no political aspirations," Rakeshbhai said.

Bharatbhai added: "The transmission line is not affecting my farmland. But I am here to support the farmers who have barely 3-4 bigha of land and families and small children to feed."

Sarpanches of more than 35 villages in Morbi district have expressed solidarity with the protesters. "This (Tuesday) is the second time we have come to Jetpar in support of the farmers. If required we will come again," Ravirajsinh Parmar, Sarpanch of Nichi Mandal village and president of the Morbi District Sarpanch Association, said.

The farmers have put forth a list of six demands, including compensation for land at the rate of 400% of the market price – on the lines of what Rajasthan has offered to its farmers – and not as per the jantri (circle) rates decided by the state government.

"The guidelines in the (central) government circular of June 14, 2024 states that the Market Rate Committee (MRC), which determines land compensation value for building power transmission corridors, will fix 200% of the market price for the tower area. However, since it is a high-voltage line, the

Rajasthan government in such a case offers an additional 200%... So we have also requested for 400% of the market price, not the jantri rate," Nehulkumar Dhirajlal Amrutia (31), one of the nine farmers on a hunger strike since June 17, said.

Morbi District Collector Swapnil Khare, who is chair of the District Level Valuation Committee (DLVC), told *The Indian Express*, "The government had invited the farmers for talks on June 28, stating that all the demands are under consideration and things could only be resolved through dialogue. But there has been no response from them."

The protesting farmers are, however, insisting the government begin by accepting all their demands. "There is no clarity from the state government and we are afraid to believe them. So we requested, first give us in writing that these six demands have been accepted," said Nishleshbhai Erwadiya, a farmer from Tikar village, 35 km from Jetpar. Erwadiya said he was taken to hospital and admitted to ICU for two days after he lost 16 kg while on hunger strike.

The strike started as a symbolic fast by 50 men and 100 women on June 9, but hardened into an indefinite hunger strike on June 17 after several conflicts with the local police. Around 15 farmers tortured their heads on June 19.

Crowds at the Upwas Chhavi surge every evening, there are chants of "Kisan Zinda

Ram temple

Police registered an FIR on June 25 on a complaint by the Shri Ram Jambhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust and arrested eight men: Avinash Shukla, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav and Subhash Srivastav.

Tinnu Yadav is Trust general secretary Champat Rai's former driver. Manish Yadav is Tinnu's nephew. Sources said cash was recovered from premises linked to Anukalp Mishra, Luvkush Mishra, Avinash Shukla and Manish Yadav.

Sources said the Trust engaged around 50 people to count notes and coins dropped in various hundiis at the temple.

An officer said, "During the counting, five individuals can be seen whisking away bundles of notes from the pile, hiding them in their clothes or shoving it in socks. Searches at the premises linked to these individuals have already led to recovery of cash. Unfortunately, the temple does not retain more than 45 days of CCTV footage. So we cannot say with certainty for how long this theft has been going on."

The police are now going through documents recovered from premises linked to the accused to ascertain if any property or asset was acquired from stolen money, the officer said.

"We are examining the various other ways that donation money was stolen from the temple. Even employees of the bank are under scrutiny," the officer said. Six of the eight arrested in the case were hired for

the counting purpose by the State Bank of India through Sainik Securities, a Varanasi-based manpower agency.

Gaurav Singh, the director of Sainik Securities, told *The Indian Express* his agency provides housekeeping staff to banks and other firms. "We don't provide banking-related manpower, but housekeeping staff. What a bank or firm uses the staff for is up to them," he said.

He said that in the hiring for the Ram temple, the agency did not have the freedom to choose manpower. "In this case, SE gave us names of the people to be hired. We verified their credentials by examining their Aadhaar cards and processed the paperwork. These men have never worked with us earlier," Singh said, adding that documentary evidence to the effect had been provided to the Special Investigation Team probing the case.

Confirming this, a police officer said, "It only goes to show the temple was being run through adhocism. It has also been pointed out in the SIT report. Several of the accused are related to each other or to a trust functionary. A large number of people appointed for counting of notes, apart from the accused, have also been hired in an ad hoc manner, because somebody was known to somebody. There was no proper vetting of individuals before hiring, nor was access control to counting facility robust with proper checks and frisking." The officer said that bank officials were also under the scanner.

A questionnaire sent to SBI by *The Indian Express* on the claims of its vendor through which some of the suspects were hired did not elicit a response.

VPN

the government, two senior government officials told *The Indian Express*. Penal consequences, including jail terms for local employees, are also being considered in case of non-compliance, it is understood. Much of these requirements and penalties are also present for large social media companies under India's IT Rules, 2021.

"In the last few months, we have been observing that users are able to bypass content, accounts and online services that have been blocked by the government on various grounds by using VPN services. The 2022 Cert-In directives that required VPN providers to store some usage data have not managed to rein in these companies as they have simply refused to comply. So, the need for a full-fledged law is being felt," a senior government official said, requesting anonymity.

Queries sent to the Ministry of Electronics and IT did not elicit a response until publication. VPN services allow users to mask their IP addresses and browse the Internet via servers located elsewhere, making it appear like the traffic is coming from a different jurisdiction, while hiding the original location. India's censorship orders typically require companies to

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

geo-block content within the country's jurisdiction, so, by using a VPN server located in the US, for instance, people can visit content that has been blocked here. They are also a way to anonymously browse the web, and are largely seen as a privacy-enhancing service.

India has stepped up its content blocking ecosystem in recent years, with over 24,000 orders issued in 2025, up from the over 12,000 orders it had issued in 2024, *The Indian Express* had earlier reported.

Another official said the need for having local points of contact for VPN companies is being felt so that the government can direct these services to not allow access to content that is being blocked, as such services "otherwise defeat the purpose".

The 2022 Cert-In directive required VPN providers along with data centres and cloud service providers, to store information such as names, email IDs, contact numbers and IP addresses (among other things) of their customers for five years. In response, VPN operators like Proton VPN, NordVPN, ExpressVPN and Surfshark, had removed servers physically located in India and had started routing traffic coming from India via Singapore. "We have no intention of complying with this invasive mass surveillance law," Proton VPN had said at the time.

fully committed to engaging with the landowners and paying them a fair compensation as determined by the civic administration under the law but some vested interests are instigating the landowners," the spokesperson said.

According to the spokesperson, some farmers have already accepted compensation for their land. One such farmer told *The Indian Express* that he was satisfied with the amount he had got.

"The work on the tower started in August 2025 and was completed in 4-5 months. Work on the cables took two and a half months after that. We accepted the compensation as per the guidelines, and received it after a delay of 30-40 days," Khodabhai Nanubhai Mundva (38), said.

A transmission tower and cables have come up on half a bigha of Mundva's 19-bigha landholding in Halvad village, about 40 km from Jetpar. Mundva said he had been unable to farm this parcel for almost six months, but had recently sown groundnut on much of the land. "*Hum logsan tusht hain aur isi vajah se ko hamare gaanv me ko garshan bhinahi hua*," he said.

On the Jetpar protest, Mundva said, "They too are farmers, and they may be right about their cause. But we are not aware of the compensation they are receiving. We have been told by company representatives that if there is a change in compensation guidelines, we would be eligible."

NORTHERN RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE	
The Sr.DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work: The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.	
Subject	Description
Name of work	PU Painting of Diesel and Electric Locomotives at Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad for 03 Years.
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044.
Completion Period	03 Years
Approximate cost of work	Rs. 90,75,594.19/- Including GST (Rs. Ninety Lakh Seventy Five Thousand Five Hundred Ninety Four and Nineteen Paisa only including GST)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 1,81,500/- (Rs. One Lakh Eighty One Thousand Five Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Description of Similar Nature of work	<i>The approved definition of similar nature of is- "Work of PU Painting carried out in transport sector i.e. Rail Transport (EMU/MEMU/DEMU/Locomotive/Wagons, MCF/CF/RCF/Metro built/other) over India Railway, Road Transport (Public carrier buses) and Civil aviation (Aeroplane/Chopper)"</i>
Website to download and upload e-tender document	www.ireps.gov.in
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	23.07.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date & Time of Tender opening.	23.07.2026 after 12:00 Hrs.
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender.
Allocation	05-0511-32
Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in . For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document.	
Tender Notice No. DSL-TKD-PU Paint-OT-2026 Dated 01.07.2026 2265/2026	
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE	

MINOR WAS THE ONLY MATCH IN THE FAMILY

Liver transplant hinged on man’s 17-year-old son: After rare HC nod, family awaits date of surgery

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 2

UTTAM KUMAR Shaw’s (52) liver is failing. For the last 20 days, he has been admitted to the Institute of Liver and Biliary Sciences (ILBS) in Delhi, waiting for a liver transplant.

A former state-level cricket player – he played for the Kolkata Police’s cricket team – he runs an electricals’ shop in Kolkata.

In January, the family grew alarmed after he suddenly started vomiting blood. A series of tests followed, and the diagnosis came as a blow: Uttam had hepatocellular carcinoma, liver cancer caused by cirrhosis.

By the second week of February, his condition deteriorated rapidly and he had to be admitted to a private hospital in Kolkata. The hospital advised a liver transplant.

The family then in Hyderabad, which gave them the same opinion.

In March, when Uttam had to be admitted again following incessant bleeds, the Kolkata hospital reiterated that he needs a transplant. This time, the family sought a second opinion from ILBS.

The advice was no different: loco-regional therapy for the cancer and evaluation for a liver transplant.

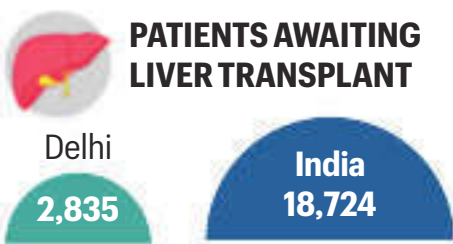
But the hardest part lay ahead. Finding a donor, and finding one quickly. There was only one person who could step forward: Uttam’s 17-year-old son. While the Transplantation Of Human Organs (THO) Act, allows close relatives, including children, to be living donors, minors can be allowed to be donors only under exceptional circumstances and as prescribed by the government under the Act.

A three-month ordeal

On March 25, the son, through his mother, moved the High Court to allow him to donate a part of his liver to his father “in view of the life-threatening liver disease and hepatocellular carcinoma from which he is suffering and for which liver transplantation is the only viable and life-saving treatment”.

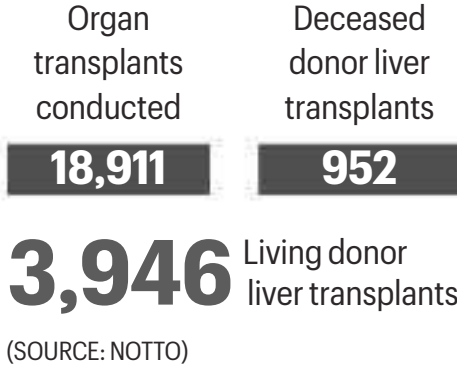
In April, responding to the petition in HC, the Centre – through the National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (NOTTO), under the Ministry of Health and Family

• THE WAIT LIST



8,853 Patients on waiting list for organ transplant in Delhi
(SOURCE: MOHFW DATA RELEASED IN PARLIAMENT IN DECEMBER 2025)

COUNTRY-WIDE TRANSPLANT DATA AS OF 2024



When can minors become living donors?

• The THO Act exercises greater caution in case of minors and foreign nationals and prohibits organ donation from mentally challenged persons. While the 1994 Act completely restricted minors from being living donors, the amendments made in 2011 expanded the scope, provisioning for minors to be living donors, but only in exceptional

circumstances. Academic research suggests that minors are considered as vulnerable owing to their decision-making capacity, their dependency on their caregivers, and also the fact that they are expected to live for much longer with potentially reduced organ mass, which may increase the duration of risk for potential complications.

Welfare – said that while living organ donation by a minor “is not ordinarily permissible”, it is the Delhi government which is authorised to take decision in such a matter. The Delhi government would take nearly two months to give its assent.

On June 29, the Union Health Ministry, taking into note Delhi Lieutenant Governor’s approval for the minor to donate a part of his liver, granted its assent for the procedure and communicated its decision to the ILBS. Following this, the HC gave its nod to the transplant process.

Uttam’s brother-in-law Sanjeev Kumar, a practising advocate at Sasaram in Bihar, told *The Indian Express*, “We realised that only his 17-year old son can donate part of his liver. No one else in the family was a match.” “The boy was very clear that his father needed to be saved. There was no other option,” he added.

A costly wait

For the family, the hospital admissions and visits have drained them of their savings – over Rs 20 lakh.

Uttam is the family’s sole earner. His son, who was studying at a school in Bhubaneswar in Odisha, had to drop out this year after appearing for his Class 10 Board examinations, said Sanjeev.

Advocate Arvind Gupta, who was representing the

minor before the HC and worked pro-bono for the case, said the family has been running around for three months, waiting for approval. “... This is not a first, such exceptions have been drawn by various courts earlier to allow minors to donate organs; the government should take a sympathetic view with such cases. A day’s delay only takes a toll on the patient and the family,” he added.

On June 29, Justice Mini Pushkarna, taking note of the Centre’s stance, reasoned that the balance of equities “overwhelmingly lie in favour of permitting the proposed liver donation and transplantation”.

It further recorded, “In case, this Court denies such permission, it may lead to loss of life of the petitioner’s father.”

Earlier in June, Uttam also underwent TIPS (Transhepatic Intrahepatic Portosystemic Shunt) surgery. The surgery involved placing a stent that moves the blood away from the liver.

He barely speaks now, and continues to battle with complications, said Sanjeev.

With the court recording in its order that ILBS shall now expeditiously fix a date for the operation, Sanjeev said, “The hospital has not yet told us a date for the transplant. The donor tests that were done earlier are outdated now and fresh tests will have to be conducted. Each day counts for us.”

DELHI DISCOMS TO UNDERGO SUCH AUDIT FOR FIRST TIME SINCE PRIVATISATION OF POWER DISTRIBUTION

Unrecovered cost of Rs 38,500 cr: Govt orders CAG audit of discoms

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

THE DELHI government has ordered a Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit of power discoms amid concerns over Rs 38,500 crore in regulatory assets (RAs) accumulated over the years – a cost that is ultimately to be recovered from consumers.

In an order issued on Wednesday, the Power department said that the CAG will undertake a “strict and intensive audit of the circumstances in which the Distribution Companies –BRPL, BYPL and TPDDL have continued without recovery of Regulatory Assets”.

The audit may preferably be completed within three months from the date of communication of the order, subject to such extension as the CAG may consider necessary having regard to the scope and complexity of the audit, the order dated July 1 read.

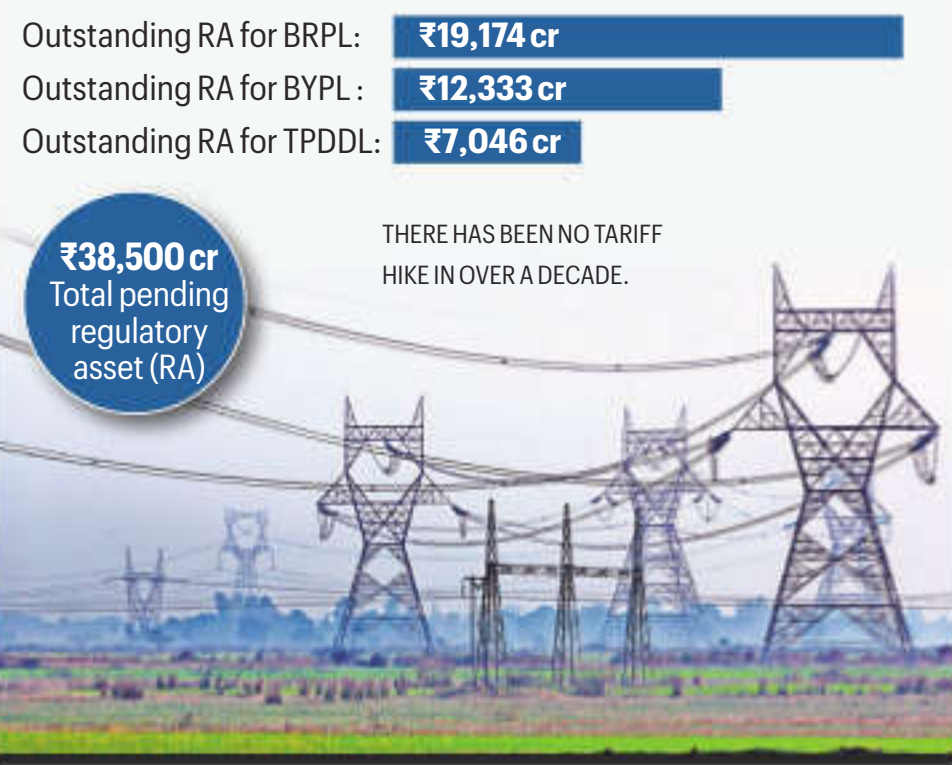
In response to the government’s decision, a BSES spokesperson said, “The question of a CAG audit of the Delhi discoms is currently sub-judice before the courts. As the matter is underjudicial consideration, it would not be appropriate to comment further.”

This will be the first time power discoms in Delhi undergo a CAG audit since the privatisation of electricity distribution in 2002, unless they seek legal recourse. A similar attempt was made by the previous AAP-led government to conduct a CAG audit, but it was thwarted by the High Court in 2015.

RAs refer to deferred expenses borne by discoms out of changes in fuel costs. It is determined as the gap between average cost of supply by the discoms and the revenue collected by them through tariffs and subsidies.

“...After considering the representations of the Distribution Companies and the directions of the Supreme Court... and having regard to the magnitude of the regulatory assets, their implications on electricity consumers, the involvement of public funds through government equity participation and subsidy support, and the consequent need for transparency and accountability in the electricity sector, the Cabinet on June 29, has observed that entrustment of the audit to the CAG of India is expedient in public interest, and has accordingly recommended the entrustment of a strict and intensive audit of the circumstances

• THE POWER CHART



in which the Distribution Companies have continued without recovery of the regulatory assets, to the CAG...,” the order read. The Cabinet meeting was chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta this Monday.

Power Minister Ashish Sood said, “The formal order for the CAG audit of Delhi’s DISCOMs is a historic moment for transparency, accountability and governance reforms in Delhi’s power sector...”

He said that after the privatisation of the power sector, many financial decisions,

special arrangements and growing liabilities escaped proper public scrutiny for years. “The AAP government chose to protect the system instead of examining it. What they failed to do in 10 years, our government has initiated within a few months...people of Delhi have every right to know how regulatory assets worth nearly Rs 38,000 crore kept growing and who benefited while this burden continued to hang over the citizens,” Sood said.

Officials also said that the audit has been approved by the

Lieutenant Governor.

Earlier in April, the Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL) rejected the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission’s (DERC) application seeking a CAG audit of power discoms and directed the Commission to begin the liquidation of pending RAs in three weeks.

As per DERC’s submission before APTEL, the outstanding RAs comprise Rs 19,174 crore for BRPL, Rs 12,333 crore for BYPL, and Rs 7,046 crore for TPDDL. These represent approved expenditure incurred by the discoms for supplying electricity.

As there was no tariff hike in over a decade, the amount rose to Rs 38,500 crore.

The order states that on August 6, 2025, a strict and intensive audit of the circumstances in which the discoms continued without recovery of RAs was directed. And the CAG on January 20 this year conveyed its in-principle approval to undertake the audit of accounts of the three discoms, upon an authorisation by the LG.

On APTEL rejecting a CAG audit, the Power department said, notices were issued to discoms on June 6, asking them to submit their representations and avail opportunity of personal hearing.

Drone-delivered weapons, social media handlers: 4 held as terror network busted

Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 2

DRONES FROM across the border dropping weapons and drugs in Punjab, handlers in Pakistan sharing mission details over social media apps, and reconnaissance of police stations and religious places in Delhi – police said these were part of an alleged plan by operatives linked to Pakistan’s Shahzad Bhatti to open fire near VIP areas in the national capital in the coming months.

According to Delhi Police, the plot came to light after the arrest of four men, linked to cross-border terror networks operating in Punjab and Delhi, since April.

Over the last several months, Indian agencies have alleged that Bhatti is linked to Pakistan’s ISI and has been attempting to expand his network in India by radicalising unemployed youth. Senior police officers said the arrests were made during a coordinated operation across Punjab and Delhi after intelligence inputs suggested that Bhatti and

his associates were allegedly planning a terror incident in Delhi-NCR. Two foreign-made pistols, and five mobile phones were recovered.

Investigators said handlers had recruited youth from Punjab and arranged foreign phone numbers for them to communicate without attracting the attention of Indian security agencies. “The Special Cell had received specific intelligence about the network and carried out multiple raids based on technical surveillance and source inputs. The first breakthrough came with the arrest of Shubdeep Singh alias Vishal (23) from Majitha Road in Amritsar,” said DCP Praveen Tripathi.

During questioning, police said Shubdeep allegedly admitted that he was in regular contact with Pakistan-based handlers linked to the Bhatti network and had been receiving consignments of firearms and narcotics dropped across the border using drones. Investigators claimed he used foreign numbers provided by his handlers to remain in touch with them.

At his instance, police arrested Gur-

jant Singh alias Rishi (22), and Sajjan Singh alias Honey (28) from Punjab.

Police alleged that both men were also communicating with ISI handlers through foreign numbers and received arms and narcotics smuggled from Pakistan. Further probed to the arrest of 24-year-old Gaganpreet from Delhi on April 24, said police.

Police claimed his Pakistani handlers had tasked him with conducting reconnaissance of police stations, police pickets and religious places in Delhi and carrying out a firing incident in the city. Police said Shubdeep and Sajjan were earlier arrested in separate NDPS cases in Punjab.

Senior police officers said the case highlights continued attempts by Pakistan-based handlers to revive terror networks by using local recruits, encrypted foreign communication channels and cross-border drone deliveries of arms and narcotics to target security establishments in India.



RAJ SHARMA
QUEEN OF OUR HEARTS

PRAYER MEETING
4th July 2026 | 10:00 - 11:30 am

VENUE
Chinmaya Mission Lodhi Road
89, Lodhi Rd, Institutional Area,
Lodhi Estate,
New Delhi, Delhi 110003

CHILDREN
Dr Shikha Nehru Sharma
Amit Sharma
Parul Mehra



राष्ट्रीय औषधीय शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान गुवाहाटी
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF PHARMACEUTICAL EDUCATION AND RESEARCH GUWAHATI

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION NO. 02/2026 **DATE: 02/07/2026**

VACANCY NOTICE

National Institute of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPER) Guwahati invites applications for the post of Estate & Security Officer on regular basis from eligible Indian Nationals.

Date & time of commencement of Online Applications	02/07/26 from 11:00 AM
Last date & time of Online Application & Payment of Fees	31/07/26 upto 05:00 PM
Last date for receipt of hard copy of the online application along with all enclosures	07/08/26 up to 05:00 PM

For detailed qualifications and other requirements, please visit the institute website: www.niperguwahati.ac.in

Sd/- Registrar /c

Advertisement No: 77/2026

Government of India
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invites applications for the post of

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Last date of submission of application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on
23-07-2026

Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers to PESB is by 17:00 hours on
03-08-2026

For details login to website
<https://pesb.gov.in>



PM SHRI KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA
(Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)
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Tel. No. - 011-20867615 | KVS Vidyalaya Code: 1437

ADVERTISING POST FOR FIRM REGISTRATION

Applications are invited for the registration of firms for the academic sessions 2026-27 & 2027-28 for providing the following services/ items in PM SHRI KV Sector 2 R K Puram, New Delhi: - Wall Painting/ Drawing, Flex Banners, Water Coolers/RO Systems, Fire Extinguishers, Sports Goods, stationery items, Computer/CCTV Camera related items, Chartered Accountant Services for return filling of TDS/GST etc. Trophies & Mementos, Photography & Videography, Costumes for Cultural Programmes/Dance Performances (on hire basis), Furniture Repair & Maintenance, Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) of Fans and Air Conditioners.

Interested firms/dealers/service providers are requested to submit their applications for registration along with their Bio-data/Profile, EPF, ESI, GST Registration, PAN, Experience Certificates, Valid Licences, and other relevant supporting documents.

The registration form can be downloaded from the school website: <https://rkpuramsec2.kvs.ac.in/>. The duly filled application form, along with self-attested copies of all required documents should be sent only through Speed Post/Registered Post to **PM SHRI Kendriya Vidyalaya, Sector-2, R.K. Puram** during the period **03.07.2026 to 25.07.2026**.

Tenders/quotations will be invited from the shortlisted firms for firm registration. The School Tender/Quotation Committee reserves the right to invite the shortlisted firms in the interest of the school.

Principal

Chinese app ‘shutting down’ e-rickshaws in social media clips: Govt to verify claims

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

IN THE wake of posts on social media platforms claiming e-rickshaws can be disabled through Bluetooth, using Chinese application BAT-BMS, the Delhi government has asked the Transport department to verify the authenticity of the app.

Videos circulating on Instagram, YouTube and X show users of the app “connecting” to e-rickshaw batteries and switching off their discharge function, leaving the vehicles stranded.

Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said the department has been asked to look into the matter and examine the app and claims surrounding its use. “I am yet to receive a written complaint, but people raised the issue at my office...,” Singh said, adding that it is illegal and the police may take action.

A senior government official, meanwhile, said preliminary findings suggest that the app can connect to Bluetooth-enabled lithium batteries within a limited range.

It is primarily designed to monitor battery parameters such as voltage, temperature and current in real time, but is allegedly being misused to disable vehicles, the official said, adding that many e-rickshaws use China-manufactured Battery Management Systems (BMS) with little or no Bluetooth security, allowing nearby users to connect to the batteries through such an app.

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PUBLIC NOTICE TO THE HOLDERS OF 14% SECURED DEBENTURES ISSUED BY M/S. GUJARAT OPTICAL COMMUNICATION LTD.

Bank of Baroda, acting as the Trustee for the Debenture Holders of M/s. Gujarat Optical Communication Ltd., hereby notifies that pro-rata payments have already been disbursed to eligible debenture holders who submitted their claims in respect of the **14% Secured Redeemable Partly Convertible Debentures**. This notice is being issued to invite claims from the remaining debenture holders who have not yet submitted their claims. Such debenture holders are requested to surrender their original debenture certificates, duly discharged along with self-attested KYC documents, at the Trustee Office within **30 days from the date of publication of this notice during working hours** on working days (i.e. excluding Sundays and Bank Holidays), to enable the Trustee to make payment of their proportionate share from the distributable proceeds available with it. Each eligible debenture holder shall be entitled to receive Rs.2.80/- per bond. **Debenture holders who have already received their pro-rata share are not eligible to submit any further claim.**

Trustee Office Address:
Bank of Baroda, Legal Dept.,
5th Floor, BCC, C-26, G-Block,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai-400051
Contact Person: **Mr. I V K Chakravarthi**
Phone no. 022-66985540/37

Date: 02/07/2026
Place: Mumbai

For Bank of Baroda, Debenture Trustee

Sd/-
Authorised Signatory & Head (Legal & RTI)

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(A Unitary Technological University of Govt. of Maharashtra)
Ph - 020-25507000 / 09 Website-www.coeptech.ac.in

Walk-In Interviews For Recruitment of Assistant Professor on 11 Months, Contractual Basis.

COEP Technological University Pune invites applications from dynamic, eligible and qualified candidates with passion towards research and academics to work as **Assistant Professor on 11 Months, Contractual Basis, non-vacational, dying post in Applied Sciences (Economics, Entrepreneurship, Design Thinking); Civil Engineering; Computer Science & Engineering; Electrical Engineering; Instrumentation & Control Engineering; and Master of Business Administration (Business Analytics, Marketing, Finance)** purely on temporary basis, to engage academic load for AY: 2026-27 in various Engineering and Science disciplines.

Please visit University website (www.coeptech.ac.in/career) for requirements, qualifications, experience, salary and other details under "Careers" tab. Reservation policy will be followed as per the norms.

All interested candidates are requested to visit the COEP Technological University website for further details and submit an **online application form** with applicable application fees **on or before 10.07.2026**.

Walk in Interviews : Monday 13.07.2026 and Tuesday 14.07.2026 as per the schedule given on the University website.

The candidates shall report at 10 a.m. to the respective departments.

Sd/-
Registrar,
COEP Technological University Pune

Date : 02/07/2026

Last few seasons, one in three winter days in Delhi saw GRAP 3 & 4 curbs

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, July 2

ABOUT ONE-THIRD of each of Delhi's last three winters was spent under the two strictest stages of anti-pollution curbs, Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP), according to an analysis by *The Indian Express*. The pattern explains why the Delhi government has decided to make several anti-pollution measures mandatory every winter — from November 1 to February 28 — instead of imposing them only during pollution spikes.

An analysis of GRAP orders issued by the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) alongside pollution levels over the last three winters shows that Delhi-NCR spent the majority of the November 1-February 28 period under some kind of pollution curbs.

In each winter, fewer than 12 of the 120 days were free from restrictions beyond GRAP 1. Meanwhile, GRAP 3 and 4 — the most disruptive levels — remained in force for about 40 days every winter.

Under GRAP 3, most of private construction and demolition activities are put on hold, while under GRAP 4, additional curbs like entry of trucks into Delhi, hybrid schooling and work from home provisions are introduced.

On Wednesday, the Delhi government notified a new



The winter of 2024-25 witnessed the highest number of GRAP 4 days among the three seasons. FILE

winter action plan making measures such as work from home, staggered office timings, construction curbs and vehicle restrictions mandatory between November and February, regardless of daily AQI levels.

The government said the decision was based on air quality trends over the past three winters, when Delhi consistently recorded 'Very Poor' to 'Severe' air quality. These measures will operate alongside GRAP.

Experts have criticised frequent implementation and withdrawal of GRAP.

In a report released in May, the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW) said the system relies heavily on AQI levels, resulting in repeated tightening and relaxation of curbs without adequately ac-

counting for pollution sources. It recommended a more predictable, source-based and hyperlocal approach so authorities can act before pollution worsens.

2023-24: Consistent elevated pollution

The winter of 2023-24 saw consistently high pollution. Average PM2.5 levels were 240 µg/m³ in November, 202 µg/m³ in December and 205 µg/m³ in January before falling to 102 µg/m³ in February. During the 120-day season, Delhi spent 24 days under GRAP 3 and 13 days under GRAP 4.

Unlike the subsequent winters, GRAP IV was invoked only once, but remained in force continuously from November 5 to 18 — 13 days. GRAP 3 was enforced in four separate

spells as pollution fluctuated.

2024-25: Highest GRAP IV days

The winter of 2024-25 witnessed the highest number of GRAP 4 days among the three seasons. Average PM2.5 levels were 248 µg/m³ in November, improving to 170 µg/m³ in December and 163 µg/m³ in January. Despite the gradual decline, repeated pollution spikes led to GRAP 4 being imposed for 27 days across three spells.

The AQI in the first two weeks of November remained in the 'Very Poor' category, but GRAP 3 was introduced only on November 14. As pollution worsened to the 'Severe' category, GRAP 4 came into force on November 17 and continued into December, making it the longest period of strict restrictions in the three winters.

2025-26: Elevated pollution in December

Unlike previous winters, pollution remained high well into December in 2025-26, instead of declining after November.

Average PM2.5 levels were almost unchanged between November (215 µg/m³) and December (213 µg/m³), leading to the continuation of stringent restrictions later into the season.

Delhi spent 27 days under GRAP 3 and 14 days under GRAP 4, with emergency measures extending through much of December.

Why GRAP matters

While GRAP 1 and 2 mainly strengthen enforcement against dust, waste burning, vehicular emissions and diesel generators, GRAP 3 is the first level that significantly affects economic activity, stopping most construction and demolition work.

GRAP 4 additionally introduces the toughest restrictions, including a ban on entry of trucks into Delhi except for essential goods and services, restrictions on Delhi-registered BS-IV diesel heavy goods vehicles, curbs on public infrastructure projects, hybrid classes for students of classes 9 and 11, work from home options for government offices with only 50% physical attendance and the possibility of shutting colleges and non-essential commercial activities.

According to the CEEW report, "While GRAP formally considers forecasts, its implementation remains largely air quality index-triggered and insufficiently linked to source contribution forecasts, hotspot-level data, and pre-emptive sectoral action."

"The problem is not that GRAP stages change," it said. "It is that frequent imposition and withdrawal without a clear source-based rationale creates uncertainty for businesses, schools, construction firms, enforcement agencies and citizens."



Sarthak Mattoo's parents at their Gurgaon residence on Thursday. TASHI TOBGYAL

‘Don’t know on whom to take out anger’: Parents of Gurgaon hit-and-run victim await justice

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 2

THE DOOR to the Mattoos' Gurgaon home opens directly into their son Sarthak's room. His bed is made. The room is neat and tidy.

But for Anuradha and Surrender Mattoo — Kashmiri Pandits — the room is a reminder that their only child will never return.

Sarthak (34) was killed in a hit-and-run early June 25 in South Delhi's Vasant Kunj.

The man driving that SUV that hit Sarthak's bike, Apurv Singh (30) — a resident of Ghaziabad in Uttar Pradesh — was arrested on June 27 but was released on bail soon after.

The family's grief has now turned into anger. "I don't know how to take out my anger and on whom," says Anuradha, inconsolable.

Sarthak was riding his motorcycle to work in Noida around 6.30 am when a Mahindra Thar allegedly hit him from behind near the Rajokri flyover. According to the FIR, the impact flung him and his motorcycle off the flyover.

In a video message recorded at his Gurgaon home, Surrender has appealed to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta for justice. "My parents died, our house was burnt, yet we rebuilt our lives. Now, our only son has been killed. Why have those responsible not been punished?" he says in the video.

Sarthak had completed his master's from Roehampton University in London after graduating from the Symbiosis School of Economics.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on Thursday, Anuradha says, "We had begged Sarthak not to return after he completed his master's in London. We were afraid of the road rage here. He told us, 'You are all I have. My heart is here.' We even told him we would settle there. But he came back only for us... and now he has left us forever."

The last few days have been



Sarthak's bedroom (top) in the house. TASHI TOBGYAL

exhausting, says Surrender. "We still haven't fully understood what has happened. Sometimes it feels like a bad dream we cannot wake up from. But I will fight for justice. I owe him that."

The family says they have received little clarity from the police. "When we asked the police how the accused got bail, we were told Section 106(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) is under abeyance because of the truckers' protests. Had that provision been in force, the people who killed my son would still be behind bars," says Anuradha.

The Ministry of Home Affairs had agreed to put the 10-year imprisonment provision for fatal hit-and-run cases under the section in abeyance following nationwide protests and negotiations with the All India Motor Transport Congress.

Their last conversation with Sarthak was over dinner the night before the accident.

"He came home around 11 pm and was on the phone. We were having dinner. He told us

to continue eating. He said he had to leave early for Noida the next morning. He left without waking us up. We never got to say goodbye," Anuradha says.

"He always wanted to make us proud. He did not have any big dreams," she adds.

The tragedy has reopened old scars for the family.

Surrender says that while he had come to Delhi in 1984 for work, during the exodus of Kashmiri Pandits from the Valley, the family's five-storey home in Srinagar was burnt down.

"We rebuilt everything from scratch," he says. "I will leave no stone unturned. If we don't fight, this will become another case people forget."

Sarthak's college batchmate, Suryansh, says even finding a photograph of the accused was difficult. "He deactivated all his social media accounts. We had to scrape around just to find one picture."

Police have said that the Thar was registered in the name of a Bengaluru-based private company and had been leased to Sagar Saha (29), who was employed with the firm.

During questioning, Saha allegedly told police that his friend, Apurv, was driving the SUV while he was in the passenger seat when the crash took place.

A senior police officer said the SUV was seized and the accused was identified within a day of the incident. "The case was registered as per the applicable law and the court granted bail," the officer added.

Monsoon arrives in Capital, rain likely next week

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

SOUTHWEST MONSOON reached Delhi on Thursday, five days later than its normal onset date of June 27, bringing widespread rain and marking the end of a prolonged spell of heat across the Capital.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) announced that monsoon has advanced across Delhi, along with most parts of Haryana and Punjab, remaining parts of Uttar Pradesh, and additional areas of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat.

Delhi's monsoon onset this year comes after the city experienced two consecutive days of heatwave conditions late June before thunderstorms and light rainfall brought some relief.

The arrival is slightly later than last year, when Southwest Monsoon reached Delhi on June 28, but much earlier than in years like 2021, when it arrived on July 13, and 2002, when the onset was delayed until July 19.

Over the last 25 years, monsoon has typically reached Delhi between the last week of June and the first week of July, with June 27 being the climatological normal onset date.



Commuters make their way amid rainfall in Gurgaon Thursday. PTI

According to IMD records, the earliest onset since 2001 was June 15 in 2008, while the latest was July 19 in 2002.

For Delhi, the weather office forecast generally cloudy skies with fairly widespread to widespread rainfall during the coming week.

Isolated heavy rainfall is likely on Thursday and again during July 5-8 under the influence of active monsoon conditions.

The current spell is being driven by multiple favourable

weather systems, including a strengthening low-level Somali Jet (wind current) enhancing moisture transport from the Arabian Sea; a low-pressure area over the northwest Bay of Bengal that is expected to become more marked over the next two to three days; an offshore trough extending from south Gujarat to Karnataka and the seasonal monsoon trough remaining close to its normal position.

The arrival of monsoon also marks the end of a relatively

• Skywatch



Forecast: July 3, 2026

Generally cloudy sky; very light to light rainfall

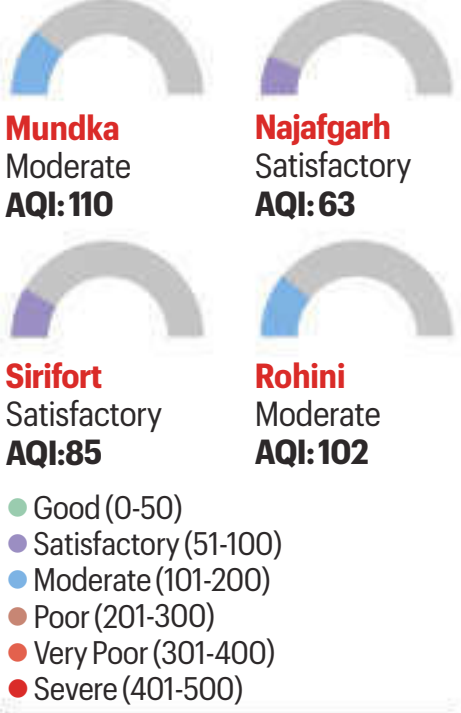
MAX: 31-33

4.4°C below normal

MIN: 20-22

7.9°C below normal

• AQI Tracker



hot pre-monsoon season, as per IMD data. Delhi experienced its warmest pre-monsoon nights in four years in 2026, with the

average minimum temperature for March-June reaching 22.9°C.

This is the highest seasonal average minimum temperature recorded since 2022 (23.3°C), and higher than the corresponding averages of 22.8°C in 2024, 22.5°C in 2025 and 20.9°C in 2023.

Delhi's average maximum temperature between March and June stood at 37°C, above last year's 36.6°C, while the average minimum temperature was 22.9°C, indicating persistently warm nights before the onset of monsoon.

According to the IMD, heatwave conditions have abated across the country from June 29. It said conditions remain favourable for the monsoon to advance further into the remaining parts of Northwest India over the coming days.

However, rainfall across the country remains below normal. As per IMD data, cumulative rainfall during the Southwest Monsoon season — from June 1 to July 1 — is 38% below the long-period average for the country as a whole.

Central India has recorded a 45% deficit, followed by East and Northeast India (40%), Northwest India (30%) and South Peninsula (26%).

• COFORGE'S FOURTH PUBLIC LIBRARY IS OPEN DAILY FROM 9 AM TO 8 PM; THE NEXT ONE IS COMING IN GREATER NOIDA

New in Vasant Kunj: A paradise of books that invites you to read — for free

Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, July 2

FROM BEHIND glass, the Argentine poet and writer Jorge Luis Borges speaks to those who walk past: "I have always imagined that paradise will be a kind of library." Inside is a slice of paradise — a round table; on it, books on various subjects.

"It's intentional, that's the quote I want people to see before they enter; it's our hero quote," says Anuradha Sehgal, the Chief Brand and Sustainability Officer of Coforge.

This is the Coforge Public Library on the first floor of Vasant Square Mall in Vasant Kunj, South Delhi. The library, open to everyone, every day, for free, is the social responsibility initiative of Coforge, the Greater Noida-headquartered multinational IT company.

The Vasant Kunj library, which was inaugurated on June 5, is the fourth and newest Coforge Public Library — the older libraries are in Noida's Sector 59, Gurgaon's Sector 48, and in Hyderabad. It sprawls

over 10,000 sq ft — and is home to 15,000 titles, including 2,500 titles in Hindi, and a Braille section sourced from the National Book Trust (NBT).

The library is open from 9 am to 8 pm daily, and can seat 170 users at a time in pink, blue, and grey cushioned chairs. "We typically get 200-250 people on weekends and about 170 on weekdays," Sehgal said. Many of the visitors are senior citizens, and the library aisles are wide enough for a wheelchair to pass. During a weekend visit to the library, *The Indian Express* met 70-year-old Arvind Singhal, who said he was there for the fourth time. His name, phone number, age group, and email were already in the library database, and he had logged in using his phone and a QR code.

Singhal said he had picked Aath Dinn (Eight Days) by the prolific crime fiction writer Surendra Mohan Pathak to read. "I wish this library had more Hindi books; there are limited options," Singhal said. "I understand that it caters to younger readers of writing in English,



Anuradha Sehgal, Chief Brand and Sustainability Officer of Coforge, at the library; (below) The 10,000-sq-ft library in Vasant Square Mall houses 15,000 titles. VIVEK PRAKASH KRISHNA

but I wish it had more Hindi novels for people like me."

Harsh Parashar (41), a law-

yer who practises in the Supreme Court, said he had come to check out the library from

Hauz Khas. The range of choices had overwhelmed him, Parashar said — "I went into a decision paralysis, so now I'm noting down names of books I want to come back and read!"

Nitika Khandelwal (23), a student at IIMC Delhi, was on her first visit, and had found a seat from which she could see trees outside the window. "The space is really cosy," she said.

Head librarian Misbah said the library was the product of Coforge CEO and Executive Director Sudhir Singh's vision to "bring the community back to reading." Sehgal said Singh had seen the role that privately-funded public libraries played in shaping communities in the United States, and got the "audacious idea" to build a similar network in India.

Visitors are required to deposit personal laptops, tablets, and their own books in lockers before they use the library. Each

table has a sign that asks visitors to maintain silence and not use mobile phones. "We have created gadget-free libraries where we want visitors to be away from any kind of distraction," Misbah said.

Sehgal said having Wi-Fi and allowing personal gadgets would likely lead the library to be "overrun by students studying for competitive exams". Her goal was to "force people to read", she said. "You'd love to spend an hour here, but when you're here, read a book, because nobody else is forcing you to do that, and what is your incentive then?"

The choice of Vasant Kunj for the library was deliberate and thought-out, Sehgal said. "It has Masoodpur, Kishanagarh, Mahipalpur, Chhatrapur, Gwal Pahari, Nangal Dewat, and several JJ clusters around it. Whenever we select a location, we always make sure that it is serving a very large cluster of urban and peri-urban areas,

with very high population density," she said.

In one corner of the library is a separate, soundproofed Kids Zone. "We made it so children could read aloud, sing, play, and delve into the world of books," Sehgal said. The library has a large collection of children's books — packing the bottom shelf in each aisle for kids to browse while their parents look for their own reading material. Every Coforge library reaches out to government schools in a 5-10-km radius, and arranges for buses to bring in their students. "We want them to come here and read, realise that there are no limitations," Sehgal said.

Coforge plans to launch 26 libraries across Delhi-NCR over the next four years. The next one is coming up in Greater Noida, where the administration has provided space rent-free. Coforge is also developing an AI-powered app that will recommend books — "There is a way to read, and we will use AI to bring that to life for you," Sehgal said.

Man saved by police after Meta flags his video on suicide plan

Drishti Jain
Noida, July 2

ON MONDAY, a 38-year-old truck driver in Greater Noida was distressed after an alleged fight with his wife over their daughter. He took to social media and uploaded a video stating that he was going to end his life, police said.

After posting the video, he left with his truck. The video, uploaded on Meta's Facebook and Instagram, set off a 40-odd-minute race by the police to rescue him. Around 11 am on Monday, Meta sent an email alert flagging the video to the Social Media Centre at the UP Police HQ. The Director General of Police then directed officers to immediately trace the man's location and send the real-time location to the Gautam Buddha Nagar Commissionerate's media cell.

As per police, the man when rescued displayed "visible signs of stress".

Brij Bhushan case: Delhi court verdict likely on August 3

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 2

THREE YEARS after a charge-sheet was filed against former BJP MP and ex-chief of Wrestling Federation of India (WFI), Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh, for allegedly sexually harassing several women wrestlers, the trial in the case has been completed.

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Ashwani Panwar of Rouse Avenue court has reserved the judgment in the matter and is likely to pronounce it on August 3.

The trial in the case began in July 2024.

While 43 witnesses were officially on the initial list, a number of them were dropped as the case progressed. Each of the remaining witnesses has been examined, final arguments concluded, and the court has asked all the counsel to file written submissions in two weeks.

The defence, led by advocates Rajiv Mohan, Rishabh Bhati, Rehan Khan and Suryansh Singh, argued during in-camera proceedings that the complainants kept changing their statements.

On the other hand, Public



The trial in the case against the former BJP MP and ex-chief of WFI began in July 2024

Prosecutor Manish Rawat argued that from framing of charges till the trial, the statements of the victims have been consistent.

Senior Advocate Rebecca John, assisted by Bhavook Chauhan, Harsh Bora and Anushka Baruah, who represented four complainants, argued that they had extensively testified about various incidents of sexual assault and harassment at the hands of the accused and that these testimonies had not been shaken in cross-examination.

“Corroborative witnesses, who witnessed some of these incidents, have also been examined and they have fully supported the version of the women wrestlers,” she told *The Indian Express*.

Material science expert appointed new DST Secy

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 2

A PROFESSOR in the Theoretical Sciences department at the Jawaharalal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research in Bengaluru, has been appointed Secretary in the Department of Science and Technology (DST).

Umesh Waghmare, 58, is known for his work in material sciences. He is an alumnus of IIT Bombay and Yale University in

the United States where he completed his PhD. He has been honoured with the Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar award and the Infosys Prize among others.

He will take the place of Abhay Karandikar, the former Secretary, who was appointed as a Member in NITI Aayog in April this year. Rajesh Gokhale, Secretary in the Department of Biotechnology, had been looking after DST as an additional charge since then.

Punjab Congress truce secured, but can it survive the next flashpoint?

Manoj CG
New Delhi, July 2

THE CONGRESS high command may have managed to pacify warring leaders in its Punjab unit and broker peace for the time being, but the factional fault lines run deep and the tricky question of whether Lok Sabha MPs should be allowed to contest Assembly elections next year could lead to fresh turmoil, sources said. Many of the chief ministerial hopefuls, including former CM Charanjit Singh Channi, are Lok Sabha MPs.

Party leaders said Channi who was keen to take over as Punjab Congress president was upset with the high command's decision to allow incumbent Amrinder Singh Raja Warring to continue. While persisting with Warring as the state president and Partap Singh Bajwa as Legislature Party leader, the high command sought to accommodate Channi and other senior leaders such as Lok Sabha MPs Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa and Amar Singh and AICC joint treasurer Vijay Inder Singla by appointing them as heads of key election-related committees.

The decision came after extensive discussions that saw much intense behind-the-scenes muscle-flexing, sources said. The high command had undertaken the massive consultation exercise — a three-member panel headed by AICC treasurer Ajay Maken met as many as 66 senior leaders — after a sizable section of the leadership felt Warring should be replaced.

At least 30 Jatt Sikh leaders had even written to Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge seeking an audience to pitch for the appointment of Channi, a Dalit Sikh, as Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) president. As the Channi camp mounted



Charanjit Singh Channi is said to be upset with the move to continue with Amrinder Singh Raja Warring (R) as state president. X/@INCPUNJAB

pressure, the other blocs too became active. Sources said Warring got the support of the majority of the district Congress presidents, appointed in November 2025. Separately, senior Jatt Sikh leaders Bajwa and Randhawa joined hands to ensure that Channi does not get the top post, said sources.

At one point, a proposal came from the anti-Channi camp that if appointed PCC president, he should not be allowed to contest the Assembly elections. Then there was another argument that changing Warring, who had been at the helm for over four years, months before the elections, would send a wrong signal.

The Congress high command's decision to remove Captain Amarinder Singh as the CM and replace him with Channi months before the 2022 Assembly elections had ended in a disaster. The Congress went into elections under Channi's leadership and managed to win just 18 of the 117 seats, its worst-ever performance.

Channi is a Lok Sabha MP and so are Randhawa, Amar Singh, and Raja Warring. High command sources said the question of whether MPs should be allowed to contest the Assembly elections could be the next flashpoint. There is no hard and fast rule in the Congress on MPs

contesting Assembly elections. Recently, the Congress high command did not allow MPs to contest the Kerala elections, but at the same time fielded Congress Deputy Leader in the Lok Sabha, Gaurav Gogoi, from Jorhat in the Assam polls. Gogoi, who was virtually the party's CM face, lost by more than 23,000 votes.

In the past, the party appointed Lok Sabha MPs as CMs after winning elections. The last instance was the appointment of Kamal Nath as the Madhya Pradesh CM in 2018. Bhupinder Singh Hooda got the Haryana CM post way back in 2005 when he was a Lok Sabha MP. Channi is learnt to be upset with the high command's decision and has not commented on it so far.

And it is not just Channi. Chandigarh MP Lok Sabha Manish Tewari is upset with the party for not consulting him and has made his displeasure known. Arguing that people tend to pick flaws in those who are talented, he posted on X on Friday, “Wish I had an antidote for the insecurities of individuals and institutions! Having said that, the Congress has given me enough over the past 45 years and I have also devoted my entire adult life in the service of the Indian National Congress over the decades. Que sera, sera, Whatever will be, will be.”

Modi and Takaichi discuss West Asia crisis, Ukraine conflict

Divya A
New Delhi, July 2

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi and his Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi weighed in on a host of global and regional issues, including cross-border terrorism from Pakistan, Gaza rebuilding, the ongoing Ukraine conflict, Strait of Hormuz and West Asia crisis and the situation in South China Sea and East China Sea.

In the joint statement released after the summit talks, both Modi and Takaichi stressed “the importance of securing free and safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, maintaining stable supply chains for energy and other essential goods, and upholding international law”. They also stressed advancing the comprehensive plan to rebuild Gaza and live up to the commitment of ensuring a two-state solution.

Both New Delhi and Tokyo have consistently supported the two-state solution as a means to achieve lasting peace in the region.

According to officials in the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), the Indo-Pacific was discussed at length between the two leaders. They concurred on the strategic importance of India's northeastern region to realise a resilient and prosperous Indo-Pacific.

They also noted the progress under the Quad framework and spoke about convening the next Quad Leaders' Summit soon. Delhi was supposed to hold the Quad Summit in 2025, but it did not work out as India and the United States (another Quad member, along with Australia) got embroiled in tariff-related issues.

Both Modi and Takaichi highlighted the importance of cooperation with ASEAN Member States to strengthen regional resilience and promote



PM Narendra Modi interacts with Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 peace. In this context, they mooted a trilateral 1.5-track policy dialogue with the Philippines, reiterating their strong support for ASEAN's centrality.

While PM Modi appreciated Japan's support in enhancing connectivity in the region with road networks and bridges, the two sides discussed creating industrial value chains connecting the Northeast with the Bay of Bengal area in collaboration with regional organisations such as BIMSTEC.

There were discussions earlier to hold the India-Japan summit in Guwahati, in consonance with Japan's ties with the region, but it was later changed to New Delhi owing to PM Takaichi's tight schedule.

The two Prime Ministers expressed serious concern over the situation in the East China Sea and the South China Sea, according to the joint statement. Without making any direct mention of China, they reiterated “their strong opposition to any unilateral action that endangers the safety as well as freedom of navigation and to changing the status quo by force or coercion”.

They shared their concerns over the growing militarisation of disputed features, in an oblique reference to China's growing military dominance in the

region.

In another initiative that is aimed at countering China's growing footprint in Africa, India and Japan discussed the formulation of the Strategic Outlook for Expanding Japan-India Cooperation in Africa.

Modi and Takaichi “unequivocally and strongly condemned terrorism and violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism from Pakistan”. The two leaders also condemned in the strongest terms the terror incident in Delhi on November 10, 2025.

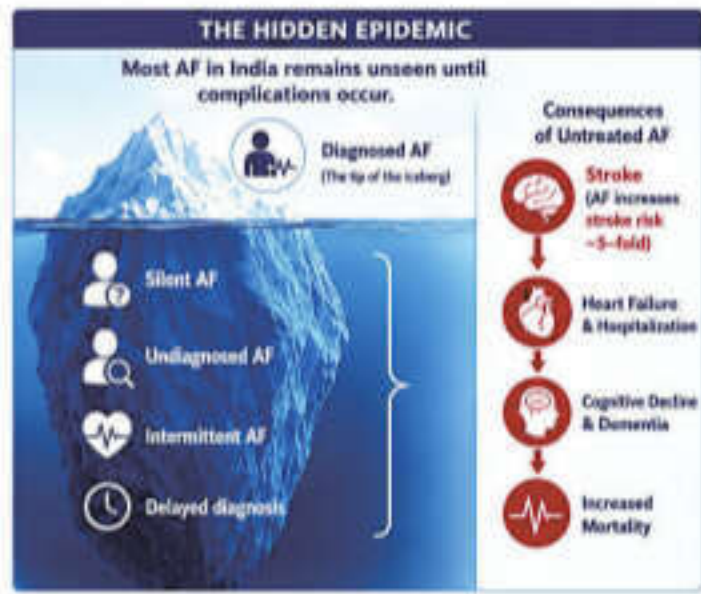
“They called for the perpetrators, organisers and financiers of this reprehensible act to be brought to justice without any delay,” as per the joint statement, which also called for actions against all UN-listed terrorist groups and entities including al Qaeda, ISIS/Daesh, Lashkar-e-Taiba, Jaish-e-Mohammad and their proxies.

The two sides also shared serious concern over North Korea's nuclear and missile programmes and over the situation in Myanmar and its regional impact. They called for a just and lasting peace in Ukraine and expressed their mutual support for each other's candidature for a permanent seat in a reformed UNSC.

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

ADVERTORIAL

Atrial Fibrillation: India's New Silent Cardiovascular Challenge



Dr. Dhanunjaya Lakkireddy

Executive Medical Director, Kansas City Heart Rhythm Institute, and President-Elect, Heart Rhythm Society

As a physician trained in India and now practicing globally, I have witnessed extraordinary progress in cardiovascular care. Yet one major threat remains underrecognized across India - Atrial Fibrillation (AFib).

AFib is the most common sustained arrhythmia worldwide and a major driver of stroke, heart failure, and healthcare burden. In India, the disease is evolving. As rheumatic heart disease has declined, AFib has not. Instead, non-valvular AFib is rising, driven by aging and increasing rates of hypertension, diabetes, obesity, and coronary artery disease.

We are only seeing the tip of the iceberg. Many patients remain undiagnosed until they present with stroke or heart failure. AFib can remain silent for years, and symptoms are often dismissed. In contrast to coronary artery disease, where awareness and infrastructure support early intervention, AFib has not received the same urgency.

The consequences are significant. AFib increases stroke risk five-fold and is associated with disability, mortality, heart failure, and cognitive decline. It is not simply an electrical disorder of the heart. It is a systemic disease.

Despite this, treatment and optimal AF care remain inadequate. Barriers include:

- | | | | |
|--|--|---|--|
| 01 Limited awareness among patients | 02 Delayed diagnosis and late referrals | 03 Variable use of anticoagulation despite stroke risk | 04 Dependence on amiodarone with long term toxicities |
| 05 Limited Electrophysiology workforce and training | 06 Geographic disparities and limited access outside metros | 07 Reimbursement limitations and financial barriers | 08 Low penetration of catheter ablation therapy |

We now have an opportunity to change this. The introduction of pulsed field ablation (PFA) in India represents a meaningful advance. It is one of the most important developments in cardiac electrophysiology, using controlled electrical energy to selectively target cardiac tissue while minimizing collateral damage. PFA – especially when integrated with 3D mapping and minimal fluoroscopy workflows – can help standardize procedures, improve safety, and reduce variability, enabling wider adoption of AFib ablation beyond specialized centers.

Recognizing this potential, I have focused my efforts on advancing AFib care in India over several years, working with leading institutions and electrophysiologists to build expertise, expand training, and develop programs and regional centers of excellence. But this is only a beginning.

Addressing AFib will require coordinated action. Earlier detection, greater awareness, improved access to evidence-based therapies, expanded electrophysiology capacity, and modernized reimbursement are essential. We must also accelerate adoption of technologies such as PFA that can safely scale care.

Most importantly, we must stop viewing AFib as a benign condition and recognize it for what it is. A major public health challenge.

India has overcome healthcare barriers before. The tools, expertise, and evidence already exist. What matters now is collective action.

The future of cardiovascular health depends on it.

Disclaimer: The views and opinions expressed by the Surgeon is based on his independent professional judgement. The information provided is for general awareness only and not intended to be relied upon as medical or other advice. Please consult your respective Doctor for any medical advice.

Issued in the public interest by Dr. Dhanunjaya Lakkireddy

Board marks may get 50% weightage in admissions — now based on NEET, JEE

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 1

BOARD EXAMS may get 50% weightage in crucial admissions, which are presently based on scores of entrance exams such as NEET and JEE, according to sources.

The possibility is being contemplated with an idea of reducing the high-stakes nature of any exam, be it entrance tests for medical and engineering admissions or board exams.

The move comes after a series of anomalies in the examination system, including evaluation errors and paper leaks, have kick-started a debate on the credibility of the system.

“The changes being contemplated are 50% weightage for board marks in admission/merit, closer alignment of entrance tests with school syllabi to reduce dependence on coaching centres, multiple attempts and a gradual shift towards adaptive on-demand computer-based tests,” a

At present, medical and engineering admissions are based on entrance test scores

source said.

At present, medical and engineering admissions are based on entrance test scores and candidates are required to score a qualifying percentage in board exams to be eligible for the entrance exams.

The reforms are being considered by the Ministry of Education's nine-member committee set up last year to examine students' dependence on coaching, the spread of “dummy schools” and fairness in high-stakes entrance tests.

The panel's final report is likely to be submitted to the government in the coming weeks.

PUBLIC NOTICE

BEFORE THE LEARNED SOLE ARBITRATOR

Under the aegis of Delhi International Arbitration Centre (DIAC), Delhi High Court, New Delhi

Arb. P. No. ARB-P/1788/2024
Case Ref. No.: DIAC/11492/09-25

IN THE MATTER OF:
Scholar Alley Private Limited

...Claimant

Versus

Ms. Sweety Sahni & Ors.

...Respondents

To,
Mr. D.P. Singh, Dilshad Colony, New Delhi-110095

And
M/s Nidhi Builders, Dilshad Colony, New Delhi-110095

Whereas the above-captioned arbitration proceedings are pending before the Learned Sole Arbitrator under the aegis of Delhi International Arbitration Centre (DIAC), you are hereby informed that vide order dated 11.05.2026, the next date of hearing in the matter has been fixed for 06.07.2026 at 03:00 PM through Video Conferencing or Physically.

You are hereby called upon to appear before the Learned Sole Arbitrator on the aforesaid date and time, either personally or through duly authorised counsel/representative.

In case of your failure to appear, the matter shall be proceeded with in accordance with law and appropriate orders may be passed ex parte.

For Scholar Alley Private Limited
Contact:- +91 95822 17080

Maharashtra Airport Development Company Ltd.
(CIN U45203MH2002SGC136979)

RECRUITMENT

Appointment of Consultant (Aviation) on Contract basis

MADC invites application from the eligible candidates for the post of "Consultant (Aviation)" on contract basis.

The detailed advertisement can be seen / downloaded from the website www.madcindia.org from **03.07.2026** on 10.00 hrs.

Sd/-
Vice Chairman and Managing Director

International Institute for Population Sciences
(Deemed to be University)
An Autonomous Organization of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India
Govandi Station Road, Deonar, Mumbai - 400088.
Contact Details: Tel: 91-22-42372468
Email: admission@iipsindia.ac.in In Website: www.iipsindia.ac.in

ADMISSION ANNOUNCEMENT – ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-2027

All the aspiring candidates are hereby informed that the last date for admission to PG, Ph.D. & PDF programmes has been extended upto 15-07-2026 (11.00AM.). For more details, please visit: www.iipsindia.ac.in

Director & Senior Professor

verka

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Notice Inviting Tender www.verka.coop

e-Tenders are hereby invited for the purchase and supply of following items:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Head office, Chandigarh Dry Fruits i. Badam ii. Kaju 4 Pc iii. Kishmish iv. Pista v. Elaich	Annual/ 6750 kg 22680 kg 2000 kg 1800 kg 2960 kg
2.	For Verka Sangrur Dairy Fresh Cut Firewood	500 MT

NOTE:
1. For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & eTendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.
2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only.

General Manager (Purchase)

Pamphlets with BJP leaders' photos spark row amid SIR

Bengaluru: A political controversy broke out in Jayanagar area of Bengaluru, Karnataka after the Congress accused the BJP of distributing pamphlets featuring prominent party leaders while registration for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) was underway. In a letter to the authorities, former Congress MLA Soumya Reddy has alleged that a BJP-appointed Booth Level Agent (BLA) was caught distributing pamphlets alongside a government-appointed Booth Level Officer (BLO).

The incident came to light after a video purportedly showing a man, identified as Chandrashekar Patil, distributing pamphlets carrying photos of some BJP leaders went viral on social media. He was accompanied by BLO D P Soumya.

The pamphlets carried images of senior BJP leaders including Bengaluru South MP Tejasvi Surya, Jayanagar BJP MLA C K Ramamurthy and former corporator of Jayanagar East Govind Naidu. ENS

FORM NO. INC 26
BEFORE THE REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION BENCH, MINISTRY OF CORPORATE AFFAIRS, GOVT. OF INDIA, NEW DELHI
[Pursuant to rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]

Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of registered office of the company from one state to another BEFORE THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT (REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION) In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of M/s MEGMEET ELECTRICAL INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED Having its Registered Office At PNo 140/7 IMT Manesar, Gurgaon, Gurugram, Haryana, India, 122052 India.

.....Petitioner

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the company proposes to make application to the Central Government under section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Annual General Meeting/ Extra ordinary general meeting held on 22.06.2025 to enable the company to change its Registered Office from "State of Haryana" to "State of Uttar Pradesh"

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION BENCH, MINISTRY OF CORPORATE AFFAIRS, GOVT. OF INDIA, 8-2 WING, 2ND FLOOR, PT. DEENDRAYAL ANTYODAYA BHAWAN, 2ND FLOOR, CGO COMPLEX, NEW DELHI-110003 within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company with a copy of the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

BY THE PETITIONER AND ON BEHALF OF FOR MEGMEET ELECTRICAL INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED

Sd/-
RAVINDRANATH DIXIT (DIRECTOR)
DIN: 10908896
Address: C/o Chaula Ravindranath Dixit, M-405, Swagat Flamingo, Nr. Sargam Cross Road, Ganshi Nagar, Gandhi Nagar-382421.
Date:-02.07.2026
Place:- Gurugram



Past Connection

UNION MINISTER Hardeep Singh Puri and Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan took a trip down memory lane recently when the latter called on the career diplomat at his office. During the meeting, Puri, a former IFS officer, recalled his days as Joint Secretary in the Indian Navy when he was on deputation to the Ministry of Defence from 1994 to 1997, said sources. Admiral Swaminathan realised that while they did not serve simultaneously, both he and Puri worked closely with former Vice Admiral Suresh Bangara (ret'd) during their public careers. In a post on X following the meeting, Puri said the two discussed ways to further strengthen the association between the Petroleum Ministry and the Indian Navy HQ.

On Block List

A FORMER Congress leader who had quit the party in the run-up to the Bihar Assembly elections last year, levelling allegations of foul play in ticket distribution, recently visited Delhi and flagged some issues to senior Congress leaders about the party's state unit. Sources said he sought appointments with several senior leaders to explain his side. His repeated requests prompted a top Congress leader, believed to be close to the Bihar leader, to block him on WhatsApp, said the sources, adding that the reaction immensely hurt the former party leader.

Sangh & Census

EVEN AS the Sangh Parivar grapples with the fallout of the alleged Ram Temple donation theft, the RSS has put another issue on top of the agenda for its annual meeting of functionaries — the Census. The RSS on Wednesday announced that its All India Prant Pracharak meeting will be held in Belagavi, Karnataka, from July 10 to 12. Besides reviewing the organisation's centenary-year expansion drive and planning the programmes till Vijayadashmi, the RSS said participants will deliberate on "current circumstances and experiences", specifically mentioning the Census among key issues. The meeting will bring together the RSS's top leadership, joint general secretaries, functionaries from all 46 organisational provinces and 11 regions, besides organisational secretaries of 32 affiliates. RSS Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat will arrive in Belagavi on July 6.

Bypoll for 3 seats, including Nabin's, on July 30: EC

New Delhi: The Election Commission on Thursday announced that by-elections for three Assembly constituencies in Bihar, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat will be held on July 30.

In Bihar, the Bankipur seat was left vacant after the resignation of BJP president Nitin Nabin, who was elected to the Rajya Sabha in April. The other two seats are Datia (MP), which became vacant following the disqualification of convicted Congress MLA Rajendra Bhati, and Manjalpur (Gujarat), which has been vacant since the demise of BJP MLA Yogeshbahi Narandas Patel.

Candidates can file nomination from July 6 to July 12; the date for scrutiny of nominations is July 14 and for withdrawal is July 16. Counting of votes will be held on August 3.

ENS

TMC rebels meet EC; why give them a hearing: Mamata camp

Election Commission seeks responses from both factions by July 6 evening

Asad Rehman & Damini Nath
New Delhi, July 2

THE BATTLE for control of the Trinamool Congress (TMC) played out here on Thursday as the bloc of rebel MLAs met the Election Commission (EC) in New Delhi, even as the Mamata Banerjee-led party questioned the poll body's decision to agree to the meeting.

The EC, later in the day, wrote to both the sides about each other's claims and counter-claims, asking them to submit their responses by 5.30 pm on July 6.

The delegation of 10 rebel MLAs led by the Leader of Opposition in the state Assembly, Ritabrata Banerjee, met Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners (ECs) Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi at the Nirvachan Sadan in the afternoon and claimed they had "over two-thirds majority". After the meeting, Banerjee said, "We are the TMC as we have over two-thirds majority."

The majority of MLAs, councillors, and Zila Parishad members are with us. The CEC and other Election Commissioners gave us a patient hearing. We made our points. We are hopeful that EC will get back to us shortly."

Banerjee said that immediately after a special session of the party on June 22, "we formally gave in writing to the Election Commission of India and physically met ECI in Kolkata; at the time, we had sought an appointment at the Election Commission of India". At the meeting, the rebels removed Mamata Banerjee as chairperson and appointed Arup Roy in her place.

However, TMC's Deputy Leader in the Rajya Sabha, Sagarika Ghose, and senior Lok Sabha MP Saugata Roy questioned the EC's decision to meet the rebels, claiming that only authorised signatories of a recognised political party can seek an appointment with the poll body.

"The Election Commission had informed all political parties that only authorised sign-



Rebel TMC MLAs, led by West Bengal LoP Ritabrata Banerjee (second from left), leave after meeting EC, Thursday. TASHI TOBGYAL

natories can seek a meeting. The AITC did not ask for a meeting. On what basis did the Election Commission grant an appointment to a person expelled by the TMC?" asked Roy.

Ghose accused the EC of acting at the behest of the BJP. "Only authorised signatories can request a meeting with the Election Commission's full bench. Today, a group led by a person expelled from the party has met the full bench. As per the commission's own rules, how did this group get the meeting?" she asked.

Ghose said there was a distinction between a political party and its legislature party. "What is this group that doesn't have a single MP? It got an ap-

pointment with the full bench of the Election Commission only because the BJP and Amit Shah are behind it," she alleged.

"The Election Commission of India has written letters to both Ms Mamta Banerjee and Mr Ritabrata Banerjee regarding the claims and counterclaims by both factions with respect to organisational elections/authorised signatories of All India Trinamool Congress. They have been asked to submit their responses by 5.30 pm on Monday, July 6, 2026," an EC official said.

The party led by Mamata Banerjee had written to the poll body last month after expelling the rebels and informing it about the new list of office-bearers.

FREEZING OF TMC BANK ACCOUNTS

Calcutta HC questions police for 'hot haste' in filing FIR

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, July 2

WITH NO interim relief to the Trinamool Congress (TMC) faction, led by Mamata Banerjee, over the debit freeze of the party's bank accounts, the Calcutta High Court on Thursday questioned the haste with which the police registered an FIR and ordered the freezing of the Opposition party's bank accounts.

The single bench of Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya also directed the manager of the HDFC Bank's Central Plaza branch to disclose the corpus held in those accounts and file an affidavit in this regard by July 8.

The court also directed the Bidhannagar Police to place on record the complaint that led to the registration of the FIR and the investigation so far.

The Mamata Banerjee-led faction had moved the High Court seeking its immediate intervention after three of its party accounts, allegedly containing Rs 440 crore, were frozen by the police.

Following the party's defeat in the Assembly polls, the rebel group of TMC MLAs and leaders had asked the bank to

“What is troubling us is that the complaint is omnibus. No specific allegations were mentioned in the FIR... registered on June 18. And the next day, the bank froze the account.”

JUSTICE SAUGATA BHATTACHARYYA,
CALCUTTA HIGH COURT

freeze the party's accounts, citing "serious dispute" within the organisation.

The rebels also complained to the Cyber Crime unit of Bidhannagar police, seeking a probe into the source of the funds.

A day later, the police registered an FIR and launched an investigation.

During the hearing on Thursday, the Bench observed, "What is troubling us is that the complaint, which was lodged on June 18, is omnibus. No specific allegations were mentioned in the FIR. The FIR was registered on June 18, and the

next day, the bank froze the account. It is bothering us how this happened in hot haste and what material the agency had."

Kishore Dutta, the senior counsel for the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC, told the court that the police registered the FIR based on "suspicion". "They started with three accounts, and now, another five have also been frozen. Based on mere suspicion in a complaint, all transactions have been stopped," Dutta told the court.

Asking whether it would be proper for it to "go into the veracity of the allegations" while the police are investigating the matter, Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya said, "Let the investigation examine that. When the issue is hazy, it will not be proper for us to look into the veracity of charges. An in-depth analysis of the allegations cannot be examined now. Here, no apprehension is expressed regarding arrest. The issue is with three bank accounts... whether it is appropriate to debit-freeze the accounts during an investigation. The effort of this court is to look into what extent the debit-freeze is needed at this stage."

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

PAC MEET ON EDUCATION

CBSE chief not bound to answer House panel queries: Secy response irks Opp members

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 2

A ROW erupted on Thursday during a meeting of the Public Accounts Committee (PAC), headed by Congress MP K C Venugopal, over questions posed to CBSE chairperson Lokhande Prashant Sitaram regarding the conduct of recent examinations and the widespread issues faced by students across the country.

The agenda for the parliamentary panel's meeting on Thursday included a briefing followed by oral evidence from representatives of the Ministry of Education, the Department of School Education and Literacy and the Department of Higher Education on the review of the implementation of centrally sponsored education schemes.

Before any member could question the CBSE chief, Vineet Joshi, the Secretary of the Education Ministry, is learnt to have told the committee that the CBSE chairperson was not bound to answer questions, as the body was not funded by the Centre, The Indian Express has learnt.

This objection drew sharp reactions from several Opposition members on the committee.

Venugopal is learnt to have pushed back, saying the committee functions as a mini-Parliament. He was of the view that

if Parliament had the authority to question the CBSE, the PAC had the same oversight powers. Issues related to the Board were of immense public importance, directly affecting millions of students, and ought to be addressed by the CBSE leadership, Venugopal was learnt to have said.

Trinamool Congress (TMC) MP Kalyan Banerjee is learnt to have backed Venugopal's stance, maintaining that accountability questions regarding students' welfare cannot be sidestepped.

Joshi is learnt to have informed the committee that they would seek the Law Ministry's opinion regarding the questions posed by the committee and its members to the CBSE chairperson.

Several BJP members reportedly supported the officer's claim that the CBSE chairperson cannot answer questions at the committee meeting. They were of the view that since the CBSE was not funded by the government, it was not obligated to respond to inquiries from the committee or its chairperson.

This was the second instance of confrontation during recent parliamentary panel meetings. Last week, the Venugopal-led committee held an intense discussion on the multi-crore Great Nicobar Island (GNI) project.

EXPRESS special

History weighs on Congress in Kerala as it searches for next party chief

Discussions are expected to begin next week after LoP Rahul Gandhi returns to India

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, July 2

THE CONGRESS in Kerala is headed for a fresh round of lobbying among senior leaders, with the party high command expected to begin deliberations on the appointment of the next Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) president. On the organisational front, the Congress has been without a leader at the helm since incumbent PCC president Sunny Joseph openly stated his intention to step down after being inducted into the cabinet.

Congress sources said discussions were expected to begin next week after Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi returns from abroad. "As the party-led government is facing protest from within the Congress as well as the Opposition over policy matters and appointments, there is no leadership to guide the government. After the government came into power, the PCC political affairs committee had met only once," said party insiders.

Congress sources said sev-



If the Nair leaders in Congress — V D Satheesan, K C Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala — battled it out for CM's post after the polls, it is the turn of Christian leaders to fight for the post of PCC.

eral leaders were in the race for the top post. Among the front-runners are MPs Kodikkunnil Suresh, Anto Antony, Benny Behanan, Shafi Parambil, and MLA Mathew Kuzhalnadan. Former MLA Joseph Vazhakkann is also in the running with the backing of Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala.

Sources said Suresh, who served as the working president for eight years, is mainly banking on his long innings and the status of one of the senior-most Dalit leaders in the party. The PCC has never elected a Dalit leader as president.

If the Nair leaders in Congress — V D Satheesan, K C Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala — battled it out for the post of CM after the Assembly elections, it is the turn of Christian leaders to fight for the post of PCC. The incumbent presi-

dent, Sunny Joseph, was appointed state Congress president in May 2025 after the Congress wanted a Christian leader in its state leadership, a move aimed at bridging with the Christian community that had drifted away from the party. Sunny had then succeeded party MP K Sudhakaran, who was made PCC president in 2021 after the Congress lost the Assembly elections back then. The Christian contenders rely upon the Congress tradition of community balancing right from the days of former CMs K Karunakaran and A K Antony.

Congress sources said the stand of AICC general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal would be crucial in deciding the next PCC president. "Chief Minister Satheesan is looking for a PCC president who will

work in sync with the government. His views will be sought while looking for the next candidate," said a source.

During the previous Congress regime from 2011 to 2016, then CM Oommen Chandy had strained relations with Ramesh Chennithala and V M Sudheeran who had served as state Congress presidents. Chennithala had then openly questioned Chandy over not consulting the party on several key policy matters and decisions. The stand of Sudheeran, who had served as PCC president from 2014 to 2016, against the liquor policy had contributed to the bar bribery scandal, which contributed to the defeat of the Congress in 2016. The history of the state Congress president and the Chief Minister pulling in different directions will likely make Satheesan more cautious about the choice for next PCC president.

A section of Congress leaders is already critical of the style of functioning of Satheesan as the CM. On the liquor tax row, Sudheeran has openly come out against the government for not consulting the party.

As the controversy escalated, Satheesan stated that the UDF as well as the Congress would take a call on the policy. Many appointments made by the new government have already drawn flak from the party, with leaders airing their dissent before the media.

J&K Shia leader stopped from boarding flight to Iran, claims son

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, July 2

PROMINENT SHIA leader and Hurriyat Conference executive member Aga Syed Hassan Musavi was stopped from boarding a flight to Iran on Thursday by officials in New Delhi, his son claimed.

Aga Hassan had been invited to Tehran to attend the funeral of slain Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

"He (Aga Hassan) was stopped by immigration officials in Delhi. They told him that he would be allowed to go only on the condition that he does not say anything against India's official stance or talks about the arrests made in Kashmir," Hassan's son Aga Muntazir Mehdi, a PDP MLA, told *The Indian Express*.

"He told them that he was going only to attend the funeral and that he was not going to deliver a speech. However, he refused to agree to their condition," Muntazir claimed.

Muntazir further claimed that immigration officials then seized Hassan's passport and sent a seizure memo to the Regional Passport Officer (RPO) in Srinagar.

Meanwhile, J&K's former CM and PDP president Mehbooba Mufti is travelling to Tehran to attend the funeral. "Mehbooba Mufti will attend the funeral of Iran's Supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei," senior leader of PDP Waheed Para told *The Indian Express*.

AS THE CONGRESS TRIED TO CORNER CM MOHAN YADAV OVER A LAND DEAL, SINGH PUBLICLY CORRECTED A KEY CLAIM, TRIGGERING ROW

The Digvijaya Singh 'fact-check' that left Cong fuming and BJP gleeful

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 2

FOR THREE days, the Madhya Pradesh Congress tore itself apart in full public view over a fact-check by former Chief Minister and veteran party leader Digvijaya Singh that punctured the coordinated Opposition attack on Chief Minister Mohan Yadav over allegations of illegalities in the handing over of land worth almost Rs 500 crore to a trust.

The result was a spectacle rare even by the standards of a party long accustomed to public feuding, as the BJP showered praise on Singh while his own colleagues accused him of sabotaging the party's anti-corruption campaign to protect his son's political ambitions.

By Wednesday, the Madhya Pradesh Congress had gone on a three-day Maun Satyagraha (silent satyagraha), instructing every leader to avoid television debates and giving soundbites

in protest against the media's alleged lack of interest in covering the CM's land deals in Ujjain.

The trouble began on June 24, when state Congress president Jitu Patwari targeted Mohan Yadav following *The Indian Express's* investigation into land purchases by his family and their real estate companies. Patwari alleged that government land worth approximately Rs 500 crore had been handed to a trust called Veer Bharat Nyas for a token sum of Re 1. "Its trustee is Shriram Tiwari, who is the Chief Minister's cultural advisor. On what basis was such expensive land given to this trust?" Patwari had asked.

It should have been a straightforward corruption accusation for the Opposition to press home their advantage. Instead, days later, Digvijaya Singh, a man the BJP has frequently targeted in the past, stood before reporters in Ujjain and, without any apparent co-



Senior Congress leader Digvijaya Singh (L) and Madhya Pradesh party president Jitu Patwari

ordination with his own party's leadership, dismantled the allegation.

"It is being alleged that land worth Rs 500 crore has been rendered to a private trust for Re 1 only. But I have all the relevant papers with me, which establish that the concerned land hasn't been given to any private trust. Instead, the concerned trust is a government trust. I don't speak on any issue without proper research ... There isn't a



dearth of dalals (middlemen) who make false accusations and then earn money," said the veteran Congressman.

The BJP did not let the moment pass.

State BJP media in-charge Ashish Usha Agrawal posted on X that the lifespan of a lie is not long, declaring that the campaign Patwari had tried to present as truth had been deflated by none other than his party's senior leader.

BJP spokesperson Dr Hitesh Bajpai, who has targeted Singh relentlessly over the years, suddenly found something to admire in him, saying the former CM had "shown the mirror" to his own party's leaders. He said while Congress functionaries were making allegations without verifying documents, Singh had at least examined the papers before speaking up.

Huzur MLA Rameshwar Sharma, another BJP leader with a long history of targeting Singh on ideological grounds, joined the chorus, praising him for taking what he called a fact-based position. Singh, he said, had exposed the hollowness of Patwari's allegations, forcing the Congress to confront its own contradictions.

Then came the BJP's most audacious gesture. MLA Pritam Lodhi publicly invited Singh to switch sides, calling him a

"good elderly man" who helps everyone and claiming that his own party was not letting him thrive despite decades of service. Should Singh cross over, Lodhi said, the BJP would treat him "like royalty".

Congress leader Ravi Saxena moved quickly to shut that door. He said Digvijaya Singh's "DNA is rooted in the Congress", described him as a loyal soldier of the party, and said Singh was the kind of leader who kept the BJP "trembling". The BJP, he said, should stop dreaming that the veteran would ever join its ranks. The sharpest blow came from Nidhi Chaturvedi, a Congress general secretary and daughter of former MP Satyavrat Chaturvedi, who used social media to launch a blistering attack on the man widely regarded as the tallest Congress leader in the state.

"When will Congress be freed from 'Naagpash' of Digvijaya Singh. His restlessness,

anger, and indecorous conduct are nothing but a highly inappropriate, distressing, and condemnable step taken out of attachment to his son." In his ambition to seat his son, Jaivardhan Singh, in the position of state party president, he has forgotten what party discipline means," Chaturvedi wrote.

The infighting alarmed the party's old guard. Former state Congress president and ex-Union minister Arun Yadav appealed directly to Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi to intervene, framing the episode as an act of sabotage by unnamed individuals within the party even as the BJP government battled its own troubles.

This was not the ordinary noise of a fractious state unit, but the signal of a possible rupture, at the centre of which was the leader who, for the last three decades, has been considered the last word when it comes to party affairs in Madhya Pradesh.

ADVERTORIAL



Your life revolves around Krishna bhakti simultaneously with haute couture.Could you share briefly how life led you to the path towards Krishna as theme for art and fashion?

Spiritual maturity is an evolutionary journey, which unravels by and by.I can say this from my experience, which is close to a miracle. I wandered like a restless soul in search of that elusive 'divine truth' that took me even to the Osho fold of Acharya/Bhagwan Shri Rajneesh. Osho,after returning from the US, had decided to settle in the quaint and panoramic site on the outskirts of KuluManali,Himachal Pradesh. I followed suit with an idea to establish an ashram near Mussoori and I did so. Yet,that nigglng yearning kept me restless. On the day of the ashram's inaugural, I stood in the precincts of that property built so meticulously by me, giving a final look at all the preparations. The place looked soulless with out Krishna's vibe,so I immediately disposed off the property. That was the moment, in a flash, myyears of unrequited spiritual quest ended.Thecourse of my life changed. In hind sight,I realised that it was divine intervention of Krishna,who showed me the path to my true calling/purpose in life.A sense of detachment and calm settled in. Since then, I was drawn to Brij,the land of Krishna's childhood days.Every visit to the place drew me deeper into the boundless and fathomless depths and ecstasy of 'LOVE' embodied in Krishna. My every action has since been dedicated to HIM and delivered by HIM.

What is the essence of creativity and art?

The power of love is transcendental, manifesting into various facets of expression. Love and only love, therefore, is the essence of creativity that translates into a piece of art. I believe that no art can behold you if it is not guided with love as its catalyst and outcome. In the Indian context,art is complete dedication to that Supreme power, who is known by different names across the country. This sentiment reflects in the countless and incredible art genres that have existed in India foreons/millennia.

How different is India's art scenario as compared to the rest of the world?

Creativity is the physical manifestation of love.This understanding is intrinsic to Indian art, where every creation is dedicated to the Lord.Therefore,the soul of Indian art is far superior to any other country in the world. Western art is seen to thrive because it is packaged attractively and sold with sharper marketing skills, and that to the world's eye looks more successful thanIndian art.On the contrary the sheer reverence and traditional obeisance offered to God before starting any work, is a cultural tradition in India, passed down generations for centuries.This practice has builtan invincible spirit of resilience with standing the toughest of survival challenges in keeping alive India's creative/artistic traditions.

I am fortunate to have travelled extensively across India and the world to the most exotic art centres or lesser-known places that have been the origin of exclusive genres of art forms.Such visits have been very exhilarating experiences while also widening my perspective to all that goes into fashion and art making them unique.

What prompted you to open the art gallery and the response thereof?

A piece of the finest painting can be an owner's pride. Unfortunately, authentic art composed around the theme of Krishna and Radha from Brij, is a rarity. This makes the paintings at our gallery exclusive. Art lovers go for the rare andthe beautiful paintings, be

fittingly complemented by iconography of Krishna and Radha.Irrespective of the price tag they gladly buy the painting to adorn their homes for transforming it into a positive aura or spiritualhaven. Our collection of Krishna Radha are thoughtfully handpicked and un compromisingly authentic attracting many genuine buyer.A piece of the finest painting can be an Our clientele list is impressive and the numbers are increasing by word of mouth. Also, the gallery is aesthetically designed for an immersive experience infused with the divine aura of my favourite deity to whom I offer every success of mine.

In India,which are the most thriving art hubs and what makes them unique?

India is a veritable treasure trove of art and artists. My life is anchored to Krishna bhakti and so the land of Birj is where I go back to again and again in my spiritual and artistic forays. Where there is Krishna, such a place lures me. The exclusive paintings embossed with pure gold work and embedded with gems and semi-gem stoneson display in this art gallery have all been sourced from surrounding villages such asVrindavan,Barsana or Krishna JanmaBhoomi- Mathura (Lord Krishna's birthplace). The way the artists of this region depict Krishna and Radha in their paintings is a style seeped in pure 'samarpan' (surrender) to HIM, which is reflected throughbeautiful motifs on canvas,not found anywhere else in the world. They are exquisite in style and interpretation. We work with some of the best artists and the piece de art that they make are so popular among art



lovers that are soon sold out. Also,my love for the holy Ganges makes Haridwar and Rishikesh, my favourite escape destinations for spiritual rejuvenation.

What is the likeness and difference between art and fashion that you have understood from your experience?

Art and fashion are one and the same.Meaning, the core of both the genres is aesthetics that emanates from love.Only someone who surrender to divine love can create something exquisitely beautiful. Passing the test of the spiritual path ultimately masters the ego.You will note some of the best artists are very humble and bereft of ego. Appreciation for what an artist has created is the firstresponse appreciated and cherished by them. While we deal only in paintings of Krishna



Sunil Mehra - A name worth in gold!

The signature outshines with an elegance that beckons you to step into the understated traditional opulent settings established three decades ago by Founder, Sunil Mehra. An ardent Krishna devotee, the idea of 'Sunil Mehra' emblazoned as hallmark on art collection and fashion apparel bearing Krishna's motif, was inspired by HIS pristine LOVE. The high end, art-cum-couture store at south Delhi's posh Greater Kailash M Block Market is the go-to destination of the elite for collector's item themed on Krishna.

and Radha,our couture line is also generally associated with elements of their imager. When love of Krishna reigns every work stands out for their sublime beauty making them into rare masterpieces.

What are the elemental synergies that you have brought together to make your art gallery unique?

I have never looked at art with the lens of an entirely commercial angle. My objective has been a comprehensive approach where the best of Krishna-Radha paintings adorn homes and offices of people,thereby,infusing a spiritual aura to the place.Yes,I do wish to popularise the paintings of Krishna from Brijbhoomi and their artists,who have dedicated all the talent that they possess in the service of the Lord. They deserve their due recognition and worth for their exceptional talent.

We do just that.This art gallery is a convenient extension of everything under one roof, offering our valuable clients that immersive experience where haute couture and paintings celebrate the spirit of Krishna. Here art and aesthetics created through the medium of spirituality coexist in harmony and thrives.

How has your journey into the spiritual realm helped your progress into high fashion and art?

I can convincingly say that my spiritual journey has been elevating in every sense,improving personal and professional life.It has changed my entire purpose of life, and the perspective about the concept of creativity.

What is the vision you have for your art gallery and the legacy that you wish you establish?

complete trust that if Krishna has put me into it HE will see me through. This complete surrender to HIM is a state of bliss that cannot be translated into words, only the mind and heart knows.

What is the response of the youth to art on Krishna?

This is indeed a strange paradox. The new generations, generally speaking,are not moored to our cultural traditions, yet a visit to Krishna pilgrimage sites/dhams have exhibited an increasing youth population seeking answers for their spiritual queries .

They are also seeking spiritual solace to overcome the stressful work and social environment to thrive.For some youngsters such historical pilgrimage thrive.For some youngsters such historical pilgrimage sites such as Vrindavanare outlets of escapism from inner and external turmoil. They are seeking unconditional love and hand-holding them at this juncture can steer them to love for Krishna and understanding of their life's purpose. I want to depict HIM in a manner that the youth understands all about love through Krishna,who came to this world to spread love. No other deity has said -"Life



I wish,whatever I have built and the concept behind it is carried forward by my son Karan Mehra,who is proactively involved with the art store. He is a very spiritual person and I am sure with experience and time,Karan will mature into a person with more depth of emotion and compassion that form the bedrock of Krishna's unconditional love and the core concept of our venture.

Which are the styles of art genres that you intend to display and promote at the gallery?

I am,however,sure of the fact that whatever I want to do will be in my style and at my pace in interpreting Krishna.Currently,my focus is only on paintings of Krishna and Radha, a love relation that began with me more than three decades ago. I am interested and mulling the idea of venturing out to some fashion hub in Europe in partnership with institutions who are followers of Krishna. HE will open the doors for it to happen, and when it is to happen.

Is only love, and I am love." And that is the crux of my mission which is directed at Krishna bhakti and establishing an eternal bond of love with HIM..

In today's economic volatility,what gave you the courage to set-up an art gallery?

Spirituality is boundless and seamless, so I want to wade through the infinite power of Krishna to explore HIM through the medium of art making everyday a new experience and learning.It takes one way from the mundane and closer to a higher plane of spirituality. There is no place of art like the one we have here in any part of the globe.It's based on an entirely unique concept,which is aimed at initiating a conversation with art lovers,centred around Krishna's pure love.I personally talk to my valued customers about Krishna,revealing his love in its purest form love.I am happy to share that many of them have sought refuge in Krishna and live a better life today.Personally,it's been a satisfying and wonderful journey inspiring me to do more.



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023) Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Babu Khan S/o Badal Khan R/o H.No. 159, 5/13 Mangal Bazar Road Sarita Vihar Mukundpur Part-II North Delhi Also at Khasra No.12/10, Gali No.20, Luskant Vihar Block-D, Burari Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 1607/2022 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Kirti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Babu Khan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Babu Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Babu Khan of CC No. 1607/2022 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Kirti Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.08.2026.**

By order
Anshul Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
(West) Room No. 268,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8857/WD/2026

झारखण्ड सरकार पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सूचना (प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना)

ई-निविदा प्रसंग सं० :- **RCD/GIRIDIH/ 698**

दिनांक :- **29.06.2026**

क्र.	कार्य का नाम	कैबली मोड से तिरंगा चौक (नुरांगी) पथ के नैज 15.562 किमी० में अवस्थित बांसकोडी नदी पर उच्चस्तरिय पुल निर्माण कार्य (पहुँच पथ सहित) वर्ष 2026-27
1.	कार्य का नाम	कैबली मोड से तिरंगा चौक (नुरांगी) पथ के नैज 15.562 किमी० में अवस्थित बांसकोडी नदी पर उच्चस्तरिय पुल निर्माण कार्य (पहुँच पथ सहित) वर्ष 2026-27
2.	प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपये में)	₹0 3,81,21,618.00
3.	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	18 (अठारह) माह
4.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	23.07.2026 12:00 बजे दिन तक
5.	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय	03.07.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न समय
6.	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह।
7.	प्रोक्वोरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क नं०	06532 — 227054
8.	ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट सेल का हेल्प लाईन नं०	0651 — 2401010

अतिरिक्त जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट पर देखें :-

<http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> हो/-

कार्यपालक अभियंता,

PR 383750 (Road)26-27/D पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BALASORE

No:- 2840 /WE, Dt:- 25/06/26
e-procurement Notice

1. Name of the work	:- "Building Works."
1. Estimated Cost	:- As per annexure.
2. Time for completion	:- As per annexure.
3. No of Work	:- As per annexure.
4. Summary for key dates is provided below	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding	Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender	Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Balasore	N.C.B.-No-08 of 2026-27	Dr.06.07.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Dr.21.07.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dr.20.07.2026 at 5.00 P.M.	Dr.22.07.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated latter

Further details can be Seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in
Any other changes/Corrigendums may be seen only in website www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BALASORE

OIPR-25001/25105/1/26-27/0009

बिहार सरकार

समाहरणालय, बक्सर

(राजस्व शाखा)

न्यायालय अपर समाहर्ता सह अपर जिला दण्डाधिकारी, बक्सर में मद्य निषेध अधिनियम 2016 के अन्तर्गत संचालित राज्यसात वाद में संबंधित वाहन स्वामी को अंतिम रूप से न्यायालय में उपस्थित होने के संबंध में।

अल्पकालीन आम-सूचना

बजयिये न्यायालय नोटिस द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 की धारा 56 (ख) के अन्तर्गत अवैध रूप से देशी/विदेशी शराब का परिवहन करने के आरोप में निम्नलिखित वाहन विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जब्त कर अधिहरण— प्रस्ताव पुलिस अधीक्षक, बक्सर/अधीक्षक उत्पाद, बक्सर के माध्यम से प्राप्त होने के फलस्वरूप विधि उत्पाद अधिहरण वाद प्रारंभ किया गया है। नोटिस किये जाने के बावजूद/नोटिस वापस होने के फलस्वरूप इन वाहनों के लिए कोई वादेदारी प्रस्तुत नहीं किया जा रहा है। इस आधार उक्त जब्त वाहन अधिहरण करने योग्य है।

बिहार मद्य निषेध और उत्पाद नियमावली 2023 के नियम 12 (क) (2) में निहित उपबंधों के आधार पर शक्ति (Penalty) की जमा कर वाहन मुक्त कराना चाहते हो तो आम सूचना निर्गत के एक सप्ताह के अंदर प्रप्र-IV में अपना आवेदन पत्र अधोहरताक्षरी के न्यायालय में समर्पित करें। वाहनों की विवरणी निम्नवत है :-

क्र०	राजसात वाद सं०	थाना काण्ड सं०	जब्त वाहन का प्रकार	जब्त वाहन का निबन्धन सं०	परिवहन कार्यालय से प्राप्त सूचना के अनुसार गाड़ी मासिक का नाम व पता	सूचनाई की जगहों तिथि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	TR- 25/2026/79/2026	रामदास राय के डेरा थाना काण्ड सं०- 51/25	Hero HF Deluxe मोटरसाइकिल	HR29AS6372	उपेन्द्र कुमार, पी०-सत्येन्द्र कुमार राय, पता-1254, जीवन नगर गोन्डी, फरीदाबाद, हरियाणा, 121004	10-07-2026

अपर समाहर्ता

—राह—

PR. No. 006836 (District) 2026-27

अपर जिला दण्डाधिकारी, बक्सर

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

योन जनित रोग छुपाओ नहीं ईलाज कराओ,

खुद के साथ अपने जीवन साथी को भी सुरक्षित करें।

बिहार सरकार

समाहरणालय, बक्सर

(राजस्व शाखा)

न्यायालय अपर समाहर्ता सह अपर जिला दण्डाधिकारी, बक्सर में मद्य निषेध अधिनियम 2016 के अन्तर्गत संचालित राज्यसात वाद में संबंधित वाहन स्वामी को अंतिम रूप से न्यायालय में उपस्थित होने के संबंध में।

अल्पकालीन आम-सूचना

बजयिये न्यायालय नोटिस द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 की धारा 56 (ख) के अन्तर्गत अवैध रूप से देशी/विदेशी शराब का परिवहन करने के आरोप में निम्नलिखित वाहन विभिन्न थाना काण्डों में जब्त कर अधिहरण प्रस्ताव पुलिस अधीक्षक, बक्सर/अधीक्षक उत्पाद, बक्सर के माध्यम से प्राप्त होने के फलस्वरूप विधि उत्पाद अधिहरण वाद प्रारंभ किया गया है। नोटिस किये जाने के बावजूद/नोटिस वापस होने के फलस्वरूप इन वाहनों के लिए कोई वादेदारी प्रस्तुत नहीं किया जा रहा है। इस आधार उक्त जब्त वाहन अधिहरण करने योग्य है।

बिहार मद्य निषेध और उत्पाद नियमावली 2023 के नियम 12 (क) (2) में निहित उपबंधों के आधार पर शक्ति (Penalty) की जमा कर वाहन मुक्त कराना चाहते हो तो आम सूचना निर्गत के एक सप्ताह के अंदर प्रप्र-IV में अपना आवेदन पत्र अधोहरताक्षरी के न्यायालय में समर्पित करें। वाहनों की विवरणी निम्नवत है :-

क्र०	राजसात वाद सं०	थाना काण्ड सं०	जब्त वाहन का प्रकार	जब्त वाहन का निबन्धन सं०	परिवहन कार्यालय से प्राप्त सूचना के अनुसार गाड़ी मासिक का नाम व पता	सूचनाई की जगहों तिथि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	TR- 20/2026/7 4/2026	नवा मोअज़्ज़र थाना काण्ड सं०- 85/25	Creta Car	DLSCAP7221	सुरज भाटिया, पी०-मनोहरलाल भाटिया, हाउस नं०-C-1670 जहाँगीरपुरी नॉर्थ स्टेट दिल्ली, नई दिल्ली 110033	10-07-2026

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि यदि कॉलम 05 में अंकित जब्त वाहन/वाहनों में से कॉलम 06 में अंकित वाहन स्वामी अथवा अन्य किसी व्यक्ति/संस्था का हित निहित हो तो उक्त कॉलम 07 में वर्णित निर्धारित तिथि तक स्वयं या कानूनतः अपर समाहर्ता न्यायालय, बक्सर में उपस्थित होकर अपने-अपने वाहन के मासिकाना हक से संबंधित वाद/पत्र व कागजात प्रस्तुत करें। अनुपस्थित होने की स्थिति में यह समझा जायेगा कि उक्त गाड़ी से आपका कोई संरोकर नहीं है। तत्पश्चात उक्त जब्त वाहन को निविदा ई-उत्पाद विहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 की धारा 58 (2) के अन्तर्गत सम्मिलित में अधिहरण कर लिया जायेगा। इसे संज्ञा राखी दृष्टि रखें।

अपर समाहर्ता

—राह—

अपर जिला दण्डाधिकारी, बक्सर

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

PR. No. 006833 (District) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, बिक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है।

इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज करायें, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।

टॉल फ्री नं०- 15545 या 1800 345 6268

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Tender No: EL/50/07/2026-27 Dt. 29.6.2026 Dy. CEE(W), NWFR, Ajmer on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00hrs. on the mention date. 1. Tender No.:- EL/50/07/2026-27 2. Name of work:- Ajmer-Augmentation of Ancillaries shop with load Bearing Covered shed with Solar Panel including CMT lab Improvement and Digitization in HQ and Carriage Workshop Ajmer. 3. Approximate cost:- Rs. 18218436.98/- 4. Earnest money:- Rs. 364400/- 5. Date & Time of closing of E-Tender:- 20-07-2026 at 15-00 Hrs. Date & Time of opening of E-Tender:- 20-07-2026 at 15-30 Hrs. 6. The details of above E-Tender is available on website:- www.irops.gov.in 941-DO/26

Please join us on www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tenders are invited by Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)/Adra, S.E.Railway for and on behalf of the President of India for Electrical works, as per details mentioned hereunder: **Sl. No. & Tender Notice No.; Description of Work; Tender Value : (1) Elect-G-ADA-2026-09, dtd. 24.06.2026;** Electrical work for Improvement of Level Crossing with approach road and rubberised surface of Level Crossing and water supply arrangement & AT supply in Level Crossing Gate under the jurisdiction of (A) Assistant Divisional Engineer/Purulia. (B) Assistant Divisional Engineer/East. (C) Assistant Divisional Engineer/Bokaro Steel City. (D) Divisional Engineer/East/Adra; ₹ 1,05,64,665/-. **(2) Elect-G-ADA-2026-10, dtd. 24.06.2026;** Electrical work for (A) Interlocking of 4 nos. of Level Crossing Gates (BR-67, BR-101, BR-10 & BR-58) in the section of Sr. Section Engineer/Signal/Bankura. [B] Interlocking of 2 nos. of Level Crossing Gates (RC-5 & DK- 2) in the section of Sr. Section Engineer/Signal/Adra in Adra Division; ₹ 34.84,730/-. **(3) Elect-G-ADA-2026-11, dtd. 24.06.2026;** Electrical work for Provision of 07 nos. of Lifts at Bhaga (2 nos.), Madhukunda (2 nos.) and Ondagram (3 nos.) stations over Adra Division; ₹ 17,19,759/-. **The closing date and time of e-tenders are on 17.07.2026 at 12.00 hrs. for each and opening of tenders will be done on 17.07.2026 after 12.30 hrs. for each. Details of the above e-tenders may please be seen at website www.irops.gov.in (PR-410)**

Raja Raghuvanshi murder: SC to hear plea challenging bail to Sonam today

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

THE SUPREME Court will hear on Friday Meghalaya's appeal challenging the bail granted to Sonam Raghuvanshi, who was arrested in connection with the May 23 murder of her newlywed husband, Indore-based businessman Raja Raghuvan-

shi, during their honeymoon in the hill state.

A Shillong court had granted her bail on April 27, saying the grounds of arrest had not been effectively communicated to her. The state's appeal challenging the order was dismissed by the Meghalaya High Court on June 29.

Appearing for the state, Sol-

icitor General Tushar Mehta mentioned the plea challenging the HC order before a bench of Justices M M Sundresh and Sheel Nagu. He told the bench that what is being referred to as failure to communicate the exact grounds is only a typographical error in the memo of arrest wherein Section 403 of the BNS, was mentioned instead of Section 103 of the BNS. Seeking an urgent hearing, Mehta added that there was a chance of the accused absconding if released. The court agreed to list it on Friday.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice (Short Tender Notice)

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/General, North Western Railway, Bikaner for & on behalf of the President of India, invites E- tenders for the following work: 1. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website No. : <http://www.irops.gov.in>. 2. Date & time of closing of e-tenders: 15.07.2026 at 15.00 hours. 3. Date & time of opening of e-tenders: After 15.00 Hrs on 15.07.2026. **Tender Notice No.:- 1-EI-BKN-E-Tend-25-26R, Name of work:-** Electrical work in c/w Construction of 5 staff quarters type-II (2 CRW, 3 JUP) in the jurisdiction of DENVS, replacement of 18 nos. type-II quarters in RTGH-BKN section in the jurisdiction of ADEN/RTGH, replacement of 14 nos. type-II quarters in HSR-SDLP section in the jurisdiction of ADEN/SDLP, replacement of 20 nos. type-II quarters in SDLP-RTGH section in the jurisdiction of ADEN/RTGH and provision of Health unit in lieu of old at Sadalpur & repair in Health unit Churu under ADEN/SDLP over BKN division.. **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):** - ₹ 9526781/- **EMD/SD (in Rs.):** - ₹ 190500/- **Tender Documents cost:- Nil, Tender Notice No.:- 20-EI-BKN-E-Tend-25-26R, Name of work:-** Electrical work in c/w construction of 20 nos. Type-II quarters in lieu existing abandoned quarters in Railway colonies of Suratgarh sub-division under jurisdiction of ADEN/SOG, Provision of Health unit in lieu of old at Suratgarh under ADEN/Suratgarh, Provision of six nos rooms with lat-bath facilities. Gym, Store and repair to door, tiles in existing rooms with color wash and painting in Loco running room at SOG under jurisdiction of ADEN/SOG & Augmentation of freight maintenance facilities at Goods yard, Suratgarh over Bikaner division., **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):** - ₹ 8965564/- **EMD/SD (in Rs.):** - ₹ 179300/- **Tender Documents cost:- Nil**
No. 69-Elect/BKNE-Tender/2026-27 Dt. 30.06.2026 943-DO/26
Please join us on www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in www.irops.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR

(At/Po- Ambapaa, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)

(E-Mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com, Tel No. :-0680-2404287)

No. e-tender // 4526// RWC// BAM // **Dated. 02.07.26**

1st Corrigendum to Bid Identification No. Online Tender/09-2026-27/PMGSY/BPR

In partial modification to above bid Identification for the works under PMGSY-IV (B-I) as stated below.

1. Last Date of availability of tender	::	21.07.2026 upto 5.30 PM instead of 14.07.2026 upto 5.30 PM.
2. Date of opening of Technical Bid.	::	22.07.2026 at 12.00 Noon instead of 15.07.2026 at 12.00 Noon

All other contents will remain unchanged.

Sd/-

Chief Construction Engineer
R.W.Circle, Berhampur

OIPR- 25001/25071/1/26-27/0017

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमंडल, गयाजी

राष्ट्रीय/स्पर्द्धा ई०-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

सिर्फ ई०-निविदा पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर

अति अल्पकालीन ई०-पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या—06/2026—27

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता	— कार्यपालक अभियंता, भवन प्रमंडल, गया जी।
2. निविदा आमंत्रण की तिथि	— दिनांक—30.08.2026
3. प्री-बीड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय	— दिनांक—15.07.2026 को 15:00 बजे अधीक्षण अभियंता, भवन अंचल गयाजी एवं दिनांक— 22.07.2026 नूत्य अभियंता (द०), भवन निर्माण विभाग, पटना का कार्यालय कक्ष।
4. निविदा कागजात प्राप्त करने (डाउनलोड करने) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	— दिनांक—08.07.2026 से 31.07.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक
5. निविदा जमा करने (अपलॉड करने) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	— दिनांक—01.08.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक
6. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय (तकनीकी बीड)	— दिनांक—03.08.2026 को 15:30 बजे केवल वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7. निविदा पत्र बिक्री का स्थान	— केवल वेबसाइट (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर
8. निविदा वैधता की अवधि	— 120 दिन

कार्य की विवरणी

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपये में)	अवधि की राशि (रुपये में)	परिमाण विवरण की राशि (रुपये में)	बीड प्रोसेसिंग राशि + सर्विस टेक्स (रुपये में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1.	गयाजी जिला में नवनिर्मित पी० ओ० अंचल (80 अंचल) के ड्राईंग रूम में पी० ओ० पी० पी०, वाटर इंडरग्राउंड में वाटरिंग एवं पंप/ट्यूबवेल की सेन का अधोस्तरण कार्य। वर्ष 2026-27	₹ 2,42,36,800/-	₹ 4,84,800/-	₹ 10,000/-	As per website	3 Months

नोट — विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए विभागीय वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in/

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कार्यपालक अभियंता

भवन प्रमण्डल, गयाजी

PR- 006884 (BCD) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

नगर विकास प्रमंडल, नूतन राजधानी

पटना नगर विभाग के नूतन राजधानी अंचल क्षेत्र, पटना

NIT NO-01/EMP/NCD/2026-27

SHORT TENDER

Patna municipal Corporation Area invites online bids through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in for following works from the bidders fulfilling eligibility criteria.

S. No	Name Of work	Cost Of Tender (Non- Refundable) Paid Through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	EMD (Paid Through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
01	EMPANELMENT OF AGENCIES FOR CIVIL WORK UNDER ESSENTIAL SERVICES AND FACILITIES FOR CITIZEN SAFETY IN EMERGENCY SITUATIONS under, Patna Municipal Corporation Area.	2,500.00	25,000.00

In case of Bank Guarantee, EMD Shall Be Payable in Favor of " Executive Engineer, NCD- Division Patna Municipal Corporation-Patna" payable at Patna.

Key Dates:

Start Of Online bid : From 12.07.2026(10:00 Hrs.) www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

Pre-Bid Meeting : 12.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. (As per RFP)

Last date Of Online Bid Submission : 22.07.2026 Till 16:00 Hrs.

Technical Bid Opening Date : 22.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.

The Preferred Company/ agencies would be empanelled through a single-stage one -part competitive bidding process based on evaluation of technical proposal. The Bidders are expected to submit their proposal in accordance with the instruction provided in the RFP. Detailed Request for Proposal (RFP) incorporating instruction for submission of bid and other relevant information's is available on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

Amendment/corrigendum to NIT, if any would be published on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only.

Executive Engineer (NCD)

PR. No. 006837 (B&C) 2026-27

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Govt brings stem cell, gene therapies under Central licensing ambit

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 2

THE CENTRAL government on Thursday amended the Drugs Rules, 1945, bringing stem cell derived products, gene therapeutic products and xenografts under the ambit of the Centrally Licensed Approving Authority (CLAA) framework to enhance

Himachal: Five killed as heavy rain triggers flash floods

Press Trust of India
Shimla, July 2

DAILY LIVES were upended as sharp showers lashed several parts of Himachal Pradesh, with five rain-related deaths reported across the state in the 24 hours till Thursday evening, officials said.

Three persons were killed in separate rain-related accidents in Shimla and Chamba districts, while one death was reported in Mandi district, according to State Emergency Operations Centre data. A bus conductor was killed in the Udaipur area of Lahaul and Spiti district after falling stones from a hillside hit him.

Around 30 pilgrims were stranded near a temple in Bharmour as flash floods triggered by heavy rainfall washed away a temporary wooden bridge, officials said. A joint search and rescue operation involving the NDRF local administration, a mountaineering institute and the PWD, was launched. “...The rescue team has reached the site and essential supplies have been sent to the stranded pilgrims,” said, Bharmour Sub-Divisional Magistrate Vikas Sharma.

AFTER DONATION THEFT PROBE

Pocketless uniforms, multiple checks at Ram Temple’s counting centre

Maulshree Seth
Ayodhya, July 2

UNIFORMS, REPEATED frisking, and monitored breaks for counting agents: Several security measures have been introduced at the Pilgrim Facilitation Centre (PFC) inside the Ram Temple in Ayodhya after allegations of theft and embezzlement of donated funds and valuables blew up last month.

Located 200 metres from the main temple, the PFC holds a counting room in the basement where collections from the 35-odd donation boxes from across the shrine premises are brought and counted. Counting is done in two shifts — roughly 8 am to 2 pm, and 2 pm to 8 pm — by about 20 tellers each.

Eight men — Avinash Shukla, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav, and Subhash Srivastav — have been arrested so far. Tinnu used to work as a driver for Champat Rai, general secretary of the Shri Ram Jannabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust. Srivastav, a retired bank employee, was in charge of the donation counting shifts while the other six were involved in counting work.

The most visible change is the new protocol for counting agents. They now have uniforms: a sky-blue, pocketless gown with a chain around the neck to be worn only inside the counting area. A dedicated changing room has been set up, where agents can change before entry and before heading home.

An official, on condition of anonymity, said counting agents from both shifts have to

Man falls in open manhole & dies in Mumbai, 4 officials suspended

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, July 2

A 55-YEAR-old man died after falling into an open manhole in Mumbai’s Saki Naka Thursday while civic workers were installing a protective grill around it. CCTV footage showed the worksite had no barricades or warning signs, prompting Municipal Commissioner Ashwini Bhide to suspend four officials, order the blacklisting of the contractor and institute a high-level inquiry.

The incident took place around 10.30 am when BMC-appointed labourers were installing protective grills at a manhole portal on Khairani Road. Following the mishap, Mumbai’s municipal commissioner Ashwini Bhide suspended four civic officials, including an assistant municipal commissioner.

The victim, Aslam Isak Shaikh, was a resident of Saki Naka’s Yadav Nagar area. He was returning home from his workplace at Saki Naka when he slipped into the manhole. CCTV videos of a nearby hotel showed that while the civic workers were carrying out the work, no bar-



The site where Aslam Shaikh died. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

riers were installed at the worksite — a violation of the civic body’s safety norms. “The victim was walking on the road, while he was speaking on his phone. Our workers warned him stating that there is work going on. But he didn’t listen to us and went ahead, falling into the manhole,” a civic official said on the condition of anonymity.

Following this, the site workers lowered a ladder to trace the victim; however, the body couldn’t be traced immediately owing to the heavy water cur-

rent. Shaikh’s body was later recovered from a stormwater drain outfall near SJ studio at Saki Naka around 1 pm following which the first responders transferred it to Rajawadi hospital where he was declared dead. The outfall was 1 km away from manhole pit where Shaikh fell.

Shaikh is survived by his son, Ali Akbar (21), wife Anjum (50) and elder daughter Shabnam (24). Shaikh was the sole breadwinner of the family and the incident left the entire family in a state of distraught.

The incident came a month after Bhide chaired a meeting where she directed all ward officials to install protective grills on manholes and open drains in Mumbai on a priority basis as part of pre-monsoon preparedness. The meeting was chaired on May 20 and the BMC’s deadline for finishing its pre-monsoon works stands at May 31.

Meanwhile, within hours after the incident, Bhide suspended four officials from Mumbai’s 11 wards which is responsible for the local administration of Andheri East (Saki Naka) and Chandivali areas.

The suspended officials include assistant municipal commissioner Dhanaji Herlekar, assistant engineer (sewerage operations) Uttam Patil, junior engineer (maintenance) Abhijit Chougule and assistant sub Engineer Deepak Chougule.

Bhide has also directed officials to blacklist the contractor which was executing the job. Issuing a statement the civic administration said that preliminary findings indicate that the contractor had not put in place adequate safety measures or barricades around the worksite.

17-year-old dies of electrocution on housing society premises

Thane: A 17-year-old girl died due to electrocution while walking through rainwater collected near the gate of her housing society in Mumbai, police said.

Police registered a case against the officials of Torrent Power Limited for alleged negligence, an official said on Thursday. The incident took place around 8.30 am on Wednesday when Alia Mohammad Sajid Chandiwabila, a resident of Yasmin Apartment, Kadar Palace in Kausa, stepped out of her house.

As she approached the building’s main gate, she received a severe shock, due to a live wire coming in contact with the water that had collected at the spot, and collapsed.

She was rushed to the nearby Bilal Hospital but doctors declared her dead upon arrival, police said.

Further probe was underway, the official said. PTI

• BRIEFLY



Crushed tractors and debris lie at the site after a massive rock collapsed at a stone quarry in Bengaluru, on Thursday. PTI

KARNATAKA

7 labourers dead, 6 injured as stone quarry collapses in Bangalore

AT LEAST seven migrant workers were killed and six others injured after a portion of the rocky mountain collapsed at a quarry on the Bengaluru outskirts Thursday morning. The state government has sought a report on the accident. Police said the accident occurred around 7.30 am at the Kaveri Jelly Crusher in Bengaluru South taluk. According to the police, around 15 to 20 workers, mostly migrants, were present at the site of the incident. Personnel from the Tavarekere police station and senior civil administration officials rushed to the scene and launched search-and-clearance operations. Police, the quarry belongs to one Anandaswamy, who has been taken into custody for questioning. ENS

Mizoram: Three killed, 2 injured in car crash

AT LEAST three people were killed and two others were injured after a speeding car rammed into a stationary truck in Mizoram’s Kolasib town on Thursday, police said. The accident occurred around 2 am on NH-306, when the car was travelling towards Aizawl, they said. The car, crashed into a truck parked along the roadside, a police officer said. The impact was so severe that the truck was pushed more than 50 metres. Two occupants of the car were rescued alive, while the bodies of the three others trapped inside the vehicle were retrieved, the officer added. PTI

Man, 5-year-old son murdered in TN’s Tirunelveli

A MAN, 40, and his son, 5, were brutally murdered by an armed gang on the Kallidaikurichi-Tirunelveli highway Thursday, police said. The assailants hit the rear of a two-wheeler of the victim, Kalimuthu, with a car, causing him to fall. They attacked and decapitated him; his head was found abandoned in a bag on the road, a police official said. Kalimuthu’s younger son was murdered and his elder son, 15, sustained injuries, the official said. Police suspect previous enmity to be the cause and an initial probe revealed the attackers were also from the victim’s village. PTI

EXPRESS special

In Chhattisgarh’s Hasdeo forests, ministry’s green nod for coal mining in Kente block

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, July 2

IN CHHATTISGARH’S Hasdeo-Arand forests, the Environment Ministry has accorded environmental clearance for mining in the Kente extension integrated coal block, with a projected production capacity of 9 million tonnes of coal per annum. The environmental clearance (EC), issued on June 24, comes close on the heels of the in-principle forest clearance granted for the integrated open cast mining and washery proposal. The ministry’s sectoral expert appraisal committee on coal mining had recommended EC for the project in January 2025. The grant of final EC, though, was linked to the in-principle forest approval, which was issued on June 9.

This is the third major coalfield that has been granted clearance in the Hasdeo forests. Parsa and Parsa East Kente Basan (PEKB) open cast mines are already operational in the forests — once earmarked as a no-go zone for mining to protect forests and wildlife.

The Kente extension coal block, spread over 1,760 hectares in Surguja district, was allotted to Rajasthan Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Ltd in 2015. The Adani Group is the mine developer and operator. Coal extracted from this mine will be transported to Rajasthan to feed the Chhabra and Suratgarh coal plants.

The clearance comes even as a 2021 biodiversity assessment by the Wildlife Institute of India (WII) for the larger Hasdeo-

E. EXPLAINED

Central India’s green lungs

THE HASDEO-ARAND forests are considered Central India’s green lungs. They are home to around 640 plant species and nine schedule-1 wildlife species, which are accorded highest legal protection. About 40-50 elephants are known to use the forests overlapping with the coal field area. Also, the forest is a catchment for Hasdeo river which joins the Mahanadi.

Arand coalfield (HACF) had stated that no mining should be carried out in the forests there, except in the already operational Parsa East Kente Basan mine, due to the activity’s likely impact on biodiversity.

The coal-bearing areas of the HACF, spread over 1,502 sq km, are one of the largest unfragmented forests in Central India, consisting of pristine Sal and teak forest, which are rich in floral biodiversity and are home to elephants and leopards besides providing an important corridor for tigers and other mammals.

The Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education had said in the biodiversity assessment done with WII that the case of Kente extension may be decided with strict environmental safeguards related to surface water management and

biodiversity conservation measures, considering the presence of very dense and moderately dense forest cover, and occurrence of wildlife.

Local tribal communities and the Congress have opposed Chhattisgarh’s push for the proposal and Centre’s approvals, citing the large-scale deforestation entailed in coal mining. As per official documents, 1,742.6 hectares of forest land will be diverted for the purpose. Felling of 4.48 lakh trees is proposed, but only in phases, and subject to coal requirements. In the first phase covering five years, close to 98,000 trees are to be felled. Of these, nearly 60,000 trees will be felled from the sixth to 10th year of the project. The Chhattisgarh government has been directed to translocate 67,414 trees below 60 cm girth and fell trees strictly in a phased manner.

The project will affect 56 families in Kente, Basan, Chakeri and Parogia villages in Surguja’s Udaipur tehsil. They are to be rehabilitated as per the state government-approved relief and rehabilitation plan.

Impact on flora, fauna

In 2017, the Environment Ministry’s forest advisory committee had granted in-principle approval for prospecting of the coal in the Kente extension coal block, with the condition to include a biodiversity assessment study. This assessment, by ICFRE, in consultation with WII, had said that mining related land-use changes will have a negative impact on forest cover and density.

INS Trikand foils piracy attempt on merchant vessel in Gulf of Aden

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 2

INDIAN NAVY commanders promptly responded to a piracy attack on a merchant vessel in the Gulf of Aden on Wednesday, ensuring the safety of 21 crew members on board, including one Indian national.

According to the Navy, *INS Trikand*, a stealth frigate deployed for missions in the Gulf of Aden, intervened during the piracy attempt on the *MV Golden Arsenal*, a bulk carrier registered under the flag of St Vincent and the Grenadines. A boarding team conducted a thorough inspection of the vessel and neutralised any threats the crew might have faced. The merchant vessel was transiting from Aden, Yemen, when it reported an attempted pirate attack approximately 300 nautical miles east-northeast of Djibouti. *INS Trikand*, which was on a mission in the area, was directed to intercept the vessel.

Unprecedented security in place as the first batch of Amarnath pilgrims arrive in Kashmir

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, July 2

AMID UNPRECEDENTED security arrangements, this year’s first batch of nearly 5,000 Amarnath pilgrims arrived in the Kashmir valley on Thursday.

The pilgrims were welcomed by senior security and civil officials at Qazigund in south Kashmir immediately after they crossed the Navyug tunnel, which connects the Kashmir Valley with the Jammu region.

Early on Thursday morning, Lt Governor Manoj Sinha had flagged off the first batch of pilgrims from Jammu. They reached in Qazigund by around noon. The pilgrims were welcomed at Qazigund by Deputy Inspector General (DIG) of Police, South Kashmir; DIG Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF); Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP), Kulgam; and other senior civil and security officials.

Officials said the first batch comprised 4,822 pilgrims, including 816 women, who will take the journey to the Hima-



Pilgrims of the first batch for the annual Amarnath Yatra undergo security checks as they arrive at the Nunwan Base Camp, in Pahalgam, Anantnag district, Jammu and Kashmir, on Thursday. PTI

layan cave shrine through the twin routes that go through Pahalgam and Baltal.

While 2,510 pilgrims will take the traditional Pahalgam-Chandanwari-Amarnath route, 2,312 pilgrims will take the shorter Sonamarg-Baltal-Amarnath route. From Qazigund, the pilgrims moved towards the twin base camps of Nunwan in Pahalgam and Baltal. On Friday morn-

ing, they will commence the onward journey to the cave shrine.

The traditional Pahalgam route is an arduous trek that takes three days to reach the cave shrine on foot, palkis, or ponies. The Baltal route is a shorter 14-kilometre trek that allows pilgrims to return in a day.

For the second year, the Shri Amarnath Shrine Board (SASB) has decided not to run the heli-

copter service to the cave shrine after the government declared the two routes as “no-fly zones” as a security measure.

This year, an unprecedented security apparatus has been put in place for the Amarnath yatra, which is the biggest annual security exercise in Jammu and Kashmir. The multi-layered security apparatus includes no-fly zones along the twin yatra routes, watch towers to keep vigil and real-time monitoring of vehicular movement.

The J&K Police issued tamper-proof QR code-based identity cards to service providers, including pony service operators, as part of improved security. The identity cards, when scanned, will provide complete information about a service provider.

Security agencies will be monitoring, in real time, the movement of pilgrim convoys through a network of CCTV cameras setup across the twin routes. The government has also issued RFID tags for vehicles, pilgrims and the service providers.

‘I can keep a thousand husbands’: MP HC calls it ‘grave provocation’

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 2

A WIFE’S remark that she could “keep a thousand husbands” like her own amounted to an indirect attack on his worth and dignity, the Madhya Pradesh High Court said as it reduced a man’s life sentence for the killing of his wife to seven years.

A Division Bench of Justices Vivek Agarwal and Avinandra Kumar Singh observed that the remark constituted “grave and sudden provocation” capable of depriving a person of self-control, though it upheld the finding that the husband was responsible for his wife’s death.

“Similarly, when a wife refers to her husband that ‘she can keep a thousand husbands like him’, it is [an] indirect/oblique reference to [the] worthlessness of the husband, meaning he has no value as a human being or a husband. Therefore, it can be termed as a sudden and grave provocation,” the Bench said.

The case arose from the killing of a seven months pregnant

A Division Bench of Justices Vivek Agarwal and Avinandra Kumar Singh observed that the remark constituted “grave and sudden provocation” capable of depriving a person of self-control

woman in Chhindwara district in July 2021. According to the prosecution, the husband informed both the victim’s relatives and the police that he had killed his wife with a stone after she allegedly made the remark during an argument. Evidence showed she died from multiple injuries, including fractures to her ribs and sternum.

While affirming the conviction for culpable homicide not amounting to murder, the high court said the evidence did not establish a premeditated attack.

It noted that the accused had used a stone found at the spot, immediately informed the police and the victim’s family, and made no attempt to conceal the offence. The Bench also found that the prosecution had not proved repeated blows with multiple stones, observing that only one stone had been seized and subjected to forensic examination, while some injuries could also have been caused by sharp-edged stones.

Concluding the facts did not attract Section 304 Part I IPC, the Bench altered the conviction to Section 304 Part II. “Considering the overall facts and circumstances of the case, while maintaining the conviction for culpable homicide not amounting to murder, we find that the case would not fall under Section 304 Part I of IPC but would fall under Section 304 Part II of IPC,” the court held, sentencing appellant to seven years’ rigorous imprisonment and imposing a fine of Rs 1,000, with an additional one year of rigorous imprisonment in default of payment.



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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

On winter air, Delhi does the right thing

THE DELHI government has done the right thing in framing a pollution control strategy at least five months before the city's air quality assumes crisis proportions. It comprises most elements of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) that have so far guided the NCR's approach to containing winter smog. But unlike in the past, when administrators would wait for the Air Quality Index (AQI) red alerts to impose restrictions, curbs on vehicles and construction activities will come into force from November 1 and continue for the next three to four months. Delhi government and private offices will operate with 50 per cent in-person staff attendance. This proactive approach would allow workplaces and business establishments to redesign work-flows, stagger employee attendance, invest in digital infrastructure and make transport arrangements before the pollution season begins. The plan addresses criticism that Delhi's pollution control authorities spring into action only after the foul air precipitates a public health emergency.

That said, bans and restrictions should not be part of a long-term pollution control strategy. Cleaning up Delhi's air will require creating a governance framework that rewards sustained reductions in emissions. Measures to implement the remote working directive, for instance, will need to be framed in a language of people's well-being and public health, not coercion. Policymakers will also be well advised not to treat Work From Home as a substitute for clean commuting. Delhi's recently-framed EV policy is a notable step in this direction. At the same time, reducing congestion on the capital's roads calls for sustained investment in reliable and interconnected public transport. The Delhi government has increased its fleet of electric buses, and the Metro has improved urban mobility to a great extent, but last-mile connectivity remains weak across many neighbourhoods.

The winter plan should, therefore, be part of a multi-pronged pollution control strategy. In recent years, experts have underlined that the national capital is part of a larger airshed with a chronic pollution problem. Delhi's air quality is influenced not just by activities in the city and its neighbourhood, but the toxic smog that engulfs the city in winters is also fed by biomass burning and industrial and transport sector emissions in an area stretching from Punjab in the north to Bengal in the east. In fact, most Indian cities fail to meet the national ambient air quality standards. The capital's decarbonisation plan should, therefore, be part of a larger project to ensure that people across the country breathe clean air. The Delhi government has taken the first step. Other states, too, need to get their act together — the Centre needs to guide and handhold them.

Delhi-Tokyo ties face the future

JAPANESE PRIME Minister Sanae Takaichi's visit to India this week comes in a time of growing uncertainty over the US approach towards China and the Indo-Pacific. While the first Donald Trump administration adopted a confrontational policy towards Beijing and invested in building regional coalitions to contain its rise, Trump 2.0 has favoured transactional one-on-one engagement over coalition-building. The Pentagon's decision to revert the Indo-Pacific Command (INDOPACOM) to its original name, Pacific Command (PACOM), the 2025 National Security Strategy's narrow conception of core US interests in the Indo-Pacific, and the recent Trump-Xi summit have all fuelled concerns about Washington's reliability as a long-term partner for Asian countries wary of China. Against this backdrop, summit-level talks between PM Narendra Modi and PM Takaichi, less than a year after the former's visit to Japan, further boost the deep-rooted Delhi-Tokyo partnership. Japan's advanced technological capabilities, investment capacity, and growing military power make it uniquely placed to complement India's rise.

Both countries share concerns about China's assertiveness. India has an unresolved border, while Japan has maritime and territorial disputes. Technology is another important pillar of bilateral cooperation. Both countries seek to reduce dependence on Chinese technologies and rare earths. Japan brings capital, advanced manufacturing, and semiconductor expertise, while India offers scale, software talent and a vast market. A coordinated India-Japan strategy can help shape the value chains of the future.

The Indo-Pacific continues to be central to India's economic and security strategy. Whether Washington's recalibration turns out to be tactical or strategic, India must do its part by accelerating its military and technological modernisation while deepening strategic partnerships across the region. A closer partnership with Japan advances both objectives. Preserving a stable, rules-based Indo-Pacific and a favourable balance of power requires India and Japan to emerge as stronger strategic actors.

Waiting for Vaibhav Sooryavanshi

THE WORLD waits for 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi to face his first ball in an international game. Picked for the England and Ireland tour, a reward for his spectacular run on the junior circuit and in the IPL, he has sat on the bench for the first few games. This rising anticipation has bred questions. Should he be treated like just another debutant or does he deserve special treatment? Has Indian cricket drafted him way too early or is this a wise call?

In the days to come, the teenager, born in Bihar's Samastipur, will be facing newer and higher hurdles. In India, a young batting prodigy doesn't just need to beat the best of cricketing brains plotting his downfall in rival dressing rooms. There are other challenges — intense scrutiny of personal life and unrealistic hype. Before the England tour, Sooryavanshi's heated exchange with a Sri Lankan player was clipped from the live telecast, the resultant 15 seconds were put out in public for the world to give sermons. Another day in the life of an Indian cricketing prodigy. After getting hit on the head while dealing with a bouncer during the IPL final, former India pacer Irfan Pathan would write that "the father in me" didn't agree with what he'd just watched.

To its credit, the BCCI has responded: His parents now travel with him, the board covering the cost, an acknowledgment that a cricketer so young should not be alone. It was a thoughtful initiative but not a bullet-proof shield. The board isn't schooling him, or others as young and talented as him, to manage the fame and funds coming their way. Tennis learned this lesson only after losing several of its talented teenagers. Cricket, as usual, has been slow. Throwing a youngster into the deep end isn't a problem but being blind to the sharks is.

Air pollution plan needs political will, not an eye on the election cycle

OVER THE past few years, we have witnessed a troubling disconnect between scientific evidence and policy implementation in the country. First, the weak enforcement of the fuel-ban policy for end-of-life vehicles undermined its intended impact. Then, the draft Electric Vehicles (EV) Policy 2.0 raised serious concerns among environmentalists by proposing to extend EV incentives to hybrid vehicles. While hybrids combine petrol engines with electric motors, they remain dependent on fossil fuels and cannot deliver the full environmental and public-health benefits of zero-emission mobility.

Against this backdrop, the Delhi government's latest initiative marks a step in the right direction by targeting emissions at their source rather than targeting the open sky. It offers renewed hope for sustained improvements in air quality. The push for the EV policy 2.0 might shrink the urban carbon footprint, and the purification of local air could help alleviate concerns over respiratory and other non-communicable diseases that affect a substantial section of the city's population. For the metropolis, which juggles a staggering fleet of over 15 million vehicles, transitioning to electric mobility is no longer just an environmental aspiration; it is a public health imperative.

The Delhi emission inventory database in the National Institute of Advanced Study's (NIAS) 2025 policy brief reveals that the transport sector accounted for 41 per cent of the city's most deadly air pollutant, PM 2.5. Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

in 2024. The new policy will unfold in two phases. Starting January 1, 2027, the city will completely halt the registration of conventional three-wheelers and light goods vehicles, permitting only electric models. From April 1, 2028, only electric two-wheelers will be allowed to register.

Two-wheelers contribute 20 per cent, whereas three-wheelers contribute less than 5 per cent of transport emissions. Currently, almost half of the three-wheelers are already non-fossil fuel, so their contribution is not 17-20 per cent as estimated by earlier studies, including the one by TERI in 2018. So, the overall gain with 100 per cent EV conversion of these three categories of vehicles would be 35 per cent of total transport, which will translate to just 15 per cent of Delhi's PM 2.5 concentration — this is a good initiative, but it won't lead to drastic improvement.

However, a balanced perspective is one of the fundamental requirements of science. Studies conducted by the NIAS show that this policy is merely the first battle in a much larger war. While the present policy is a good start, to truly clear the air, subsequent policies must tackle the two heaviest polluters: Heavy commercial vehicles and buses, which command around 60 per cent of transport emissions. Tackling pollution from their tailpipes could reduce Delhi's PM 2.5 by 20-25 per cent.

The number of commercial vehicles and buses might be low, but their emissions are higher compared to those from two-wheelers



GUFRAN BEIG

While the present policy is a good start, to truly clear the air, subsequent policies must tackle the two heaviest polluters: Heavy commercial vehicles and buses, which command around 60 per cent of transport emissions

Vijaya Mehta gave my words a stage, my creativity a home



MAHESH ELKUNCHWAR

IT HAS been a long association which started in 1970 between a young greenhorn writer and a theatre director and actor of national repute. I started writing in 1967, and my publisher Shri Pu Bhagwat took the risk of publishing my one-act plays in his prestigious *Satyakatha*.

He sent it to Vijaya Mehta, who was training at the Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts (RADA) at the time. "Here is a new voice, see if you like it," he told her, and Vijaya did. She wrote to me from London: "I have been looking for something like this ever since I came here. I am coming back in four months, and I want to do your plays." *Sultan, Holi, Yatana-ghar*, one after another, she produced and directed my one-act plays under the banner of Rangayan.

Before this, I had never sent any of my plays to a director because who would know me? More importantly, how many directors would do a one-act play? But Vijaya had returned from London with many innovative ideas; she had a new bunch of young actors. The atmosphere was just right for experimentation.

A lot of new things had been done even before this, but we needed to do something bursting not only with new ideas but stylistically different. This was the time when the Marathi literary scene was undergoing a sea change.

There was new life in Marathi poetry, short stories and novels, and this vitality spilled over to theatre. B S Mardhekar had revolutionised literary sensibility. Vijay Tendulkar had already started writing, and Vijaya had done one or two of his plays as well.

Rangayan was founded around 1959-60. When I joined hands with Bai, as Vijaya was called, I knew that I had found my home ground. We were not interested in entertaining; fame and money were not even on our radar. We wanted to explore theatre, art and life through our work. And, we did not have a target audience.

The premise we started with was that we were learning something from theatre. So, I would write a play, and she would pick it up, and we would work together on it.

After five or six shows, maximum 10, we said, "Enough of that, we have learned what we can from this one. Now, let's

move on." It was never our ambition to do a hundred shows and reach out to people. Rangayan had about 400 or 500 members — writers, artists, painters and musicians. We got feedback from them, and that helped us grow.

I learned a lot from Vijaya, about the meaning of space and time in theatre, about writing a text for performance. This was not the *guru-shishya* tradition because there is no such thing in theatre. You learn on your own or perish. But I like to call myself Vijaya Mehta's protegee. She would say, "You were never my protegee; I have been your friend." "That's fine, but I'd like to call myself your protegee," I would retort. It was a very beautiful creative togetherness.

Vijaya did about five plays of mine in the beginning. That kind of experimental theatre was appreciated only by a handful of people and did not travel outside Mumbai and Pune, but the elite of the Marathi literary and theatre world got to know about my work because of Vijaya.

Though Vijaya's experimental theatre phase lasted 15 to 20 years, she did not ever completely dissociate from it. Later, when she decided to work in professional Marathi theatre, she brought a fresh approach to the genre as well. A pioneer in many senses, her contribution to Marathi theatre is irreplaceable.

A teacher, guide, philosopher, friend, confidante — she was many things to me. Very few people have lived such a rich creative life as Bai.

She was admired by people all over the world, particularly in Germany, where she did *Shakuntalam* and *Mricchakatikam* in German with German actors. She brought Bertolt Brecht's *The Caucasian Chalk Circle*, adapted as *Ajab Nyaya Vartulacha* to Marathi theatre.

Saying that her death is a big loss will be underrating her contribution, her service to India.

I am going to miss her dearly. She was 91 and ill. I met her about six months ago, and I could see that the end was coming. It was not exactly a shock when the news came, but a loss is a loss, and when it comes, you realise that you are really never prepared for it.

The writer is a Sahitya Akademi award winning Marathi playwright, screenwriter and actor

Trump's Quad retreat opens door for India, Japan, Australia



GURJIT SINGH

THE RELUCTANCE of the US to convene a Quad summit, the decision in Washington to revert to a Pacific Command from the Indo-Pacific Command, and the Donald Trump administration's desire to establish a possible G2 with China have generated concern across the Indo-Pacific. These raise questions about the future of the Quad and the broader vision of a Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP). Yet this may be the moment for India, Japan, and Australia to step forward. The Quad was not intended to be solely an American project. The intellectual foundations were laid largely by Japan, particularly through the vision articulated by Shinzo Abe. India and Australia embraced the idea because it reflected a shared interest in preserving an open, rules-based maritime order, stretching from Africa's eastern coast to the Pacific Ocean.

If US attention fluctuates, the responsibility for sustaining that vision increasingly falls upon the region's leading middle powers. The meetings of PM Modi with Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi yesterday and with Australian PM Anthony Albanese in Australia this month provide an opportunity to show that the Indo-Pacific's future does not depend exclusively on Washington's enthusiasm.

Japan signalled its intention to assume a greater role. Marking 10 years since Shinzo Abe first outlined the FOIP, Takaichi reaffirmed its relevance. Tokyo's updated FOIP focuses on economic infrastructure for the age of AI, resilient supply chains for energy and critical materials, and security cooperation. These are akin to India's own aims. Japan's proposed FOIP Digital Corridor, which includes submarine cables, Open RAN, satellite communications, and advanced optical networks, provides opportunities for collaboration with India and Australia. Australia's growing defence cooperation with Japan also shows how regional powers are trying to reduce reliance on any single external power.

Delhi has long indicated that the Quad is not an Asian NATO and has resisted efforts to transform it into a formal alliance. Strategic autonomy remains central to its foreign policy. But it shouldn't be confused with strategic passivity. A robust India-Japan-Australia framework would allow them to collaborate without depending on an alliance system. India need not be involved in the Taiwan crisis. It can play a bigger role in the Indian Ocean.

Beijing's growing naval strength, economic coercion, aggressive territorial claims, and weaponisation of critical supply chains cause anxiety across the Indo-Pacific. Simultaneously, many ASEAN members remain wary of having to choose between China and the US. This creates a window for India, Japan, and Australia. They are often perceived as partners rather than rivals.

If the Indo-Pacific is to remain free and open, it should be supported by economic integration. Could India apply for the CPTPP? India withdrew from RCEP in 2019 due to concerns about market access and Chinese domination. CPTPP covers Japan, Australia and others, and excludes China. It promotes rules-based trade, investment protection, digital commerce, and supply-chain integration. Strategically, it would place India firmly within the Indo-Pacific economic architecture, reduce dependence on bilateral trade arrangements and augment India's current FTAs. For a larger role in the regional order, India should look beyond security engagements to frameworks that mould trade, investment, technology, and standards.

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

The writer is a former ambassador

The Quad was not intended to be solely an American project. The intellectual foundations were laid largely by Japan, particularly through the vision articulated by Shinzo Abe

40 YEARS AGO

July 3, 1986



Chandigarh deadlock ends

THE SEARCH for a new formula to end the deadlock over Chandigarh has started. The Centre sent feelers to the Akali leadership suggesting alternative proposals to resolve the knotty problem. The initial reaction of the Akalis was not favourable as they did not want to accept any step "outside the Rajiv-Longowal accord". One of the proposals on which the Akali leadership was believed to have been sounded was the retention of Chandigarh as a Union Territory and payment of Rs 400 crore and Rs 300 crore to Punjab and Haryana respectively by the Centre for the construction of new capitals. The other proposal was for the division of Chandigarh in the ratio of 60:40.

World Bank loan for India

INDIA WILL receive a loan worth \$303.2 million from the World Bank this year. The loan, the biggest for any country this year, is to be used for fertiliser production in India. India will also receive another loan of \$132.5 million from Japan, Italy, and Denmark.

Ten killed, 23 extremists held

TEN PEOPLE, including three hardcore terrorists, were killed and at least five injured while authorities captured 23 extremists, three of them trained in Pakistan, during the past 48 hours in Punjab. Three people, including terrorist Balbir Singh, who carried a reward of Rs 50,000, and his accomplice

Ajit Pal Singh, were killed, and three wounded while Punjab Quami Ekta Committee president and Congress (I) leader B K Khullar escaped unhurt.

Language tension defused

THE EXPLOSIVE situation on the Karnataka-Maharashtra border was defused when the Karnataka CM, Ramakrishna Hegde, and a delegation of the Samyukta Maharashtra Seema Samithi, led by M S Joshi and Sharad Pawar, hammered out a formula. The government will withdraw its order on teaching of Kannada in border area schools by the year-end if the Maharashtra Government is able to prove that the directive contains an element of compulsion.



DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

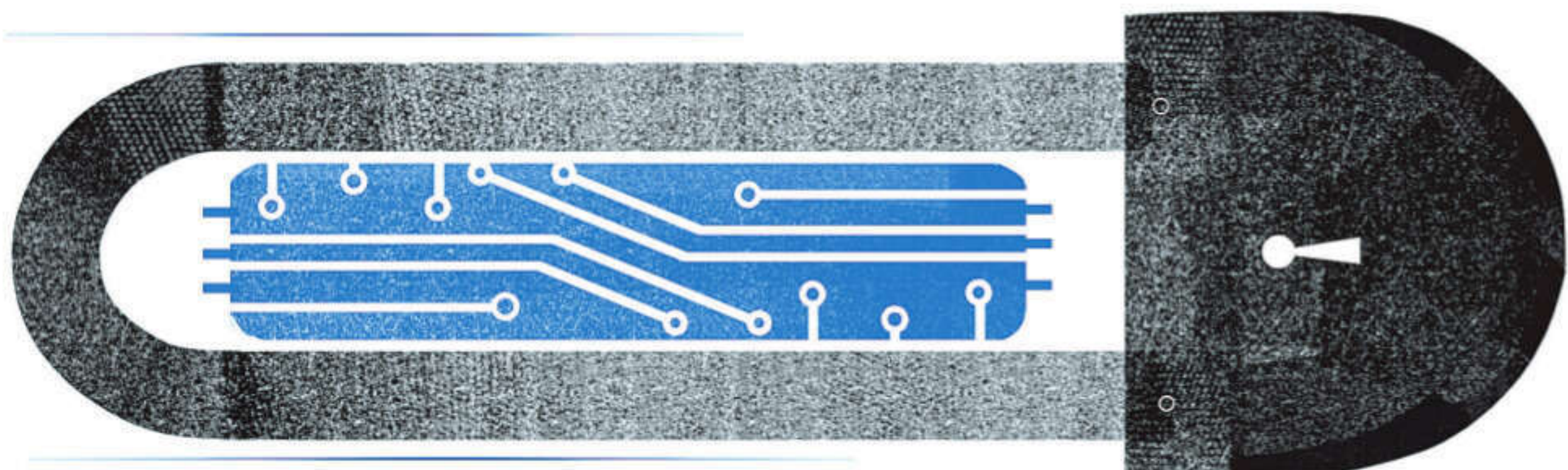


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Is restricting access to frontier AI models turning it into a geopolitical weapon and/or leverage?

Don't bet on an AI trickle-down



Soumya Bhowmick

THERE IS an Adam Smith reading of the present moment: Even as the US tightens its grip on the most advanced chips and models, the invisible hand will, given time, diffuse capability outward, with prices falling and the frontier becoming the floor. The difficulty is the time. As John Maynard Keynes noted of this classical optimism, in the long run, we are all dead. In a domain where capability compounds by the quarter, the long run is the period in which the strategic gap becomes permanent.

This is the harder reading that New Delhi should adopt. AI is being weaponised, and the country that holds the frontier has every incentive to keep it scarce. Modern statecraft has normalised the conversion of interdependence into leverage. We saw it with vaccine nationalism during the pandemic; we are seeing it with the Strait of Hormuz. We see it in critical mineral and rare earth export controls, where processing dominance can be switched on as a weapon. AI is the next and most consequential entry on that list because it is not just one commodity but the general-purpose input to all the others.

The American architecture for this is already built. The 2025 AI Diffusion framework sorted the world into tiers of access and, for the first time, placed AI model weights under export control alongside the chips that train them. That specific rule has since been loosened into a more discretionary, country-by-country regime, but the principle survived and hardened. Its sharpest expression came only weeks ago, when Washington ordered Anthropic to cut off the latest versions of its most capable models, Mythos and Fable, to every user outside the US; the company complied by suspending access for everyone, curbs that have since been lifted from July 1.

At the G7, the pitch to allies was that frontier models would be reserved for “trusted partners.” Read plainly, that means access to the most powerful general-purpose technology of the era is becoming a privilege that Washington can extend or revoke at will. That is not a market trickling outward. It's an arms race with a gatekeeper. Unlike earlier technologies, AI feeds its own outputs back as inputs and reaches into cognition itself, so the leader's edge compounds and a follower's lag hardens into a structural gap.

In my conversations across Washington this month, the same uneasy picture kept surfacing. Neither India nor Europe sits at Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

the frontier of AI development. China, by contrast, has leaned into open-weight models that are cheaper and easier to adopt, which gives much of the world, India included, a powerful commercial pull towards Chinese systems exactly when the American frontier becomes harder to reach. That pull collides with real concerns about data sovereignty, security, and strategic dependence. India risks being squeezed from both ends: Rationed by Washington at the top, courted by Beijing at the bottom, and fully sovereign at neither.

None of this is a case for fatalism, because India is not starting from nothing. It has the demographic ballast its rivals lack: The world's largest population, a median age under 30, and one of the deepest pools of software talent anywhere. But scale is potential, not power, and soft endowments do not substitute for hard capacity. India still buys its chips rather than making them, and the binding constraints are physical: Advanced semiconductors, reliable energy, data-centre capacity, patient risk capital, and the university-to-industry pipelines that turn talent into frontier research.

To its credit, the government has stopped treating this as a private-sector afterthought. The India AI Mission has built a shared national compute pool that has crossed 34,000 GPUs and is scaling further, with subsidies for startups and universities. It has commissioned a dozen indigenous foundation models, and at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi, builders such as Sarvam released competitive open models tuned for Indian languages.

What is still missing is preparation for the contingency this whole episode fore-shadows: A future in which a chip generation or a frontier model is simply switched off for India, as Mythos was switched off for the world. That preparation is partly legal, securing binding guarantees of compute and model access rather than goodwill that expires with an election, and deepening ties with Europe and other middle powers that share the predicament. It is partly industrial, accelerating domestic fabrication, power generation, and data-centre build-out so that sovereignty does not rest on imported silicon. And it is partly strategic patience of the right kind, investing now in the institutions, talent, and capital a frontier capability demands, in the knowledge that this is the one race where catching up later is not an option.

The comforting view assumes a long run in which everything equalises. The weaponisation of AI is the warning that there may be no such long run to wait for, only a sequence of short ones in which advantage is banded or lost. India has the people, a credible start, and a narrow, closing window. The question is whether New Delhi treats that window as a horizon or as a deadline.

The writer is with the Observer Research Foundation (ORF)



Aditi Narayani Paswan

RECENTLY, THERE has been a renewed interest in Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS). When one talks of IKS, one immediately thinks of classical Sanskrit texts. There is no denying the value of these traditions, but our understanding of IKS should also include literature from people at the periphery. Otherwise, we miss the chance to understand the empirical and far more people-centric, democratic branch of Indian philosophy, engineered not by academic elites but by a 15th-century working-class weaver from Varanasi named Kabiradas.

A towering force in India's intellectual history, Kabir fused absolute non-dualism with the practicality of ancient yoga. Through his *nirguna bhakti*, he democratised the search for truth. His life and work

are the ultimate proof of how IKS can be applied in everyday life.

Kabir's contribution to Indian thought was his approach to *pramana* — the philosophical concept of valid evidence and authority. Since ancient times, orthodoxy had clung to *shabda pramana*, which treats scriptural authority and mastery of these texts as the only gateway to the truth. Kabir broke the barrier by replacing scriptural compliance with *anubhuti* — direct experience, making use of the senses. This marked a tectonic shift in how knowledge was understood. For Kabir, knowledge was not an inheritance one derives at birth, nor something to be memorised or restricted to specific ghettos. It was a reality to be actively tested, lived, and made accessible to all.

Historian Purushottam Agrawal demonstrates in *Akath Kahani Prem Ki* argues that in Kabir, the “weaver” represents a confluence of robust “indigenous modernity” and “spiritual universalism”. For Agarwal,



Anil Sasi

AMERICA'S GOVERNANCE of AI is proving whimsical, much like the Donald Trump administration's approach to most other aspects of geopolitics. But its more recent efforts to wall off access to advanced American AI models could end up being counterproductive. Policies designed to further America's lead could encourage foundational AI model developers worldwide to build on Beijing's largely open-source model push and unintentionally catalyse China's rise in AI, while also forcing more cooperation across other jurisdictions such as the EU or Japan. While Trump's increasingly transactional approach has now been legitimised as state policy, its willingness to treat AI as a new source of extraordinary leverage comes with pitfalls in the long term.

So, how fickle is this new US regulatory stance on AI? A departure from its traditional light-touch regulatory strategy, the new American policy seems to be adjusting and improvising, quite like a saxophone player in a jazz quartet, to the arrival of increasingly powerful models with national security implications. On June 12, three days after Claude Fable 5 was launched, the Trump administration directed Anthropic to exclude foreigners from accessing its latest and most capable frontier AI model. On Wednesday, after an over two-week ban, the US government allowed Anthropic to restore customer access.

Despite this, the signals these actions send are likely to endure: That America is not loath to exploit its role as the gatekeeper to frontier AI while capriciously deciding who gets to use the world's most crucial technology. That the US is willing to ride roughshod over private AI companies, as it did earlier in March when it designated Anthropic a supply-chain risk, and it will not hesitate to treat users pretty much the same way. All this despite the models having been developed entirely by private companies with commercial operations across multiple jurisdictions.

While Trump has consistently upended many established tenets of US foreign policy and appears to be unflinchingly proud of brandishing an unreliable image of America in everything from defence to trade, this administration is by no means an exception. After World War II, the US stopped assisting the UK's nuclear weapons programme, only to relent after the latter developed expertise of its own. It has consistently chosen not to share its best military equipment, like the F-22 Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+42RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

fighter jets, even with close allies. Most of this administration's restrictive policy actions do not just affect America's adversaries, but also its closest allies.

Reversing the AI ban likely happened not out of altruism, but because of the realisation in Washington DC that the legal basis of the order was shaky and was unlikely to stand up to challenges in courts.

From a strategic standpoint, though, these restrictions seem even more tenuous. Take America's more recent restrictions focussed on cutting off China. Following export bans that blocked China from accessing advanced semiconductor technologies and space equipment, Beijing has aggressively pivoted to domestic development. In the process, Chinese firms successfully designed and launched their own high-performance chips, specifically testing processors in the 28-nanometre (nm) to 16 nm range, all the way to Huawei's project aimed at producing 1.4-nm chips by 2031. US space restrictions may have restrained NASA and federally funded contractors such as SpaceX from engaging in collaborations with China, but Beijing has managed to build a top-notch space sector that is achieving historic milestones, including retrieving samples from the far side of the Moon and fabricating its own low Earth orbit space station.

America's AI move is anti-innovation, too. Innovation works best through diffusion — like GPS becoming dominant because it was widely available, despite it having started as an American military project. A ban on software is even more untenable than Trump's earlier interventions that blocked access to hardware, such as Nvidia chips.

For the world, the move could force AI companies elsewhere to look for models from other countries or build their own. Countries would now want to cooperate more to overcome this American hegemony in frontier AI. China is already pushing ahead on cost-optimised open-source models and accelerating adoption across its economy; the EU is now fostering co-operation to build sovereign compute while Japan has announced substantial capital investments.

For India, too, it's becoming clear that without a sovereign AI stack, the reliance on foreign tech could be detrimental, despite all the hype around the country's diffusion strategy: Hybrid public-private AI diffusion aimed at deploying AI across healthcare, agriculture, and public services. It makes sense for Delhi to double down on committing to its own foundational models, however imperfect, and then leverage its scale to engage multiple ecosystems simultaneously. That should be the singular take-away from the US actions on Claude.

The writer is National Business, and Explained, Editor, The Indian Express. anil.s@expressindia.com

Birthright citizenship survives, but immigrants remain vulnerable



Sumit Ganguly

IN A 6-3 ruling, the United States Supreme Court has upheld the constitutional commitment to birthright citizenship, thereby affirming the Fourteenth Amendment to the American Constitution. Under its terms, any child born in the United States (except for those of foreign diplomats), regardless of the citizenship status of the parents, is deemed to be an American citizen. The decision, from a Supreme Court that has given the US President a series of legal victories, came as a major blow to Donald Trump, who has been railing against this constitutional right.

Trump's hostility to this right stemmed from his stated commitment to limit immigration, both legal and illegal, to the US. More specifically, he was hostile to the principle of birthright citizenship because he and several of his advisers argued that it was being routinely abused. In their view, pregnant women from any number of countries were deliberately traveling to the US to give birth to their children in order to obtain American citizenship for them.

The evidence for such claims is scant. For example, of the 3.6 million children born in the US, a mere 9 per cent or 320,000 were born to parents who were illegal immigrants or had temporary protection as their immigration status was being adjudicated in US courts. These numbers hardly constitute a surge and, in any case, the mothers of most of these babies were already in the US, whether legally or otherwise. They had not specifically come to the US to give birth. Trump, who rarely accepts political or legal defeats with good grace, is now appealing to Congress to introduce legislation to override the decision.

The prospects of any such legislation, which would require a constitutional amendment, are dim at best. To pass it would require a two-thirds majority vote in each of the two chambers, the House and the Senate. Subsequently, three-quarters of the states would have to ratify it. The current or even likely future political maps offer little or no hope for such an outcome. Constitutional amendments are notoriously difficult to pass.

Does this decision have any significance for Indians legally working in the US, who are, nevertheless, not permanent residents or citizens? To some degree. Children of H-1B visa holders born in the US will now remain eligible for American citizenship and will not need to fret about their status.

That said, the administration is unlikely to relent in its pushback against immigration. Despite pleas from the Gov-

ernment of India as well as American firms, it has not relented on the high fees that it imposed on American employers. As of September 1 of last year, American employers wanting to bring in a worker from abroad on the H-1B visa programme will be compelled to pay \$100,000. Since India was the recipient of close to 70 per cent of these visas, the impact on prospective Indian visa seekers will be disproportionate. A federal judge struck down the order in June, declaring it to be an unlawful tax that can only be imposed by Congress, but the Trump administration will appeal the decision.

Beyond the issue of citizenship and visas, Indians and even Indian Americans have cause for concern. Systematic statistical data on hate-related crimes against them is not readily available, but according to a recent, reliable survey, as many as 27 per cent of Indian Americans feel that they are now the objects of discrimination while 25 per cent of permanent residents reported the same sentiment. Since this was a nationwide sample, it does not reveal regional variations. Some anecdotal evidence, however, suggests that even in America's Silicon Valley, hostility towards people of Indian origin working in the high technology sector is growing.

The rise of anti-immigrant sentiment both within the current administration and in American society is disturbing, especially since the US is a land of immigrants, barring the marginalised native American population. Sadly, hostility to immigrants is not new in the US. In the mid-19th century, in the wake of the Irish potato blight, thousands of impoverished immigrants turned up on America's shores, and faced blatant discrimination and hostility when they landed in major urban centres such as New York City. Such attitudes persisted for years before people of Irish origin were assimilated into American life and society.

Compared to those of Irish descent, Indian Americans are a small fraction of the American population. There are nearly 40 million who are of Irish ancestry, while there are slightly over 5 million Indian Americans. Yet, as recent immigrants who are non-White and mostly of other faiths — as opposed to the numerically dominant Christians — they can easily become the object of scapegoating. Common tropes suggest that anti-immigrant sentiment toward Indian Americans stems from the belief that they are unfairly seizing job opportunities and are abusing the visa system. Sadly, the current administration has done little to quell these fears and has instead fanned them. Though profoundly disturbing, hopefully these sentiments are only the latest version of anti-immigrant bigotry and will abate over time.

The writer is a senior fellow and directs the Huntington Programme on US-India Relations at the Hoover Institution, Stanford University



ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Mamdani model

AMERICA HAS never been inherently conservative in a cultural sense (‘Can Mamdani effect break through cultural barriers of American conservatism?’, *IE*, July 2). What appears as conservatism is rooted in the material conditions shaped by its capitalist system. In the 1930s, amid the Great Depression, significant working-class radicalism emerged, yet communist votes remained limited. This was not due to voter conservatism but because the ruling class, facing pressure and the example of the USSR, offered concessions like the New Deal, Social Security, and later Medicare. These measures, funded by imperialist super-profits, effectively bought social peace and integrated large sections of the working and middle classes into the system. Today, with capitalism in crisis — marked by militarisation, declining hegemony, and attacks on welfare under figures like Trump — the system's capacity to buy social peace has weakened. This explains the surge in support for DSA-style politics and leaders like Zohran Mamdani.

Manu Kant, via email

Citizenship quagmire

WHAT STANDS OUT is how uncertainty itself becomes a tool of

pressure, regardless of the court's final word (‘Trump could use new tools after court snub’, *IE*, July 2). Long-term visa holders now live with an added anxiety about their children's status. India's diaspora bodies should actively counsel affected families on legal safeguards rather than leave them to rumours. Bilateral channels could also raise this concern quietly, given the size of the Indian community involved. Predictability in immigration policy benefits both India and the United States, and abrupt shifts serve neither the economy nor the goodwill of the diaspora.

Abbharna Barathi, Chennai

Soil health

THE ARTICLE rightly highlights that soil health is the foundation of sustainable cotton production (‘India's cotton farms need better soil, not just new GM seeds’, *IE*, July 2). New seed technologies alone cannot overcome the challenges posed by declining soil organic matter, nutrient imbalance, and water stress. Farmers need greater support for regenerative farming practices, including organic carbon enhancement, balanced fertilisation, and efficient irrigation. Scientific innovations should complement, not replace, sound agronomic practices.

Sharad Shinde, Ahilyanagar

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

TECH

Scams, spoofing: Govt’s concerns over WhatsApp’s username feature

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 2

THE CENTRE has asked Meta-owned WhatsApp not to roll out its upcoming username feature over concerns of impersonation and fraud. In a notice issued to the company on Wednesday, the IT Ministry has given WhatsApp three days to furnish a detailed explanation of the feature.

This week, WhatsApp announced it would gradually allow users to select a username and hide their phone numbers when contacting another user for the first time. It is currently allowing users to “reserve” a username to avoid overlaps with others. It is an optional unique identifier that can be used to message or call, while keeping a user’s phone number private. Messaging services like Telegram and Signal have similar features.

Though the company is billing the feature as one making WhatsApp conversations more private, some are concerned that bad actors could use it for impersonation. WhatsApp earlier clarified in response to the government’s notice that it had built safeguards around the feature.

Username as identity

In its notice, the government is understood to have told WhatsApp that the feature may materially increase the incidence of online fraud, phishing and digital arrest scams. The government has also flagged that the feature may facilitate impersonation of public authorities and government agencies, by permitting the adoption of usernames closely resembling those of genuine people and institutions.

Senior government officials said a risk assessment of the new feature would be undertaken. “During our internal assessment and subsequent questioning of WhatsApp, if we do not think there are enough guardrails to protect against impersonation, the government may also look into whether the feature’s rollout should be stopped altogether,” an official said, requesting anonymity.

India is WhatsApp’s biggest market, with over 850 million users. Some in the Indian tech community had also criticised the feature. Mobikwik’s CEO Bipin Preet Singh said on X: “Not a good idea at all. Will lead to proliferation of fraud and impersonation. For example, I checked, most variations of my name already taken. Wonder what can it be used for.”

WhatsApp’s defence

A WhatsApp spokesperson said that to protect against impersonation, the company has held high-profile names of public figures, government entities and celebrities.

“Users still require a phone number to use WhatsApp and we’ve built multiple layers of defense against scams into usernames: Other users need to know the exact username to message you, we will limit how many new people an account can contact... and have systems to detect and remove activity showing common impersonation and abuse patterns,” they added.

In an earlier blog post announcing the feature, WhatsApp said: “Usernames are our latest step to make WhatsApp even more private. There’s no directory to browse and no suggestions”. As an added safety feature and to allow users to control who can reach them on WhatsApp with their username, the platform has built an optional numeric key that others will need to know to message a user.

“When you message someone for the first time who doesn’t have you saved in their contacts, we might share whether your phone number is registered in a country different from theirs to help them know who they’re connecting with so they can stay safe and avoid unwanted contact,” WhatsApp said.

The feature has not yet been rolled out. For creators, small businesses, and organisations that may want to maintain a consistent presence online, WhatsApp will allow an option to claim their existing Instagram or Facebook username on WhatsApp. The company said it takes impersonation-related abuse “seriously,” and will take action against users who may pretend to be someone else. Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzgl

India is WhatsApp’s biggest market, with over 850 million users. Some in the Indian tech community had also criticised the feature. Mobikwik’s CEO Bipin Preet Singh said on X: “Not a good idea at all. Will lead to proliferation of fraud and impersonation. For example, I checked, most variations of my name already taken. Wonder what can it be used for.”

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BUSINESS

Sanae Takaichi’s visit: What India and Japan can do to boost their business ties



EXPERT EXPLAINS
AJAY SINGH

TOKYO-BASED ENERGY & SHIPPING EXECUTIVE WHO HAS WORKED AT THE SENIOR-MOST LEVELS OF JAPANESE INDUSTRY.

A STATISTIC often cited to illustrate the underperformance of India-Japan business relations, despite the otherwise flourishing strategic partnership, is the number of Japanese companies operating in India — 1,500. Thailand, in contrast, has around 6,000 Japanese companies.

Of the 1,500 in India, just 1% account for over half of all business. And most of this business, in turn, comes from a single sec-

tor — automobiles — thanks largely to the early commitment to India by Suzuki Motor Corporation in the 1980s.

However, more Japanese companies than ever before are now making efforts to do business in India, noticing the steady growth of the Indian economy despite global challenges, and realising that India offers stability in an increasingly uncertain world.

There is a subtle but telling shift in that a small number of the best Japanese corporations are now sending their most capable Japanese staff — a precious resource — to explore opportunities in India. There has been much investment in real estate, technology startups and steelmaking. Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi has brought welcome support to Indo-Japanese clean energy partnerships, among others. The fruits of all these endeavors will be visible in the coming years.

How Japanese firms can adapt

Japanese firms’ most valuable assets

RAM TEMPLE DONATION ROW

How temples deal with donations

India’s biggest temples have similar processes to handle donations. What differs are the institutions governing these systems



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY

EVERY DAY, thousands of devotees fold currency notes into temple *hundis* (donation boxes) believing the offering has reached the deity.

What follows is a donation handling chain that is broadly similar across India’s biggest temples. Offerings are removed by authorised personnel, shifted to counting centres, segregated into cash, coins and valuables, counted, and recorded before being deposited into designated bank accounts. The entire process is under CCTV surveillance.

The recent allegations of theft of donations at the Ram Janmabhoomi Temple in Ayodhya have brought this invisible chain into public view. But Ayodhya is far from the country’s only temple handling massive offerings. Shrines such as the Sri Venkateswara Swamy temple in Tirupati, the Jagannath temple in Puri, Vaishno Devi temple in Katra, Siddhivinayak temple in Mumbai and Kashi Vishwanath in Varanasi receive hundreds of crores in donations every year, besides tonnes of gold, silver and jewellery.

Where temples differ is not in the journey of the donation but in the institutions governing the handling process. We examine the donation systems, oversight mechanisms and governance frameworks at five of India’s biggest temples and compare them with those at the Ram Temple.

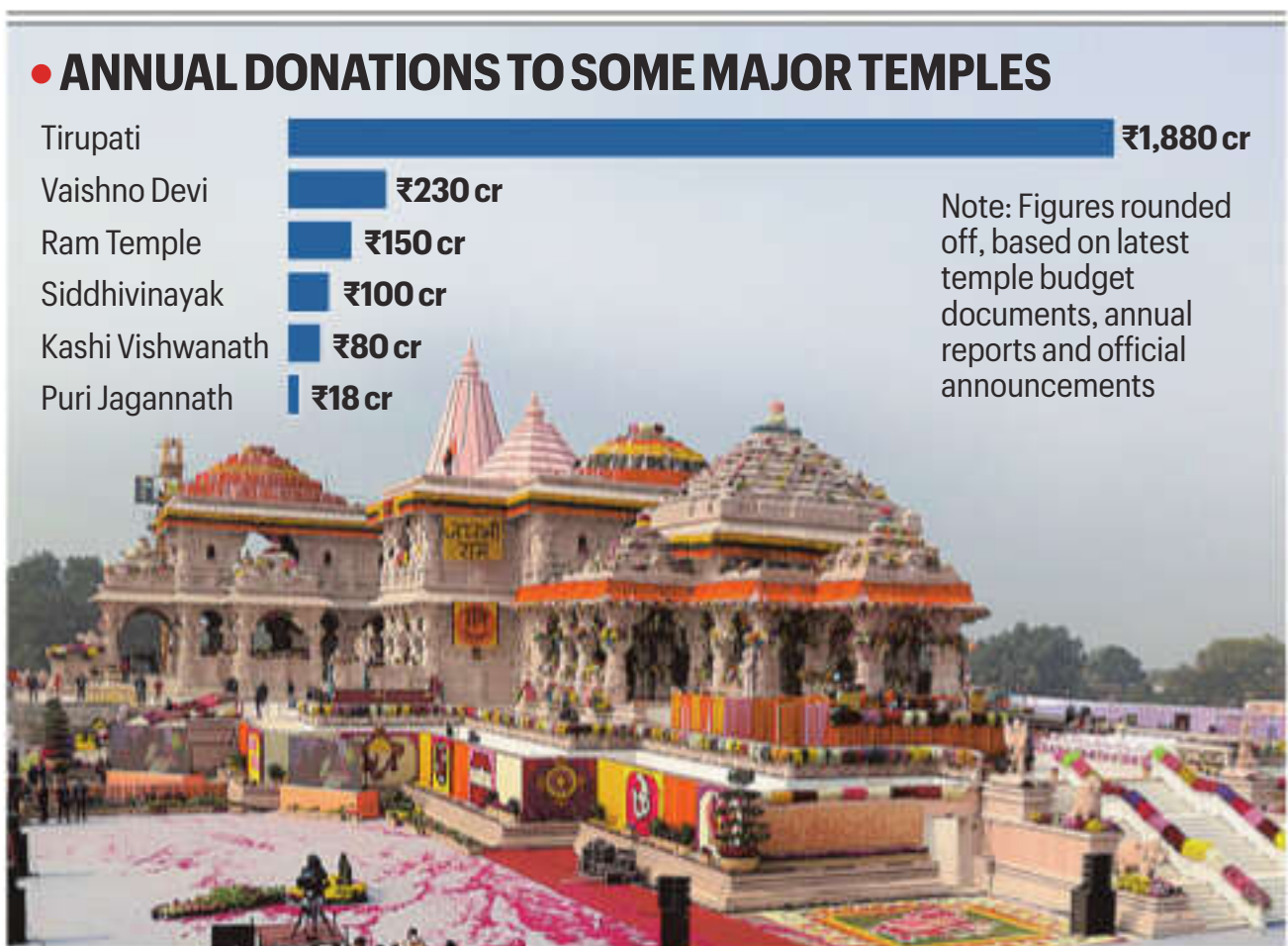
RAM TEMPLE: At the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, donations from about 35 *hundis* are opened by authorised personnel, including trust officials and a State Bank of India (SBI) representative, and taken to a counting hall inside the pilgrim facilitation centre. There, counting staff outsourced by SBI and trust staff count cash and jewellery under the supervision of retired banker Subhash Srivastava, while overall responsibility for the donation process rests with trust member Anil Mishra. Once verified, the collections are deposited into the trust’s SBI account.

TIRUPATI: Few religious institutions in the world process donations on the scale of the Balaji temple, and its famed ‘Parakamani system’ has evolved accordingly. Permanent Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD) finance personnel, representatives of nationalised banks, and vetted volunteers — mostly serving or retired government and bank employees — work together to process donations under a CCTV network monitored by the temple’s vigilance wing. People, wearing pocketless clothes, are frisked before entering and leaving the counting hall. Cash movement is secured through armoured transport under escort, while access to different stages of the process is segregated among finance officials, vigilance staff, bank representatives and volunteers.

JAGANNATH: At Puri, *hundis* are opened under the supervision of the temple administrator or an authorised gazetted officer, while a member of the Managing Committee serves as an independent witness.

Each *hundi* is sealed before and after opening, entries are made in statutory forms, and CCTV monitors the handling of donations. Designated accounts staff maintain statutory registers for cash and valuables before bank deposits are made. The temple has also expanded official donation channels through payment gateways and Odisha’s digital *hundi* initiative.

VAISHNO DEVI: At Vaishno Devi, donation handling mirrors the shrine’s corporate-style



The Ram Temple in Ayodhya on its consecration day in January 2024. PIB

Systems in the states

TAMIL NADU: The Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Department, established under the Tamil Nadu Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Act, 1959, administers over 40,000 temples.

ANDHRA PRADESH: The Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD) is an independent trust that manages the Sri Venkateswara Temple and several allied temples. The government appoints its Board of Trustees and Chief Executive Officer.

KERALA: The Travancore Devaswom Board, constituted in 1950, manages over a thousand temples, including the Sabarimala Temple.

UTTAR PRADESH: Following a major temple theft in January 1983, the UP Sri Kashi Vishwanath Temple Act was enacted by the then Congress government. A Board of Trustees was entrusted with its management, with a government-appointed CEO.

JAMMU & KASHMIR: A state government-appointed body manages the Vaishno Devi temple.

management. Donation boxes are opened by committees comprising accounts officers, area managers, and security personnel rather than individual trustees or religious functionaries. Finance, security and operations are handled by specialised administrative departments under the Shrine Board. Given the mountainous location, the Board uses battery vehicles and, when required, helicopters, to move valuables.

SIDDHIVINAYAK: Here, independent oversight begins at the counting table itself. According to treasurer Pawan Tripathi, the main *hundi* is opened every Thursday in the presence of an executive officer, a trustee, a bank representative, and an auditor under CCTV surveillance, ensuring multiple independent stakeholders witness every stage of the counting. Devotees also have access to official banking and digital donation channels.

KASHI VISHWANATH: At Kashi Vishwanath, the district administration is part of the accountability chain. The temple’s 56 donation boxes are opened under the supervision of a Sub-Divisional Magistrate, while counting takes place in the presence of bank officials and a retired gazetted officer.

Deposit receipts are generated for every transaction to create an audit trail. Jewellery is valued by government-approved appraisers before being taken into custody.

How Ram Temple stands apart

Most of India’s older major temples are administered under dedicated legislation enacted by state governments. TTD functions under the Andhra Pradesh Charitable and Hindu Religious Institutions and En-

dowments Act, the Jagannath Temple under the Shri Jagannath Temple Act, the Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine under the Jammu and Kashmir Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Act, the Siddhivinayak Temple under a Maharashtra law governing its trust, while the Kashi Vishwanath Temple is administered under the Uttar Pradesh Shri Kashi Vishwanath Temple Act.

These laws create the governing bodies, define the powers of administrators, prescribe financial procedures, provide for government oversight and statutory audits, and in some cases lay down detailed rules for handling donations.

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra functions through a trust deed rather than a dedicated statute governing the administration of the temple. Day-to-day management, including appointments and financial administration, rests with the trust.

Another point of departure is the composition of the management. In several older temples, key financial processes involve executive officers, statutory administrators, government nominees, magistrates, auditors, or other public officials whose responsibilities are defined under law.

At the Ram Temple, many of the key office-bearers associated with donation management — including General Secretary Champat Rai, trust member Anil Mishra, administrator Gopal Rao, and donation supervisor Subhash Srivastava — have long associations with the RSS or its affiliates. Responsibility for administration is therefore concentrated within the trust structure rather than distributed across a broader statutory administrative framework.

The distinction assumes significance because a private internal audit commissioned by the trust within months of its formation identified weaknesses in the administrative framework.

Unlike many temple boards, the Ram Temple trust is not subject to mandatory financial audits by the state or central governments. Questions relating to public audit and oversight of the trust’s finances have also reached the courts. The trust has not publicly disclosed whether the recommendations contained in the 2020 audit were fully implemented.

When systems are tested

No major temple has been untouched by controversy. Tirupati has over the years tightened access controls, vigilance, and surveillance after instances of theft involving employees and volunteers. At Jagannath, the Ratna Bhandar dispute centred on the custody and inventory of temple valuables, eventually leading to court-directed scrutiny and fresh inventories.

At Kashi Vishwanath, efforts have increasingly focused on routing donations through official channels rather than direct offerings to priests, while Siddhivinayak has periodically faced scrutiny over governance and financial management.

The allegations at the Ram Temple are still under investigation and no conclusions have been reached. But the experience of India’s older temples suggests institutional safeguards are rarely built overnight.

The traditional models to manage temples, state’s role



SHYAMLAL YADAV

THE RECENT allegations of embezzlement of offerings and donations at the Ram Janmabhoomi Temple in Ayodhya have brought its management into focus. The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust was formed in 2020, when the Union Cabinet cleared the way for its establishment.

With reports of irregularities, Ram Temple Construction Committee Chairman Nripendra Mishra has advocated for appointing a CEO to manage trust affairs. On the other hand, the Vishwa Hindu Parishad, the main driving force behind the Ram Temple movement, has called for ‘liberating’ temples across the country from government control.

Temples and their assets

There are no official figures for Hindu temples in India, but estimates put the number at around 10 lakh. Most of these are small village shrines or modest structures maintained by local communities, families or hereditary priests who take the offerings and donations. A significant number of large temples own substantial properties and receive large donations from devotees. Charitable trusts often manage temples. Significant donations in the form of cash offerings and goods in kind are mostly unaccounted for.

Three main traditions of temple management

Temples are managed through diverse systems, primarily under three traditional models, with varying degrees of government involvement:

1. FAMILY MANAGEMENT (‘PANDAS’ AND PRIEST FAMILIES)

The majority of temples are managed by specific families or hereditary priest lineages known as *pandas* or *pujaris*. Offerings, donations and ritual responsibilities traditionally belong to them. When multiple families are involved, control often rotates.

A notable example is the Udupi Sri Krishna Mutt in Karnataka. It is administered by the *Ashta Mathas* or eight monasteries founded by the 13th-century saint Madhvacharya. Each *matha* manages temple administration and rituals for two years; thus, the next cycle for a *matha* comes only after 16 years.

2. MAHANT SYSTEM

Here, a single spiritual head (mahant, mathadhish or pithadheeshwar) holds prime authority. The mahant exercises control over temple assets, properties, offerings, and administration and typically appoints or nominates his successor.

A prominent example is the Gorakhnath Math in Gorakhpur, UP, headed by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, who was appointed by the late Mahant Avaidyanath. Similar successor-based systems operate in the Shankaracharya *mathas*.

3. AKHADA (PANCHAYATI) SYSTEM

Akhadas are autonomous organisations of *sadhus*. These are often in the limelight during the Mahakumbh, where they are prioritised for the holy dip according to their relative status. *Akhadas* function as collective bodies, often with elected or consensus-based heads and also called “Panchayati Akhada”. They appoint priests, oversee rituals, and control donations.

Government’s role in managing temples

The British introduced the Religious Endowments Act in 1863, which handed over control of temples to committees set up under the Act. However, the government retained considerable influence through other legal provisions.

In 1925, the Madras Hindu Religious Endowments Act empowered provincial governments to legislate on endowments. Its powers gradually expanded to include oversight, even allowing takeover of the temple management. After Independence, the 1925 Act became the blueprint for various state laws.

Article 25(2) of the Constitution empowers the state to regulate or restrict “any economic, financial, political or other secular activity which may be associated with religious practice” and to enact laws for social welfare and reform.

This provision is the basis for state legislation governing temple endowments. Muslims and Christians manage their places of worship and religious institutions through community-run boards or trusts.

Apart from government-appointed bodies playing a role in temple management, they also pay salaries to priests and ensure that offerings and donations are deposited into dedicated accounts. States also use part of the income from offerings at large temples for the administration and upkeep of those and smaller temples, and for non-temple welfare activities.

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGjOKH6oBd0F> panese corporations.

What Indian companies can do

Although the governments of India and various states, industry associations and the like actively market India to Japan, it would be helpful to focus more deeply and actively support Japanese investors in India, especially first-timers in select sectors.

Partnerships utilising all available capabilities — not only government agencies — to create support structures that can deliver results on the ground are needed.

Corporate India would benefit by engaging with Japan more strategically and intensively. It is rare to find an office in Tokyo of even the biggest names among Indian firms, or even a part-time local advisor. Consequently, there is a lack of understanding of the Japanese mindset and of how business can be developed here.

Indian companies still look for old fashioned ‘collaborations’ or ‘transfers of technology’ in return for enabling ‘access’

SUSTAINED RELIANCE ON THERMAL POWER ALSO PUSHED COAL CONSUMPTION ABOVE SUPPLIES

Reliance on coal soars as weak rains drag hydro output by 19.5%

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 2

THE COUNTRY is leaning more heavily on coal to meet surging electricity demand this summer, as rainfall deficit has squeezed hydropower output. Hydro generation fell 19.5% year-on-year (y-o-y) to 13,361.96 million units (MU) in June, down from 16,593.07 MU a year earlier, according to data from the National Power Portal.

At the same time, coal-fired generation climbed to 117,677.69 MU in June 2026, the highest for the month in the past three years. That was 13.9% higher than June 2025, 3.9% above June 2024, and 14% higher than June 2023.

Coal-fired generation increased amid a 40% rainfall deficit in June, while the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast below-normal rainfall for July as well. The weak monsoon has also kept electricity demand elevated for cooling and irrigation, pushing peak power demand to 264.76 gigawatts (GW) in June.

This year's situation stands in contrast to last year, when hydroelectric power played a crucial role in meeting evening peak demand during summer when solar output drops. How-

● COAL POWERS AHEAD AS HYDRO OUTPUT WEAKENS

Year	2023	2024	2025	2026
Coal power generated in June (MU)	103,250.93	113,292.29	103,293.11	117,677.69
June 2026 performance	+14.0%	+3.9%	+13.9%	—
Coal power generated in April-June (MU)	315,243.90	349,531.08	325,521.71	352,725.38
April-June 2026 performance	+11.9%	+0.9%	+8.4%	—

Year	2023	2024	2025	2026
Hydro power generated in June (MU)	14,134.76	13,748.56	16,593.07	13,361.96
June 2026 performance	-5.5%	-2.8%	-19.5%	—
Hydro generation in April-June (MU)	34,364.97	34,117.28	39,438.02	36,861.99
April-June 2026 performance	+7.3%	+8.0%	-6.5%	—

NOTE: MU IS MILLION UNITS

SOURCE: NATIONAL POWER PORTAL

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMg1

ever, rainfall deficit has altered the equation. With hydro generators prioritising reservoir conservation, grid operators are relying more on thermal sources in providing flexible peak-hour generation.

Stress on coal power

Throughout the April-June period this year, coal-fired generation has remained elevated, with output climbing to 352,725.38 MU — the highest for the period since 2023. The sustained reliance on thermal power also pushed coal con-

sumption at power plants above supplies during the first two months of the quarter.

Latest data from the Central Electricity Authority shows the country's 223 GW thermal fleet consumed 156.8 million tonnes (mt) of coal during April-May 2026, against supplies of 147.2 mt, resulting in a drawdown in inventories.

The higher thermal generation reflected the need to meet sustained demand from elevated night-time temperatures and agricultural consumption amid a monsoon rainfall defi-

cit, a senior official said.

However, coal supplies to the power sector gathered some pace in June, with dispatches by Coal India Ltd (CIL) — the country's largest coal miner — rising 7.5% y-o-y, according to company data.

That marked a sharp acceleration from the 2.2% growth recorded in May, indicating stronger coal movement to power plants as thermal generation remained elevated. Notably, CIL accounts for about 83% of the coal supplied to the power sector in India, while

nearly 80% of its total offtake goes to power utilities.

Grid operators turn to gas-based power

The sluggish progress of southwest monsoon has also prompted the country's top grid operator to turn to expensive gas-based power this summer. On June 29, Grid Controller of India (Grid India) issued an advisory asking gas-based power stations to plan fuel procurement arrangements, anticipating the need for additional gas-fired generation for 10-15 days in July.

The assessment is based on projected demand, planned and forced outages of generating units, hydro, renewable generation profiles and present weather information available on IMD, the advisory read. Similar advisories were issued for June as well. This comes as the conflict in West Asia has cast a shadow over fuel availability for gas-based power plants this year. During April-June period, gas-based power generation fell to 6,594.81 MU from 8,794.35 MU in the same period last year, marking a 25% y-o-y decline. Even though gas-based power accounts for only a small share of India's overall generation mix, it plays a crucial rebalancing role during evening peak hours.

Mehli Mistry exits Tata's investment firm board

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 2

MEHLI K Mistry, a close associate of the late Ratan Tata, has resigned as a director of RNT Associates Pvt. Ltd, the investment firm founded by the former Tata Sons and Tata Trusts chairman.

Mistry, one of the executors of Ratan Tata's will, cited preoccupation with other commitments as the reason for stepping down

Established in March 2009, RNT Associates is a privately held investment firm of Ratan Tata with offices in India and Singapore. The firm focuses on funding startups and early-stage enterprises across industries including venture, advisory, financial services, social inclusion and technology. Its board includes Ratan Tata's half-sisters Shireen Jejeebhoy, Deanna Jejeebhoy, Jamsheed Poncha and Siddharth Sharma.

Mistry's departure comes amid a broader wave of governance and leadership changes across Tata-linked institutions over the past several months.

The move follows recent changes in the governance of key Tata philanthropic entities.

In October 2025, Mistry stepped down as a trustee of Sir Ratan Tata Trust, Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and Bai Hirasai Navsari Charitable Institution Trust after his reappointment to their boards was not approved by other trustees. Tata Trusts, which holds a 66% stake in Tata Sons, are among the principal philanthropic bodies associated with the group and play a crucial role in overseeing charitable initiatives and holding stakes in Tata Sons. Despite these changes, he continues to serve as a trustee of the Tata Education and Development Trust.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

FM meets French biz leaders, seeks investment in India

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Thursday held separate meetings with senior executives of global banking major BNP Paribas and transport solution provider Flying Whales, during which she highlighted India's investment opportunities and startup ecosystem. In a meeting with Flying Whales president Sebastian Bougon in Paris, she welcomed the firm's interest in establishing its ecosystem in India.

"She informed Bougon about the opportunities in India

for a company like Flying Whale and encouraged him to engage with the vibrant startup ecosystem operating in this space," the finance ministry said on X. Sitharaman, who is in France, also highlighted opportunities available in India for firms such as Flying Whales and pointed to the framework available at the International Financial Services Centres Authority in GIFT City for ship and aircraft leasing as well as Maintenance, Repair and Operations, which could be leveraged by the company. PTI

EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUNDS SCHEME, 2026

New withdrawal rules, same PF contribution rates

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, July 2

THE MINISTRY of Labour and Employment has notified Employees' Provident Funds Scheme, 2026, in line with the Code on Social Security, replacing the Employees' Provident Funds Scheme, 1952. The recent decisions taken by the retirement fund body, Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) regarding partial withdrawals, streamlining of withdrawal categories, have been incorporated in the new scheme along with an explicit mention about mandatory and voluntary contributions above the statutory wage ceiling.

For contract workers, the concept of 'principal employer' has been introduced in the scheme for the first time. This is in line with the provisions of the labour codes.

The EPF Scheme, 2026 states that the employer will be required to pay both the employer's contribution and the employee's contribution, in the first instance, along with administrative charges or other fees for an employee directly employed by the employer or through a contractor (not registered independently), within 15 days of the close of every month.

In cases where the PF payment is made by the contractor, the ultimate responsibility for contributions will be with the principal employer.

Changes in scheme

In October 2025, the EPFO announced a slew of changes to its withdrawal norms by streamlining the withdrawal categories from 13 to three — essential needs (illness, education, marriage); housing needs; and special circumstances — along with an introduction of a

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGjOKH6oBd0F>

After WhatsApp, Telegram, Signal get notices from IT Ministry

New Delhi: After sending a notice to Meta-owned WhatsApp, the IT Ministry has now shot off notices to Telegram and Signal, raising questions on their existing username feature and asking how the platforms are addressing concerns related to fraud and impersonation risks, according to a source.

The source said that in the notice to Telegram, the government has asked the platform why it should be allowed to have the username feature.

The feature allows users to create unique usernames that can be used for connecting on the platform without sharing phone numbers.

On Wednesday, the Centre issued a notice to Meta over the username feature announced for WhatsApp, citing concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams, and impersonation attacks.

It had also directed WhatsApp to pause the feature until consultations on the issue are completed "to the satisfaction of the government". PTI

● REVISED SCHEME

● The concept of 'principal employer' for contract workers has been introduced in the scheme for the first time, in line with the labour code provisions

● Under the EPF Scheme, 2026, employers must deposit both employer and employee EPF contributions, along with administrative charges, within 15 days of the close of every month

minimum balance of 25%.

The new EPF Scheme, 2026 incorporates those changes by allowing members to withdraw funds in case of illness of self and family members, up to 100% of the eligible member balance, after completion of 12 months of total membership of the Fund. The 100% eligible member balance means withdrawal of 75% of the total funds as 25% is mandatory minimum balance require-

ment. The full 100% amount can be withdrawn after remaining unemployed for one year. Members can also withdraw for the education of self and family members, an amount up to of the eligible member balance, after completion of 12 months' total membership of the Fund. Partial withdrawal cannot exceed 10 times during the membership. For the marriage of self and family members, an amount up to 100% of the eligible member balance can be withdrawn, and partial withdrawal cannot exceed 5 times during the membership of the Fund.

For housing-related requirements, a member may be allowed partial withdrawal from the Fund for purchase of a flat, house; site for construction of a house; construction of a house; repayment of a home loan obtained for purchase, construction of a flat or house or for acquisition of a site; and additions, alterations, renovations or improvements to an existing house or flat. The condition is that such withdrawals will be limited to 75% of total funds after completion of 12 months of total membership in the Fund and partial withdrawal not exceeding five times during the membership.

"Members will be able to make partial withdrawals under simplified rules for essential needs such as illness, education and marriage, as well as for housing requirements and other specified special circumstances, subject to prescribed conditions and maintenance of a minimum balance of 25% of aggregate of total contributions to the Fund," Puneet Gupta, Partner, People Advisory Services, EY India said.

What remains the same in the scheme?

The rate of contribution remains the same from the previous scheme at 12% and 10% for certain notified establishments. As per the existing scheme, the rate of contribution is mandatory till the wage ceiling. The EPF Scheme, 2026 requires provident fund contributions at 12% of wages from both the employer and employee and specifically provides that where wages exceed the statutory wage ceiling, mandatory contributions will be restricted on the wage ceiling amount, Gupta said. "Employees may, however, opt to make voluntary contributions either on wages exceeding the statutory wage ceiling or at a rate higher than the prescribed 12%. Employers also have the option to make matching contributions against such voluntary contributions," he added.

FULL REPORT ON

[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

● MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
77,502.12	24,175.70	₹1,43,003	₹95.40
579.48	169.85		
0.75%	0.71%	Silver ▲	Oil ▼
		₹2,28,850	\$68.28

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 1, 2026


RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LTD.
Suratgarh Super Thermal Power Station, Suratgarh-335805

E-Tender Notice : TN-2190 (RVU2627GLOB00654)
Online tenders are invited for Replacement of old CRD system by High Performance Energy Chain system for Stacker Cum Reclaimer (S/R), stage-II, CHP, STPS, Suratgarh. Tender details are available on websites <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> (for e-tender), www.energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/rvunl & www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/6051 RVUN/PR-4420 Superintending Engineer (Proc.)


The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)

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PRO/AAM(M)/40/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**


SBI
Information Security Department, State Bank of India,
Global IT-Centre, Sec-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614

Corrigendum - 7
Ref: SBI/GITC/ISD/2026-27/SOC/1442 Dated: 06.04.2026
State Bank of India (SBI) has issued Request for Proposal (RFP) for Setting up Cyber Defence Centre. For details, please visit 'Procurement News' at <https://sbi.bank.in> and e-tender portal (<https://etender.sbi/sbi>). Eligible bidders, based on the criteria in the RFP notice, may obtain the full RFP upon payment of the tender fees up to 03:00 PM on 10.07.2026. Corrigendum-7 dated 02.07.2026 of the RFP may be downloaded from e-tender portal (<https://etender.sbi/sbi>).
Last date and time for Bid submission: Up to 05.00PM on 14.07.2026
Place: Navi Mumbai **Dy. General Manager (SOC)**
Date: 03.07.2026 **Information Security Department**


Mangalore SEZ Limited
Mangalore Special Economic Zone, Sy.No. 168-3A, Plot No. U1 Administrative Building, Bajpe Village, Mangalore - 574 142
Dakshina Kannada, Karnataka

Extension of Expressions of Interest (EOI) Submission Dates
The last date for submission of Expressions of Interest (EOI) are extended as follows:

Name of work	Deadline for submission of EOI	
	Original	Revised
Establishment of 4.5MLD Capacity Tertiary Treatment Plant at the Common Effluent Treatment Plant in MSEZ/EOI Ref No: MSEZ/L4.5MLD TTP/EOI/2026	15:00 hrs on 06.07.2026	15:00 hrs on 20.07.2026
Establishment of 22.7MLD Capacity Tertiary Treatment Plant at Kavoor, Mangalore - EOI Ref No: MSEZ/L 22.7 MLD TTP/EOI/2026	15:00 hrs on 06.07.2026	15:00 hrs on 20.07.2026

Interested firms may obtain detailed information and EOI documents from the MSEZ website: www.mangaloresez.com.
All subsequent communications, corrigenda, addenda, clarifications, notifications, and updates pertaining to this EOI shall be hosted exclusively on the above website. Interested firms are advised to regularly visit the website for the latest information.
Sd/- Chief Executive Officer
Mangalore SEZ Ltd, Mangaluru

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 2

LONG-STANDING insolvency-related disputes involving Bank of Baroda (BoB) and the NMC group of companies of the UAE, have been settled out of court with the Indian lender paying \$600 million (around Rs 5,700 crore) to the joint administrators of the firm — ending a series of proceedings spanning multiple jurisdictions.

BoB shares fell 4.18% to Rs 260.15 on the exchanges after the bank made the announcement on Thursday.

Once listed in London, NMC in 2020 revealed over \$4 billion in hidden debt, leaving many UAE banks and other lenders with heavy losses. BoB had lent \$250 million to NMC and its founder BR Shetty who later backed away from providing collateral.

The Mumbai-headquartered public sector lender came into the picture after NMC's joint administrators alleged that the bank facilitated financing arrangements by processing or extending credit based on fictitious invoices and undisclosed borrowings, enabling the firm's management to conceal its true financial position. They sought billions of dollars in damages



BoB had lent \$250 mn to NMC & its founder who backed away from providing collateral. REUTERS

from BoB. The bank, on its part, denied the allegations in court.

Now, as a consequence of the settlement, the proceedings before the Abu Dhabi Global Market courts have been formally discontinued. NMC Health PLC, NMC Healthcare Ltd, NMC Holding Ltd and their respective joint administrators have settled all claims and disputes with BoB.

The agreement resolves all claims, causes of action and related matters between the parties without any admission of liability or wrongdoing by either side, BoB said in an exchange filing.

The parties emphasised

that the settlement has been reached on a confidential basis, with all other terms of the agreement remaining undisclosed. The payment was settled through the Abu Dhabi branch of the bank.

The announcement further clarified that the bank's liability in the proceedings is limited to the agreed settlement amount, bringing certainty to one of the most closely watched insolvency-related disputes arising from the collapse of the NMC group. Additionally, the related proceedings before the English courts are currently being discontinued, effectively bringing the litigation to an end across both jurisdictions, the filing said.

NMC Health was founded by India-born BR Shetty.

In 2020, it collapsed after investigators discovered billions of dollars of previously undisclosed debt and alleged financial irregularities. The firm, with \$6.6 billion of debt, entered administration, and administrators sought to recover losses from various parties they believed were involved or responsible.

Allegations emerged from a large-scale accounting fraud that allegedly concealed billions of dollars in debt over several years.

FULL REPORT ON

[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

Fuel price cut not yet warranted: Puri

Saurav Anand
New Delhi, July 2

STATE-RUN OIL marketing companies may review petrol and diesel prices in the next two to three months if crude remains stable around current lower levels, Petroleum and Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri indicated Thursday.

An immediate reduction, however, is unlikely as refiners

are still processing expensive crude procured during the West Asia conflict and continue to carry cumulative under-recoveries of around Rs 2.19 lakh crore.

The statement comes as Brent crude has dropped nearly 44%, from a four-year high of \$126.41 a barrel on April 30 to about \$70.78 on Thursday. The September Brent contract was down 1.09%, after touching a

fresh four-year low of around \$70.37 a barrel.

"If the question is, when will you bring prices down, they are still carrying the stock which was bought at a higher price, with higher insurance and higher freight rates. If this low crude price persists for the next two or three months, then that would be a legitimate question," Puri said addressing reporters. FE

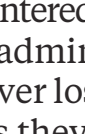
● BRIEFLY

Modi, Japan PM inaugurate Maruti's Kharkhoda plant

New Delhi: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India's fourth manufacturing facility at Kharkhoda in Haryana was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his visiting Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi on Thursday. The plant was virtually inaugurated by the two leaders at the India-Japan Joint Economic Forum here in the Capital. PTI

UAE's IHC, Adani plan \$11.5 bn aluminium project in Odisha

Bengaluru: Abu Dhabi's International Holding Company plans to invest \$11.5 billion in an integrated aluminium project in Odisha through a joint venture with Adani Group, a state official said Thursday, in what would be the country's largest foreign investment in the metals sector. Under the MoU, IHC and Adani Group will each hold a 50% stake in the venture. REUTERS


RAIL WHEEL FACTORY
Yelahanka, BANGALORE - 560 064
Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE NO.RWF/S/P1/05/2026-27 dt:22.06.2026
On behalf of the President of India, Principal Chief Materials Manager invites electronic Tenders from Interested Vendors for supply of the following items on the Indian Railways E-Portal-www.ireps.gov.in. The Tender documents and the Corrigenda to the Tenders, if any, will be available on the Portal only.
1)Tender No: P1262022. Due date: 31/07/26. Short Description: Hexamathylenetetramine (Hexamine) to IS 4306/1987 Qty : 25725 Kgs. 2) Tender No: P1262148. Due date: 15/10/26 Short Description: Clay Graphite stopper as per RWF specification. Qty :249688 Nos. 3) Tender No: P1262203. Due date: 23/10/26. Short Description: Clay Graphite tapered Ingate Sleeve conforming to as per RWF specification and drawing [1] 521-2187 Nos. [2] 017-1058 Nos. [3] 014-344 Nos. [4] D19-1530 Nos. [5] D21-966 Nos. [6] B2-2382 Nos. [7] B3-2075 Nos. [8] B4-1688 Nos.
Principal Chief Materials Manager


Government of Tamil Nadu
KARUR CORPORATION
KARUR DISTRICT
E-Tendering ReTender Notice (Second call)

Roc No: 6052/ 2025/ E5 **Dated: 01.07.2026**
Karur Corporation invites Bids from eligible Bidders through e-procurement portal for "Providing Under Ground Sewerage Scheme to the leftout areas and added areas of Karur Corporation with operation and maintenance for the period of 5 years for collection system and construction of STP including operation and maintenance for the period of 10 years". Bidders shall submit their Bids through online e-procurement portal <https://tntenders.gov.in> up to **03.00 PM** (as per the time in the server clock of the tender portal) on **24/08/2026**. The Bids will be opened through online at **3.30 PM**, on the same day (**24.08.2026**)

Sl. No	Name of Work	Bid Value (Rs. In lakh)	Bid Security (Rs. In lakh)	Period of availability of bid document	Date and time of Bid opening	Period of Completion
1	Providing Under Ground Sewerage Scheme to the leftout areas and added areas of Karur Corporation with operation and maintenance for the period of 5 years - package 1 Estimated cost for Providing UGSS Estimated cost for Operation and maintenance for the period of 5 Years (Excluding electricity charges)	11015.26 368.02	113.84	09.07.2026 to 24.08.2026 up to 3.00 PM	24.08.2026 at 3.30 PM	36 Months
2	Providing Under Ground Sewerage Scheme to the leftout areas and added areas of Karur Corporation with operation and maintenance for the period of 5 years - package 2 Estimated cost for Providing UGSS Estimated cost for Operation and maintenance for the period of 5 Years (Excluding electricity charges)	21426.56 647.39	220.74	09.07.2026 to 24.08.2026 up to 3.00 PM	24.08.2026 at 3.30 PM	36 Months
3	Construction of 35.25 MLD capacity sewage treatment plant at Arasu colony with operation and maintenance for the period of 10 years at Karur Corporation package 3 Estimated cost for Construction of STP Estimated cost for Operation and maintenance for the period of 10 Years (Excluding electricity charges)	7791.39 1698.02	94.89	09.07.2026 to 24.08.2026 up to 3.00 PM	24.08.2026 at 3.30 PM	18 Months

1. The Bid documents shall be made available from **09.07.2026**.
2. The Bid documents may be downloaded from the website (<https://tntenders.gov.in>) at free of cost up to **3.00 PM** on **24.08.2026**.
3. Bids through e-submission shall only be accepted.
4. Pre-bid meeting will be held on **24.07.2026 at 11.00 AM** in the Office of the Karur Corporation, Main Road, Karur - 639 001.
DIPR/2183/TENDER/2026

MOSCOW SAYS IT TARGETED UKRAINIAN MILITARY, ENERGY SITES AND AIRPORTS

Russia rains missiles, drones on Kyiv in major offensive, 21 killed

Ukraine declares Friday a day of mourning after latest attacks

Reuters
Kyiv, July 2

RUSSIA LAUNCHED hundreds of drones and dozens of missiles at Ukraine's capital Kyiv in the early hours on Thursday, killing at least 21 people, wounding scores more and damaging around 130 buildings in one of the biggest attacks of the war.

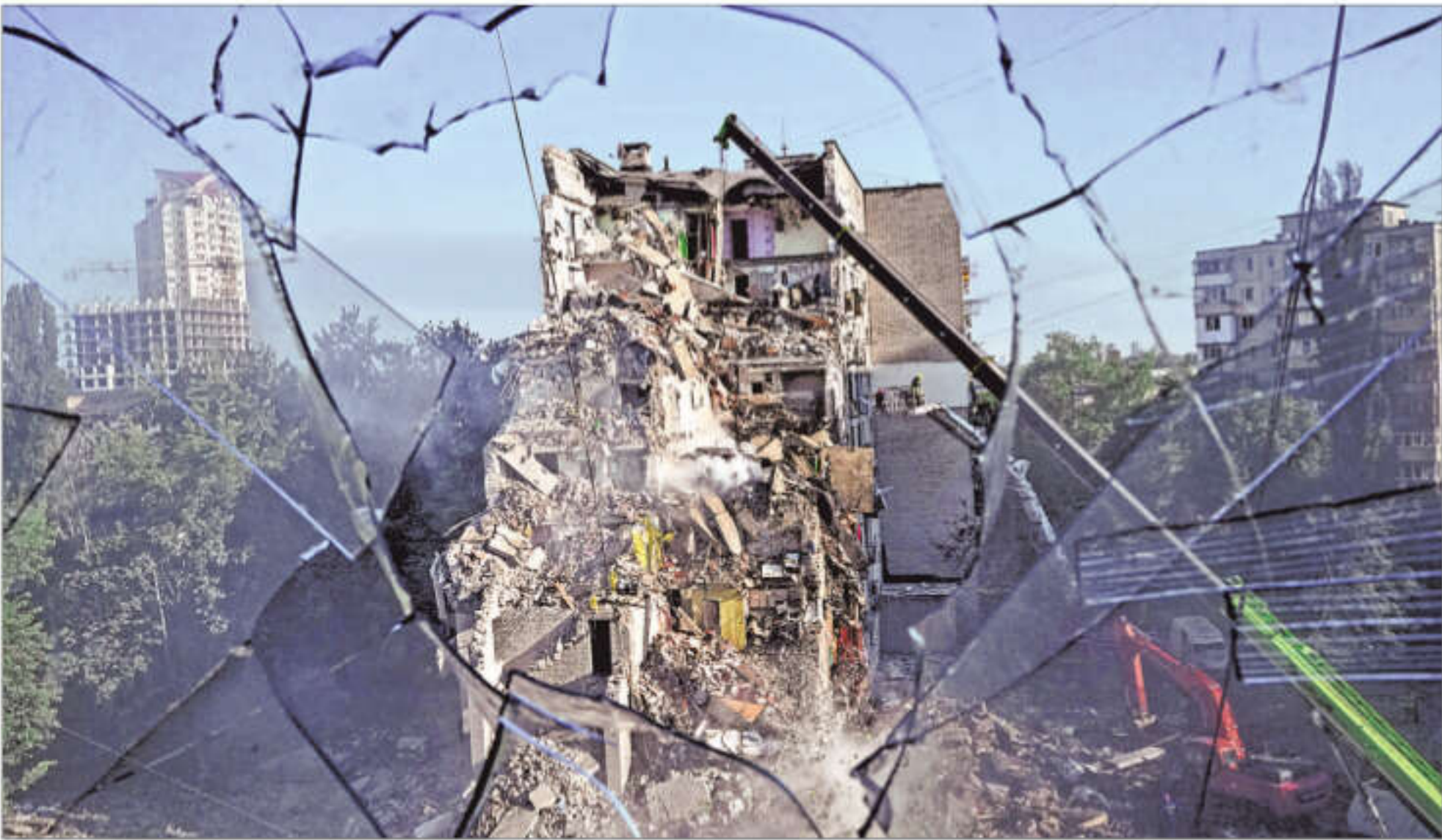
Multiple explosions shook Kyiv and reverberated across the capital throughout the night as thousands of residents rushed to bomb shelters and underground metro stations. Huge columns of smoke filled the skyline.

The attack was the deadliest in Kyiv since at least May, and the wide spread of destruction across the breadth of the capital had little precedent even in a war now in its fifth year.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, who cut short his visit to Ireland and rushed home, visited a site on the city's left bank where a nine-storey residential building was half destroyed. He blamed the destruction in part on a failure of allies to deliver promised air defenses.

"If our partners had delivered on their promises in a timely manner, I think we could have saved more homes and lives today," said Zelenskyy, who looked tired and visibly frustrated. "All we ask of our partners is simply to do what we've agreed on. We're not even asking for more."

Russia launched 74 missiles and 496 drones overnight, the



A residential apartment building is seen damaged after a Russian strike on Kyiv, Ukraine, on Thursday. AP

Ukrainian air force said. Yuri Ihnat, the Air Force spokesperson, said the number of ballistic missiles was unusually high and the interception rate for them was low. Ukraine has struggled with shortages of Patriot missiles in recent months.

The Russian Defence Ministry, in a Telegram post, said its "massive attack" using long-range, high-precision air-land-and-sea-launched weapons and drones hit military and energy facilities, as well as airports in Kyiv and other locations.

Moscow said the attacks were retaliation for Ukrainian drone strikes on Russia. Kyiv, which has stepped up strikes in recent weeks on Russia's domestic fuel supply, said it had

hit an oil refinery overnight in the Russian region of Nizhny Novgorod, where the governor reported one person killed in a strike on an industrial facility.

The Kremlin said Russian military commanders had briefed President Vladimir Putin about the Russian attacks, adding that Moscow would continue to increase pressure on Ukraine to achieve its war aims.

Kyiv Mayor Vitali Klitschko announced a day of mourning in Kyiv for Friday. He said that damage was recorded across the entire city of about 3 million people, with some buildings heavily damaged.

Katarina Mathernova, the EU ambassador to Ukraine, said that "Russia unleashed hell on

Kyiv" overnight, and had struck accommodation used by diplomatic personnel. Diplomats were unharmed, but their belongings were lost in the fire that engulfed the building, she said.

More than 600 rescuers were sifting through the rubble at several sites across the city and the work would continue through the night, the emergency services officials said.

Kaja Kallas, the EU's foreign policy chief, said only sustained military support for Ukraine and increased pressure on Moscow could help stop Russian attacks. "Today, I will propose to sanction more entities supporting Russia's military-industrial complex in response to the strikes," she said in a post on X.

Ukraine, US held talks in past two days: Zelenskyy

Kyiv: A senior Ukrainian defence official, Rustem Umerov, and Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner have held talks in the past two days, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Thursday.

Zelenskyy said he still hoped Kushner and envoy Steve Witkoff would visit Ukraine even as US-backed peace efforts have stalled for months, adding that he hoped to have a meeting with Trump on sidelines of a NATO summit next week. **REUTERS**

11-year-old boy driving truck crashes into group of Thai monks, killing 9



The damaged vehicle that was crashed by an 11-year-old boy in Mukdahan, Thailand, on Thursday. REUTERS

Associated Press
Bangkok, July 2

AN 11-YEAR-old boy crashed a pickup truck into a group of monks on a pilgrimage walk in northeastern Thailand on Thursday, killing nine, officials said.

A total of 35 monks from Mukdahan province, about 600 km northeast of the capital Bangkok, were on the pilgrimage. Five monks were killed at the site, while four others died at a hospital. Thirteen were hospitalized with three in critical condition, according to the provincial administration.

The group started the 260-km walk to Ubon Ratchathani province about 30 minutes before the crash.

Security camera footage shared by a local rescue group, Ruam Jai Mukdahan Rescue Association, shows the monks walking in a single line on the side of a road before the truck crashes into them. The boy is in custody and will be questioned when state child protection officers arrive, police said.

The cause of the accident is under investigation, but police said the monks described seeing the vehicle swerving before it slid off the road and crashed into the group.

Tehran warns US and Israel as it gets ready for Khamenei funeral

Doha talks take a break, rhetoric sharpens over Strait of Hormuz

Reuters
Dubai, July 2

IRAN SAID on Thursday that any US interference in the Strait of Hormuz would trigger a "decisive and rapid" response, adding that the continued presence of US air assets across the waterway endangered regional security, state media reported.

Khatam al-Anbiya Central Headquarters, which coordinates Iran's armed forces operations, said all tanker and commercial vessels must follow routes designated by Tehran for safe passage through the strait, adding failure to comply with navigation protocols would face an immediate response.

An Iranian military commander warned the US and Israel on Thursday against any attack on Iran as it prepares for the state funeral of Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who was killed in airstrikes on the first day of the war.

"We warn the enemies of Iran, especially the US and the Zionist regime (Israel), to avoid any miscalculation and to think about the harsh retaliation our armed forces would make to any threat and aggression against our country," Ali Abdollahi, commander of Khatam al-Anbiya Central Headquarters, said in a statement carried by state media.

Funeral processions for Khamenei will begin on July 4 in

We warn the enemies of Iran, especially the US and the Zionist regime (Israel), to avoid any miscalculation and to think about the harsh retaliation our armed forces would make to any threat and aggression against our country"

ALI ABDOLLAHI, COMMANDER OF KHATAM AL-ANBIYA CENTRAL HEADQUARTERS

Tehran and conclude on July 9 with his burial in his hometown of Mashhad, with additional ceremonies planned in Qom and Iraq in-between these dates.

On Wednesday, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi gave a similar warning that Tehran would deliver an immediate and powerful response to any threat against its people or leadership after comments by Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz that Iran's current Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei was "marked for death."

The talks made "positive progress" on matters related to the memorandum that halted the war in June, a Qatar Foreign Ministry spokesperson said in a post on X, though there was no sign the two sides made headway towards a lasting peace.

The next meeting between Iran and US negotiators will take place after July 9 funeral processions for Iran's late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, the Qatar ministry added.

Pilot in Beijing's tower crash had anxiety, suicidal thoughts: Probe

Press Trust of India
Beijing, July 2

THE PILOT of the small plane that crashed into Beijing's tallest skyscraper last week had long suffered from anxiety and even discussed "ending his life" in his diaries, investigators said on Thursday.

The two-seat plane crashed into the over 100-floor headquarters building of the state-owned conglomerate CITIC Group on June 26, prompting the evacuation of a large number of people working there.

The pilot was killed and 13 others injured in the incident. None of the injured is in a life-threatening condition, according to an official statement.

The pilot, identified only by his surname Liu, was a 66-year-old Beijing resident, according to the investigation released by the Chaoyang district government of Beijing Thursday.

The pilot was a divorcee and a freelance worker who lived alone. He obtained a sport pilot licence in 2021 and a private pilot licence in 2024. He took off in an Aurora SA60L, a single-engine, two-seat light aircraft, from Beijing's Pinggu district on Thursday afternoon.

'Stain on our history': Starmer apologises over forced adoptions

Reuters
London, July 2

BRITISH PRIME Minister Keir Starmer apologised on Thursday to women forced to give up their babies or separated from their mothers at birth under a system of forced adoptions that targeted unmarried women for decades after World War Two.

An estimated 185,000 children were separated from their mothers in Britain.

Starmer apologised on be-

half of the state for the lifelong trauma it had caused. "On behalf of the whole country, I say it to every single person impacted: we are deeply and profoundly sorry," Starmer told parliament, describing what happened to the victims as a "stain on our history".

"The state did not do enough to protect mothers, children, and families from harm, and for this systemic failure I am truly sorry." Between 1949 and 1976, the British state and Christian



PM Keir Starmer. FILE

churches created a system in which young women with children outside marriage were

shamed and coerced into giving up their babies to comply with the social norms of the time.

The Church of England apologised for its role last month, acknowledging its involvement in running so-called "mother and baby homes" where unmarried women were sent, often against their will, during pregnancy or after giving birth and separated from their babies.

The state's apology follows similar apologies by Ireland and

Australia, four years after Britain's human rights committee concluded that the government was "ultimately responsible" for the lack of protection for unmarried mothers and their babies.

Starmer said the government would spend £4 million (\$5.3 million) to help people access their adoption records, fund intermediary services that help people reconnect with family members and for research and testimonial projects to document the long-term impact.

UN asks Pakistan to reverse 'reconstructions' at Taxila sites

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, July 2

THE UN has asked Pakistan to reverse the "reconstructions" that "undermined the integrity" of two historical sites in Taxila, a UNESCO World Heritage site, or these would be placed on the agency's "danger list", a media report said on Thursday.

UNESCO, the cultural arm of the UN, in a recent meeting told senior government officials that it would not hesitate to "delist" the historical sites at Mohra Moradu and Sirkap just like it had "delisted" a World Heritage Site in Germany, due to the recent "unnecessary interven-

tions", the Dawn newspaper reported quoting sources.

The UN agency warned that it would "delist" Taxila from its World Heritage List if the actions were not reversed.

In March, a visitor shared information and pictures with Pakistan's Permanent Delegate to UNESCO in Paris, highlighting reconstruction works by Punjab archaeology department.

The visitor observed interventions that could "affect the authenticity and integrity of the property, specifically original walls being replaced with new construction or their height being raised", the report said.

Security guard rescued from rubble a week after Venezuela earthquakes

Reuters
Catia La Mar, July 2

SEARCH AND rescue teams from El Salvador and Chile on Thursday rescued a 44-year-old security guard trapped in the ruins of the mall where he worked in the Venezuelan state of La Guaira, more than a week after a duo of strong earthquakes devastated the country's northern coast.

Work to save Hernan Alberto Gil from the rubble of the nine-story Galerias Playa Grande shopping center began on Monday, according to Salvadorean President Nayib Bukele,



Alberto Gil was pulled from the rubble a week after the twin earthquakes in Venezuela. REUTERS

who has been posting updates about the operation on X.

Rescuers were able to provide him with hydration via

tubing, Bukele has said, but needed to dig two separate tunnels to try to reach him, because of the instability of the ruins.

Gil was carried out of the rubble on a stretcher on Thursday morning and loaded into an ambulance as cheering rescuers and reporters looked on.

"This rescue was made possible thanks to the joint efforts of teams from Chile, the United States, Portugal, Mexico, Costa Rica, Venezuela and El Salvador, who worked tirelessly to remove debris, stabilize the structure and clear a path to reach Hernan," Bukele said on X.

\$400-million retrofitted 'gift' from Qatar takes maiden flight as Air Force One

Julia Demaree-Nikhinson, Konstantin Toropin & Josh Boak
Washington, July 2

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump on Wednesday took his maiden voyage on a new Air Force One — a retrofitted Boeing 747-800 worth \$400 million gifted by Qatar that embeds his personality more deeply into the institution of the American presidency.

Gone is the trademark light blue hull that helped Air Force One blend into the sky. The refurbished jet is painted in Trump's preferred color scheme: a navy-blue belly with red and gold stripes. It has the luxury features that the presi-

dent believes a commander-in-chief's entourage should have — plush carpets, lie-flat seats, wood paneling and a presidential seal on the seat belts, according to reported tours of the plane.

Trump told reporters that he was proud of the luxurious plane. "You can do two things: You can low-key it, or you can show it," he said.

The retrofitted Qatari jet is intended to serve as a "bridge" between the aging Boeing jets that have served as Air Force One for the last 36 years and two new aircraft, which are years behind schedule and expected to be delivered in 2028 at the earliest. Trump toured



the new jet just weeks after returning to the White House last year and directed that it be prepared for his use for the bulk of his remaining time in office.

The compressed timetable

set by the president limited the modifications to the plane. Images of the jet captured since its unveiling and analyzed by the Associated Press show that it is not equipped with at least some of the same missile detection and countermeasure systems as the outgoing Cold War-era jets.

The Air Force has said that it did little to change the cabin layout of the plane and that it spent less than \$400 million on security upgrades.

Jeremiah Gertler, a senior analyst for Teal Group, an aviation and defense consulting firm, said that this absence, as well as a seemingly smaller number of communications

antennas, suggested that the Qatari jet is better suited to only work as a domestic aircraft.

"If you're going on a long trip, you take the big fancy car, but if you're just buzzing around town, you'll settle for something less. Right? And this looks like it's a domestic-only model," Gertler said, speaking of the new jet.

"If the idea was to do it as quickly and inexpensively as possible, it would seem to lead to the notion that there's less content" in the jet's modifications, Gertler said.

Trump has said he plans to use the new plane next week when he travels to attend the NATO summit in Turkey.

PLANE vs PLANE

How Qatar's Boeing 747-8 compares with old Air Force One

LENGTH		WINGSPAN	
			
747-200B	747-8	747-200B	747-8
230 feet 10 inches	250 feet 2 inches	195 feet 8 inches	224 feet 5 inches

	747-200B	747-8
Cruise speed	Mach 0.84 (645 mph)	Mach 0.855 (656 mph)
Max Weight at takeoff	833,000 lbs	987,000 lbs
Range (nautical miles)	6,735	7,730

SOURCE: BOEING; MAPCREATOR.IO



DIRECTORATE OF AGRICULTURAL MARKETING & AGRICULTURE FOREIGN TRADE, UTTAR PRADESH

4TH FLOOR, KISAN MANDI BHAWAN, VIBHUTI KHAND, GOMTI NAGAR, LUCKNOW-226010

EARLY MARKET ENGAGEMENT (EME) NOTICE

Proposed Selection of Project Management Unit (PMU)

The Directorate of Agricultural Marketing & Agri Foreign Trade (DAM&AFT), Government of Uttar Pradesh, intends to procure the services of a Project Management Unit (PMU) for providing professional support in implementation of programmes relating to Agricultural Marketing and Agri Exports.

Prior to issuance of the Request for Proposal (RFP), the Directorate shall organize an **Early Market Engagement (EME)** meeting in **physical mode** to invite comments, suggestions, and feedback from interested and prospective bidders, as well as other relevant stakeholders, on the proposed draft RFP. The details of the EME meeting are as follows:

- Date & Time: 08 July, 2026; 10:00 AM
- Venue: Director Room, Agricultural Marketing & Agri Foreign Trade U.P., 4th Floor Kisan Mandi Bhawan, Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow-226010.
- The Draft RFP is available on the Dept. website: www.upkrishivipran.in

Disclaimer: This Early Market Engagement is a pre-procurement consultation intended solely for obtaining market feedback. Participation in the EME or submission of comments shall not confer any right or advantage in the subsequent procurement process.

T.K. Shibu

I.A.S.

Director, Agricultural Marketing & Agriculture Foreign Trade, UP.

UPID-253207 Date 01/07/2026

www.upidadv.gov.in



Government of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Flying Institute
Department of Cabinet Secretariat & Vigilance
(Civil Aviation Division)

State Hangar, Birsa Munda Airport Road, Hinoo Ranchi-834002
E-mail-jfi.govtfly@gmail.com/jfi@jharkhandaviation.in
Website-www.jharkhandaviation.in



Ref No.: Psychometric Test/81/2026/JFI-598 /Ranchi, Dated:-02.07.2026

Request for Quotation

Inviting request for quotation For conducting Psychometric Test/Pilot Aptitude Test for selection of Trainee Pilots in Sona Sobran Udan Academy (JFI) at Dumka

Quotations are invited by the Managing Director, Jharkhand Flying Institute (JFI), State Hangar, Birsa Munda Airport Road, Hinoo, Ranchi, Jharkhand from reputed, experienced and technically qualified organizations/ institutions/ private agencies for conducting Psychometric Test/ Pilot Aptitude Test for selection of Trainee Pilots.

Interested organizations/institutions/private agencies who are willing to comply with the terms and conditions of this RFQ, may submit their bids to Managing Director Jharkhand Flying Institute, State Hangar, Birsa Munda, Airport Road Hinoo, Ranchi.

If any organizations/institutions/ private agencies are interested in the above process work, they are requested to quote their Lowest prices and proposal offline.

Details of RFQ are available on the IPRD, Jharkhand-www.prj.jharkhand.in & JFI website- <https://www.jharkhandaviation.in>.

The Schedule of Events for Different activities are given below:-

Schedule of Events		
Detail of Events	Date	
1. Publication of RFQ	02/07/2026, 03:30 P.M.	
2. Start of Submission of RFQ	02/07/2026, 03:30 P.M.	
3. Last date for submission of RFQ	13/07/2026, 03:30 P.M.	
4. Opening of Technical Bids.	14/07/2026, 03:30 P.M.	
5. Opening of Financial Bids.	After scrutiny of the Technical Bid	
6. Award of agreement	Shall be notified later.	

Bidders are requested to check the official website of Jharkhand Flying Institute www.jharkhandaviation.in on a regular basis for updates.

Jharkhand Flying Institute; Govt. of Jharkhand reserves the right to cancel or modify any of the above conditions or cancel any or all RFQ without assigning any reasons.

Sd/-

Capt. S. P. Sinha

Managing Director-cum-Director Ops.,
Jharkhand Flying Institute

PR 383836 Civil Aviation(26-27).D



PATRATU ENERGY LIMITED

(CIN: U40106JH2012SGC000765)

Regd. Office:- Engineering Building H.E.C, Dhurwa, Ranchi- 834004
Email- chiefengineerproject223@gmail.com/gmproject-juunl@jharkhandmail.gov.in

Re-Tender Notice

EOI Notice No.: 11/PR/JUUNL/2026-27

Director, Patratu Energy Limited cum General Manager (Project), JUUNL invites EOI from Insolvency Resolution Professional (IRP) registered with Insolvency & Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) for "Appointment of Insolvency Resolution Professionals Liquidator for voluntary winding up of Patratu Energy Limited (PEL)".

Sl. No.	Details of Work
1	"Appointment of Insolvency Resolution Professional as Liquidator for voluntary winding up of Patratu Energy Limited (PEL)".
2	Eol Processing Fee Rs. 1180.00 (Rupees One Thousand One Hundred Eighty) only including GST
3	Project Completion Period Till closure of PEL and registration of closure order from Ministry of Corporate Affairs.
4	Validity of Bid 180 Days from bid opening date
5	Calendar of Events: i. Date of Publication of EOI 03.07.2026 at 16:00 hrs ii. Last Date / Time for receipt of bids 27.07.2026 at 16:00 hrs iii. Date and Time for Opening of Technical bid 28.07.2026 at 16:00 hrs iv. Online opening of Financial Bid To be Intimated after technical evaluation. Director, PEL cum General Manager (Project), Jharkhand UrjaUtpadan Nigam Limited Engineering Building H.E.C, Dhuurwa, Ranchi- 834004 Email- chiefengineerproject223@gmail.com Mob: 8210263836/7898312628
6	Address of communication

- EOI document and BOQ can be downloaded from the website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>. The downloaded document shall be treated as a valid document for participation in the bid only if payment has been made towards Eol processing fee.
- The EOI processing fee should be deposited in online mode on etender portal i.e. www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in only.
- Cheque/ DD/ Fixed Deposit receipt/ Money Order or saving certificate etc. are not acceptable towards deposit of Eol processing fee and bids with above will be considered without Eol processing fee.
- Any bid shall not be entertained after the deadline under any circumstances whatsoever.
- The undersigned reserves the right to issue, extend the date of publishing/ submission/ opening of bid/ distribute the work among the bidders or reject any / all bids without assigning any reason thereof.
- Corrigendum/ addendum if any will be published in newspaper and also be uploaded on above website.
- Prospective bidders are requested to visit website regularly.

Sd/-

Director, PEL cum General Manager (Project)

PR No. 380270 PR 383781 Jharkhand Urja Utpadan Nigam Ltd(26-27)D

OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER, MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, GWALIOR (M.P.)

WATER SUPPLY DEPARTMENT

File No. 68/2026x9/1/WS/2026 Gwalior, Date : 30/06/2026

नगरपालिका १० संकेत ४६९

Notice Inviting Tender

दिनेक ०१-०७-२०२६

On line tender are invited on behalf of Gwalior Municipal Corporation.

Name Of Work	Probable Amount of Contract	Tender ID No.	Cost of Bid Document & EMD	Last date of purchase online tender dated
वाई क्रमांक ४८ एवं ५२ के विभिन्न क्षेत्रों में सोवर लाइन विद्युत जाने का कार्य ।	1,84,56,520.20	2026_UAD_512260_2	12,500/- 92,283/-	15.07.2026

Further details can be seen at <http://mptenders.gov.in>.

Executive Engineer,
Water Supply South Vidhansabha
Gwalior Municipal Corporation, Gwalior

BEFORE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL -II, DELHI.

4th Floor Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street New Delhi-110001.

Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act 1993 read with rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of

OA NO 127/2021

Kotak Mahindra Bank -Applicant Versus M/s R S Enterprises & Ors. -Respondent

To, DEFENDANT: D1. M/S R S Enterprises, D2. Mr Subhash Mishra, D3. Mr Vikas Mishra, All at: 1/2456 F1 Gali No 24 Ram Nagar Shadha New Delhi – 92, Also at: 1/2455A Street No 25 Ram Nagar Shadha East New Delhi – 32.

Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 24,95,751.07 /- (Rupee Twenty Four Lakh Ninety Five Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty One and Seven Paise Only) against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 14.07.2026 At 11.00 A.M. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence. All the matters will be taken up through video Conferencing or physical and for that purpose:- (i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application/software; (ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding Officer/ Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in; (iii) In any exigency qua that the Advocate/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 23748478. Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this the 04th day of Feb.,2026

By Order of the Tribunal, Sd/- Section Officer, DRT-II, Delhi

8 6

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. JHS/DYCOMM/2026/24 Date: 30.06.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Materials Manager, Office North Central Railway, Jhansi, invites the following E-procurement Tenders.

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Earnest money Deposit (₹)
1	51265668	Set of TPU Ring (Happy Pad) for primary suspension of Fiat bogies to RDSO Drg. No. CG-20049 Alt. 1 item-1&2 (01 Nos. each per set)	10040 Set	₹ 2.84,340/-

Tender Opening Date : 20.07.2026

Note:- The Complete information of above tenders can be seen and download from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/ corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. 1494/26 (MG)

 @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1. Name of Work with its location	Part-C: Replacement of number plates, provision of caution boards, sigma boards, neutral section boards and other reliability activities like tree trimming & muff raising in DUK section inconnection with Strengthening of existing TRD assets in DUK section.
2. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 2,26,81,003.66/-
3. Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 4,53,600/-
4. E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	16.07.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 30.07.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5. E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	30.07.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 18-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 01.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2257/26

varthana

VARTHANA FINANCE PRIVATE LIMITED

Registered Office at: No. 58B-110, Varasiddhi, Outer Ring Road, Service Road, 3rd Block, HRBR Layout, Kalyan Nagar, Bangalore-560043.

Website: www.varthana.com, Email: care@varthana.com, Phone: 080-68455777,

Branch Office: Ajanta, Plot No. 14/73, 3rd Floor, Shipra path Mansarovar, Jaipur, Pincode - 302020.

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR AUCTION FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Asset under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with Rule 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Mortgagor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of M/s. Varthana Finance Private Ltd., Jaipur (Formerly known as Thirumeni Finance Private Ltd), will be sold on 21-07-2026 (Tuesday) at 1 p.m. "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" basis, for recovery of below mentioned loan account. The details of the Borrower(s)/ Mortgagor(s) Secured Assets/ Dues/ Reserve Price/ Auction date and time, EMD & Bid increase amount are mentioned below :-

Name of The Borrowers/Mortgagors : M/s. The Scholars Arena English Medium Secondary School, Represented by its Authorized Signatory, Ms. Vidushi Jain, 2.M/s Padmawati Shikshan Sansthan, Represented by its Authorized Signatory, Ms. Vidushi Jain, 3. Ms. Vidushi Jain, Do Lokesh Jain, 4.Mrs. Sharmila Jain, W/o Lokesh Jain . 5. Mr. Lokesh Jain, S/o Bhura Lal Jain. Loan Account Nos.S24UDA02710 [Client ID-282957].

Details of Total Outstanding Amount in Rupees : Rs. 9,95,74,240/- (Rupees Nine Crore Ninety Five lakhs Seventy Four Thousand Two Hundred and Forty Only) as on 30-06-2026, together with further agreed contractual rate of interest plus legal costs/ charges, till realization of the entire amount.

Details of Immovable Property:

Property No. 1: All that Part and parcel property situated at residential Plot No. 1, Khasra No. 519, 3371/518, Village Titardi, Tehsil Girva District Udaipur, Rajasthan, measuring area 5533 sq ft. Bounded as - East: Road 30 ft wide, West: Khasra no. 559 & Part of 3371/518, North: Khasra No. 518 me, Road 30 ft wide, South: Khasra No. 520.

Property No. 2: All that Part and parcel property situated at Residential Plot No. 1, Khasra No. 522me, 523, 524, Village Titardi, Tehsil Girva, District Udaipur, Rajasthan, measuring area 17280.50 sq ft. Bounded as - East: Khasra No. 520 & 521, West: Khasra no. 526 & Ex House, North: Khasra No. 525 Part and 518, South: Road 30 Ft wide and Khasra No. 530

Property No. 3: All that Part and parcel property situated at Residential Plot No. 1, Khasra No. 509 to 513, Village Titardi, Tehsil Girva, District Udaipur, Rajasthan, measuring area 22385 sq ft. Bounded as - East: Road 60 Ft Wide, West: Khasra No. 514, 531 and The Arena School, North: Garden Khasra No. 508, South: Rasta and Khasra No. 531, 542

The Reserve Price of the above Property/ies will be Rs. 14,09,56,550/- and the Earnest Money Deposit will be (EMD 10% of Reserve Price) Rs. 1,40,95,655/-.

Known Encumbrances, if any : Nil.

Intending bidders should submit their EMD amount and Bid amount along with KYC documents (PAN Card and Aadhaar/Voters ID/Driving Licence) and Rs. 1,000/- being Non-refundable Tender fee by way of Demand Draft/ Pay Order drawn on a Scheduled Bank, favoring "M/s. Varthana Finance Private Limited", payable at Jaipur, before 3 p.m. on or before 20-07-2026 (Monday).

The Auction will be held at: Ajanta, Plot No. 14/73, 3rd Floor, Shipra path Mansarovar, Jaipur, Pincode - 302020 . on 21-07-2026 (Tuesday) at 1-00 p.m.

For detailed terms and conditions of the Sale, please refer to the link provided in Company's website i.e. : www.varthana.com.

The prospective bidders may contact the Authorized Officer Mr.Nikhil Mishra - Phone No.7380626660.

Date : 03-07-2026

Place : Jaipur

Authorized Officer
For Varthana Finance Private Limited,

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BATALIK DAY TRIBUTES

CAPT MANOJ KUMAR PANDEY, PARAM VIR CHAKRA (POSTHUMOUS) 03 JULY



Capt Manoj Kumar Pandey, Pvc



Hav Bhim Bahadur



Hav Ganga Ram Rai



Rfn Kalu Ram Rai

On this momentous occasion of 'BATALIK DAY' we salute and remember CAPT MANOJ KUMAR PANDEY, Param Vir Chakra (Posthumous) who laid down his life while evicting Pakistani intruders during the Kargil War in 1999. The Nation would also remain indebted to the supreme sacrifice of the following brave soldiers who alongwith Capt Manoj Kumar Pandey, Param Vir Chakra (POSTHUMOUS) made the supreme sacrifice during 'OP VLIAY' on this day in 1999.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 1/11 GORKHA RIFLES (BRAVEST OF THE BRAVE) (BATALIK)



BORDER SECURITY FORCE
CONSTABLE SURESH KUMAR 172 BN BSF
15.11.1974 - 03.07.2003

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Suresh Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by m litants in area of CI Post Dharama Ramban J&K and later succumbed to his injuries.



CONSTABLE C STANLY,
KIRTI CHAKRA 10 BN BSF
25.07.1973 - 03.07.2002

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable C Stanly on his Balidan Diwas On this day, he sustained fatal bulter injuries during a counter terror operation in Pulwama (J&K). He fought valiantly and neutralised one militant on the spot before succumbed to his injuries. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with Kirti Chakra (Posthumously)



CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Darshan Singh of 49 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a fierce encounter with militants during an anti-terrorist operation in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 3 July 1992. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

PASCHIM GUJARAT VIJ CO. LIMITED

Reg. & Corp.office, Nana maya main Road, Laxmi Nagar Rajkot-360004

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P1/2026-27/04

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P2/2026-27/05

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P3/2026-27/06

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P4/2026-27/07

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P5/2026-27/08

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P6/2026-27/09

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/UG/RCC P7/2026-27/10

Tender Notice no-PGVCL/Tech/RMU/2026-27/11

tender for "Site Survey, Designing, Engineering, Procurement, Supply, Loading, Transportation, Unloading, Insurance, Delivery at Site, Handling, Storage, Installation, Testing, Commissioning Including Documentation of All Items/Material required to complete works for Turnkey Based Contract For Conversion of Existing 11 kV Over Head HT Line Into Under Ground Cable Network With Ring Main System at Khadi Road, Aji Industrial, Morbi Road, Motamava, Khokhaddad, Vavdi and Madhapar Sub Division of Rajkot City Circle and Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of 11 kV Ring Main Unit with Fencing under area of Rajkot City Circle under PGVCL with GIS Mapping / Geo Urja Mapping (Developed by GUVNL) and Asset Tagging under SIScheme" is put up on our ONLINE (e-tender) website <https://pgvcl.nprocure.com> Interested vendors are requested to submit the tender on line. Tender document for view and download are also available on our website www.pgvcl.com Interested vendors may download the same from this website. In future, if any amendments required for above tender same will be uploaded only on above website.

Chief Engineer (Tech)

"Customer Care Center Toll Free No. 1800 233 155333 & 19122"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No. DRMC/AGRA/PAY & USE/POLICY/2018 Date- 30.06.2026

E-Auction Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway- Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Normal Pay & Use

Auction Catalogue No.: PNU-AGRA-26-A

Asset Details:

Manning of Normal Pay & Use Toilet (IRFC) on Operation and Maintenance (O&M) basis at Agra Fort Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date- 16.07.2026 Time:- 12.00

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date- 16.07.2026 Time:- 12.30

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1489/26 FA

 @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL

ADITYA BIRLA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office- Indian Rayon Compound, Veraval, Gujarat - 362266 Branch Office- Unit No. 710 A | 7th Floor | Corporate Park | B-109 | Sanjay Place | Agra -282002.

APPENDIX IV

[See Rule 8 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]

Possession Notice (for Immovable Property)

Whereas, The undersigned being the authorized officer of Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 had issued a demand notice dated 27-01-2025 calling upon the borrowers VINITA SHARMA, VINITA SHARMA (IN THE CAPACITY OF AVAILABLE LEGAL HEIR OF LATE TARAN TARAN SHARMA) mentioned in the notice being of Rs. 8,08,692.35/- (Rupees Eight Lac Eight Thousand Six Hundred Ninety Two and Thirty Five Paise Only) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers and to the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of the powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act. read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this 30th day of June of the year, 2026.

The borrowers in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited for an amount of Rs. 8,08,692.35/- (Rupees Eight Lac Eight Thousand Six Hundred Ninety Two and Thirty Five Paise Only) and interest thereon. Borrowers attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section 8 of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

All That Piece And Parcel Of Residential Apartment No S-95, Size 707 Sq. Ft., Or Carpet Area Of 44.91 Sq. Mtr. On Second Floor, In Tower E, Block-B, In The Project "Singhal Dream City", Situated At Ladamada, Jaipur Road, Near 100 M Ring Road, Patholi Nahar, Agra, Uttar Pradesh-282001, And Bounded As: East: Others Property West: Other's Property, North: Other's Property, South: 24.0 Mt. Wide Zonal Road (Proposed) & Other's Property

Date: 30.06.2026

Place: AGRA

Authorised Officer
Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

पत्र सं- NWROGSU/GEN/07/2023-O/o CPM/GSU/JUUNWR दिनांक- 30.06.2026

मंडल रेल प्रबंधक, गति शक्ति, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के विश्व एवं उनकी आर से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रवर्धित नियमों के अन्तर्गत निष्पत्ति प्रपत्रों में निविदा निम्न कार्यों के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है-

ई-निविदा सूचना सं० 2026-27:- 08, कार्य का नाम व स्थान:- Augmentation & Upgradation of DEMU maintenance facilities at DEMU Shed Meria Road. Bidding type Normal, अनुमानित लागत रुपये:- 49,87,84,605.65, ब्याचने की राशि रुपये:- 99.75,700.00, निविदा सूचना संख्या एवं निविदा परतुतु/खुले की तिथि GSU-08 of 2026-27 Date 10.08.2026 को 15.00 बजे तक है। वेबसाइट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देली व भरी जा सकती है- www.ireps.gov.in. 944-DO/26

Please join us on        www.ireps.gov.in  

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM-2

For and on behalf of President of Republic of India, Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Construction-II North Western Railway, Jaipur issues following corrigendum in EPC Tender No. EL-C-EPC-TRD-JP-T01-25 26 "Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 132KV/2X25KV Traction Sub Stations (Scott Connected Transformer) with associated Switching Posts for 2 x 25 KVAT feeding system & SCADA in Jaipur - Sawaimadhopu section of Jaipur Division of North Western Railway." Published details:- Similar nature of work not included in document, Corrigendum details:- Similar nature of work has been included in the tender as corrigendum-2 which is available on IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in. All other terms and conditions will remain same.

By, Chief Electrical Engineer/ 945-DO/26

(Construction-II), Jaipur

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)

NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)

Mob.: 9473942568

Email: se4_upjnibly@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 448/M-16/85

Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT RUDAYAN, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upscd.gov.in"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)

NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)

Mob.: 9473942568

Email: se4_upjnibly@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 449/M-16/86

Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT DAHGAWAN, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upscd.gov.in"

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Amit Kumar Sharma S/O Shri Hari Shanker Sharma R/o A-549, Sector-19, Noida, Distt- Gautam Buddh Nagar, U.P- 201301 have changed my name Amit Sharma to Amit Kumar Sharma for all future purposes.

0071045365-1

I, ANEES MOHAMMAD, R/O H.NO- R-1,TAJ ENCLAVE GEETA COLONY, DELHI-110031,HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR DAUGHTER NAME FROM ANUSHA TO ANUSHA FATIMA

0040863813-4

I SAMIKSHA VERMA D/O VIJAY KUMAR VERMA R/O-X/2058 GALI NO 1 RAJGARH EXTN,DELHI-110031 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAMIKSHA VERMA

0040863750-1

I, Pradeep Tyagi S/o Ved Parkash R/o House No. 394, Sector-17, Faridabad, Haryana-121002, have changed my name to PRADEEP KUMAR TYAGI permanently.

0071045432-1

I,Vikrant S/O Vijay Pal Singh,R/O House No.56,1st floor,Block-B, Sec-49, South City II,Gurgaon,Haryana-122018,have change my name from Vikrant to Vikrant Singh

0040863801-12

I,hitherto known as MRIDULA GOHAR,D/O- Shri Vijay Pal,R/O- Flat-B-5,1st-Floor, Prabhu-Apartment,Kishan-Garh,Vasant-Kunj, South-West Delhi,Delhi-110070,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MIRIDULA GOHAR.

0040863802-8

I Sunny S/o Shri Chand Daggar R/o 113 -B, Arjun Nagar, New Delhi -110029 have changed my name to Sunny Daggar for all purposes.

0040863703-3

I,Mehzbín,W/o-Mohammed Javed,R/o A-436,Third-Floor,J. J.Colony,Khyala, Tilak Nagar,Patel Nagar,West,NCT Of Delhi-110018,have changed my name to Mahjabee.

0040863826-3

I,Vansh S/o Manoj Kumar R/o Plot No.209,Meera Enclave EXTN., Part-2, Nanngloi,West Delhi-110041,have changed my name to Vansh Solanki.

0040863801-5

I,Nazma W/o Naushad Siddiqui R/o S-78 Gali No-23,Bhrampuri Garhi Mendu,Delhi-110053,informed that My name and My Husband name and MY DOB has been wrongly written as Nazima W/o Noushad Ali and DOB-1/11/1969, the correct name of mine and my husband and DOB is- Nazma W/o Naushad Siddiqui &-16/8/1696 Respectively.

0040863711-1

I,VINIT SHARMA S/O BHAYA LAL SHARMA R/O HOUSE NO- D-60, DBLOCK, GALI NO-4, GANGA VIHAR, GOKUL PURI, DELHI-110094 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM VINIT SHARMA TO VINEETSHARMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071045396-1

I,Manya w/o Ashish Luthra,r/o B-27/2 UGF Hargovind-Vihar sector-4,Rohini Delhi-110085,have changed my name to MANYA LUTHRA for all purposes.

0040863813-6

I, YASWANT GUSAIN S/o Late Mohan Singh Gusain, R/o Type-II/85, North West Moti Bagh, New Delhi-110021, have changed my name to YASHWANT SINGH GUSAIN for all purposes.

0040863741-2

I, SURINDER SINGH ALIAS CHINAA S/O GURNAM SINGH R/O 1866/139, GANESH PURA, TRI NAGAR, DELHI-110035 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SURINDER SINGH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071045436-1

I Ashish Kumar S/o Mr. Jagbir Singh R/o House No. 17-A, DDA Flats Pocket - B, New Jafraabad, Shahdara, Delhi - 110032 has change my name as Ashish Chaudhary for all future purpose.

0040863705-1

It is for general information that I, Shaji K Nambiar S/o K K Damodaran, R/O 399/Sector 9, R K Puram, ND 110022, declare that the name of mine has been written as K Shaji in all my educational documents and Kottittavai Shaji in my passport No. A5803647. The actual name of mine is Shaji K Nambiar which may be amended accordingly.

0130066375-1

I,MOHD SHADE,S/O ABDUL RAHIM,R/O A-119/1,SUKHDEV NAGAR,NEAR KOTLA MUBARAKPUR,LODHI ROAD,DELHI-110003 have changed my name to MOHAMMAD SAYEED

0040863802-1

I, Ashok Kumar, S/o Sant Kumar, resident of House No. D-196, Sector-61, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name from Ashok Kumar to Ashok Kumar Arora for all future purposes.

0040863811-1

I Vinod Kumar alias Vinod Kumar Sharda S/o Atam Prakash Sharda R/o C -168, LGF, Sarvodaya Enclave, South Delhi, New Delhi -110017 have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Sharda for all purposes.

0040863703-5

I,Jaibir Daggar,S/O Kartar Singh R/O 192, Shahpur Jat, Village Andrewsganj, South Delhi-110049,Have Changed My Name to Jaber Singh.

0040863801-10

I,hitherto known as AMRITA VERMA,W/o-Deepak Kashyap,residing at,A-8/69,Gali.No.-8,Bhajan Pura,Garhi-Mendu,PO:Bhajan Pura,DIST:-North-East Delhi,Delhi-110053,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as AMRITA KASHYAP.

0040863826-6

I,SURJEET SINGH,S/O WAZIR SINGH SEHGAL,H-396,NEAR K.R. MANGLAM SCHOOL,VIKAS PUPI,NEW DELHI-110018,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SURJEET SINGH SEHGAL

0040863801-7

I, Eklavya Bhardwaj S/o Girish Bhardwaj R/o T-12,301, Sunworld Vanalika, Sector-107, Noida, have changed my name to Eklavya Bhardwaj for all future purposes.

0071045347-1

I, Pramod Raghav S/o Netrapal Singh Raghav R/O Flat No.903A, Tower-5, Panchsheel Wellington, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016, have changed my name to PRAMOD KUMAR RAGHAV for all future purposes.

0071045410-1

I,Shakuntla Devi,W/O Late.Prem Singh,R/O House no-C-495 SFS Flats Sector-19 Rohini New-Delhi-110085,have changed my name to SHAKUNTALA Permanently

0040863813-8

I, Arnab S/o Naveet Mohan, R/o 18-D, 2nd Floor, L-Block, DDA Flats Saket, New Delhi-110017 have changed my name to Arnab Mohan for all purposes.

0040863734-1

I, RAJESH KUMAR S/O SHIV PAL R/O HOUSE NO.3079, HOUSING BOARD COLONY, SECTOR-3, BALLABGARH, DISTT. FARIDABAD, HARYANA-121004, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM RAJESH KUMAR TO RAJESH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES

0071045456-1

I,SAARTHAK DAHIYA,S/o-Anup Singh Dahiya R/o-BU-23,Pitamp Pura,Delhi-110034,have changed my minor daughter name AESHNA aged 4 years to AESHNA DAHIYA.

0040863802-3

I,MOHD ABDUL HAQ,S/O-ABDUL WAHEED,R/O-4808,GALI RANG REZAN,BARA HINDU-RAO,DELHI-110006,have changed my name to ABDUL HAQ,for all future Purposes.

0040863813-1

I,K ROSELINE spouse of,K MANOHAAR,R/O-H.No-29-391/4,Vajpai-Nagar, Neredmet,Secunderabad,Telana gana PIN-500056,have changed my name,from K ROSELINE to ROSELINE JAMES vide-affidavit date-30/06/2026,at New-Delhi.

0040863826-8

I, Ram Gopal S/o Ram Singh R/o 2815/28, Gali No-2, Dharampada, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi-110031 have changed my name to Gopal for all purposes.

0040863760-1

I,PURAM KRUPARANI,W/O NEERUDU NARASIMHA,R/o B-1/351, FF, Janakpuri, B1-Block, Delhi-110058,have changed my name to NEERUDU KRUPARANI,for all future purposes.

0040863801-9

I, Archana Bijay Yadav W/O Bijay Kumar Yadav, R/O Supertech Capetown Tower No. CMC-2, Flat No. 1502, Sector-74, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Noida 201304, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name Archana Bijay Yadav to Archana Yadav for all other future.

0071045350-1

I,Mira Devi W/o AKshevar Prasad R/o Gram-Mithapur, Post-Darauli, Thana-Bhabua, Darauli, Kaimur (Bhabua), Darauli, Bihar- 821101, have changed my name to Urmila Devi

0071045418-1

I,KARUNA/KARUNA KUMARI W/O JOGINDER SINGH R/O 118/125/1 STREETNO-5,BLOCK-B SANT-NAGAR BURARI DELHI-110084,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KARUNA CHAUHAN.

0040863813-10

I AYAN S/O ASAD AHMAD R/O-B-17C GALI NO 2 KANTI NAGAR EXTENSION KRISHNA NAGAR EAST DELHI-110051 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AYAAN KHAN

0040863729-1

I,SAROJ RANI W/o-Dilbag Singh Dhandra R/O-B-9/6,FF, Mianwali Nagar, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-87,have Changed my name to SAROJ DHANDRA,permanently

0040863801-2

I, Girish Bhardwaj S/o Shiv Charan Lal, R/O T-12,301, Sunworld Vanalika, Sector-107, Noida, have changed my name to Girish Bhardwaj for all future purposes.

0071045343-1

I,Sharad Kumar Raghav S/o-Sh.Tirlok Singh Raghav,residing at H.No.56/3,Rasoolpur Dasna,NTPC Vidutyt Nagar Dadrn,Gautam Buddh Nagar,UP-201008,have changed the name of my,minor daughter Shivakari Raghav aged-10-years and she shall hereafter be known as Chitrani Shivakari Raghav.

0040863802-5

I,Asha Kumai Duggal,W/o-Kanhya Lal Duggal,R/O-854, Sector-3, Wave City,Ghaziabad-201010, U.P.,have changed my name to Asha Duggal.

0040863813-3

I,Arshad S/o Mohammad Nasir R/o 3258, Gali Farhatullah Khan, Kucha Pandit, Lal Kuan, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Mohammad Arshad for all purposes.

0040863761-1

I, Bijay Tribhuvanram Yadav S/O Tribhuvan Ram Yadav, R/O Supertech Capetown, Tower No. CMC-2, Flat No. 1502, Sector-74, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Noida 201304, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name Bijay Tribhuvanram Yadav to Bijay Kumar Yadav for all other future.

0040863761-1

I,Arshad S/o Mohammad Nasir R/o 3258, Gali Farhatullah Khan, Kucha Pandit, Lal Kuan, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Mohammad Arshad for all purposes.

0040863761-1

I, Bijay Tribhuvanram Yadav S/O Tribhuvan Ram Yadav, R/O Supertech Capetown, Tower No. CMC-2, Flat No. 1502, Sector-74, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Noida 201304, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name Bijay Tribhuvanram Yadav to Bijay Kumar Yadav for all other future.

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I,Arshad S/o Mohammad Nasir R/o 3258, Gali Farhatullah Khan, Kucha Pandit, Lal Kuan, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Mohammad Arshad for all purposes.

0040863761-1

I, VINEET SYAL S/O Vijay Syal, A-2103, Ramprastha Primera, Sector-37D, Basai(50), Gurgaon-120006, have changed my name to VINEET KUMAR SYAL.

0071045430-1

I,Deepmala Kumari,W/O Deepak Kumar,R/O Flat No-2157,Tower-12, 2nd floor,Gold Coast,Crossing Republik,Ghaziabad UP-201016,have change my name from Deepmala to Deepmala Kumari

0040863801-11

I, Ravindra Kumar S/o Bhagatram Saxena R/o Village Keshampur Post Jua, Pasapur, Auriya, UP-206247 have changed my name to Ravindra kumar Saxena for all future purposes

0071045357-1

I,Ramesh/Ramesh Goel S/O.Puran Chand R/o H.No-196,1st Floor,and 2nd-Floor, Sandesh Vihar,Pitampura,Saraswati Vihar,Delhi-110034,have changed my name to Ramesh Kumar.

0040863802-7

I Mohammad Nafees S/o Mohammad Shareef R/o 574, 4th Floor, Gali No. 12, Jamia Nagvar, Zakir Nagar, PO: New Friends Colony, Dist: South Delhi, Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Mohamm Nafees for all purposes.

0040863703-2

I,AMANA,W/O NABBAN,R/O H.NO-E-49/B-455,JANTA-MAZDOOR COLONY STREET-NO-25,NEAR HANUMAN TEMPLE, WELOCME, SEELAMPUR,NORTH EAST,DELHI-110053,have changed my name to AAMNA permanently.

0040863826-2

I,Piyush S/o Pardeep Kumar,R/O H.No.533/4,Gali.No.-2,Shankar Garden Line Par,Bahadurgarh Distt Jhajjar(Haryana), have changed my name to Piyush Sharma.

0040863801-4

I,MD KAIF S/o MOHD IRSHAD, R/O H NO. N-8-B, N-Block, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to MOHAMMAD KAIF

0071045338-1

I, Monika & Monika Chauhan W/o Girish Bhardwaj R/o T-12,301, Sunworld Vanalika, Sector-107, Noida, have changed my name to Monika Bhardwaj for all future purposes.

0071045345-1

I, Patricia G Rebeiro W/o Virender George R/O C-12, Tower-4, Type-4 East Kidwai Nagar, Delhi-110023, Delhi INDIA, declare that name of my husband has been wrongly written as Virender George Rebeiro in my Service Records. The actual name of my husband is Virender George, respectively which may be amended accordingly.

0071045381-1

I, Patricia G Rebeiro W/o Virender George R/O C-12, Tower-4, Type-4 East Kidwai Nagar, Delhi-110023, Delhi INDIA, declare that name of my husband has been wrongly written as Virender George Rebeiro in my Service Records. The actual name of my husband is Virender George, respectively which may be amended accordingly.

0071045381-1

I,Patricia G Rebeiro W/o Virender George R/O C-12, Tower-4, Type-4 East Kidwai Nagar, Delhi-110023, Delhi INDIA, declare that name of my husband has been wrongly written as Virender George Rebeiro in my Service Records. The actual name of my husband is Virender George, respectively which may be amended accordingly.

0071045381-1

I,Patricia G Rebeiro W/o Virender George R/O C-12, Tower-4, Type-4 East Kidwai Nagar, Delhi-110023, Delhi INDIA, declare that name of my husband has been wrongly written as Virender George Rebeiro in my Service Records. The actual name of my husband is Virender George, respectively which may be amended accordingly.

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I,Patricia G Rebeiro W/o Virender George R/O C-12, Tower-4, Type-4 East Kidwai Nagar, Delhi-110023, Delhi INDIA, declare that name of my husband has been wrongly written as Virender George Rebeiro in my Service Records. The actual name of my husband is Virender George, respectively which may be amended accordingly.

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0071045381-1

I,Sneh Lata,W/O-Parveen,R/O- House no-A-201,Satya Shanti Apartments Plot no-23, Sector-13,Rohini,New Delhi-110085,have changed my name to SNEH LATA CHHIKARA Permanently

0040863813-7

I,PARSHANT S/o Yashwant Singh Gusain @ Yaswant Gusain, R/o HouseNo. 272, R.K. Puram, Sector-12, New Delhi-110022, have changed my nameto PARSHANT GUSAIN for all purposes.

0040863741-3

Indu Bala Aggarwal W/o Anand Prakash Aggarwal residing AM-101, First Floor, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi -110088 changed name to Indu Aggarwal

0130066413-1

I,Arati Kumari Paswan W/O Shyam Sunder Singh R/o Hanuman Mandir Gali Railmandi Jaswantnagar Etawah U.P have changed my name to Arati vide Affidavit dated.14/03/2026 at Delhi.

0050292420-1

I,PRIYANSHU RAJ ARORA,S/O Dharmesh Raj Arora R/O-8-B,Platinum-Enclave, Pocket-I Sector-18,Rohini,Delhi-110089 have changed my name to PRIYANSHUU RAJ ARORA

0040863802-2

I, Jaanhavee, D/o Laxman Prasad, resident of Royale Tower-212,Shirap Suncity,Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, have changed my name from Jaanhavee to Jahnavi Prajapati. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jahnavi Prajapati for all future purposes.

0040863802-2

I, Jaanhavee, D/o Laxman Prasad, resident of Royale Tower-212,Shirap Suncity,Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, have changed my name from Jaanhavee to Jahnavi Prajapati. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jahnavi Prajapati for all future purposes.

0040863802-2

I, Jaanhavee, D/o Laxman Prasad, resident of Royale Tower-212,Shirap Suncity,Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, have changed my name from Jaanhavee to Jahnavi Prajapati. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jahnavi Prajapati for all future purposes.

0040863802-2

I, Jaanhavee, D/o Laxman Prasad, resident of Royale Tower-212,Shirap Suncity,Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, have changed my name from Jaanhavee to Jahnavi Prajapati. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jahnavi Prajapati for all future purposes.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Varsha Sharma prop of M/s Varsha Saree Godam, At: G.F., A-2/A, Kh. No. 66-67, Main Road, Near Mayur Public School, Prem Nagar, Karawal Nagar, North-East, Delhi-94, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CC No. 7817/24, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Kotwali, North Distt., Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that Varsha Sharma prop of M/s Varsha Saree Godam the said accused of CC No. 7817/24, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Kotwali, North Distt., Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.08.2026.

By Order

Sh. Arjun Kirar

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,

DP/8986/N/2026 (NI Act), Central, Room No.-02, Ground Floor, (Court Matter) CBA-1, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

कार्यालय महाप्रबन्धक (सि०),
उ.प्र. राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
ए-1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अन्तर्गत विकास/अनुरक्षण/उत्पत्तिकरण कार्य हेतु सरकारी विभागों/सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निगमों में कार्यरत कर्मों/वर्कचरों से ई-निविदायेँ आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलॉड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है:-

1. क्रमांक 1 पर अंतिम कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 03.07.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 23.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिन्हें दिनांक 23.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अर्थव्यवस्था)

2. क्रमांक 2 पर अंतिम कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 03.07.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 10.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिन्हें दिनांक 10.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अर्थव्यवस्था)

निविदादाताओं द्वारा कौशल शायनपत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा प्रपत्रों में उत्तिरिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती हैं। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का निरपेक्ष निम्नवत् है:-

क्रमांक

कार्य का नाम

कार्य की लागत
रु० (लाख में)

1

Construction of Boundary Wall of Park (only Civil Work) for I.A. Site-5, Kasna, Distt.-G.B. Nagar.

154.38

2

Construction / Repair of Boundary Wall and foot path of Boundary Wall and foot path of park (only Civil Work) for I.A. EPIP Kasna, Distt. G.B. Nagar.

144.69

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरे अंतिम करें। जीएसटीएल अलग से देय होगा।
निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: <https://beta.upsidamarketplace.com> पर स्थित ई-लिक एवं यूटिलिटी की website: <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है।
अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के विरिध प्रबन्धक (सि०) के श्री प्रवीण कुमार सलोनिया मोबाइल नं० 9871090103 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

महाप्रबन्धक (सि०)
उपप्रबन्धक(विभाग), कानपुर

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

HYDERABAD METROPOLITAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER

East Wing, 7th FLOOR, Swarna Jayanthi Commercial Complex, Ameerpet, HYDERABAD-500038.

e - Procurement Tender Notice

Tenders are invited on e-procurement from valid Registered Contractors for the following works:

S. No.	NIT No	Name of work	Tender inviting authority	Last date of submission of bids online	
1.	HMDA/DE VICE/12/ 2026-27, Date:- 02-07-2026	"System Integrator Services for Preparation, Development, Implementation, and Maintenance of 3D City Model for Core Urban Region Economy (CURE) and a GIS based Geospatial Base Map for Hyderabad Metropolitan Region (HMR), Future City Development Authority (FCDA), and Yadagirigutta Temple Development Authority (YTDA) Areas"	Chief Engineer, HMDA	Uploading of RFP on Procurement Platform Pre-bid Meeting Uploading Pre Bid Queries & Amendments if any Last Date for receiving Bids Online	04-07-2026 13-07-2026 20-07-2026 31-07-2026

For further details visit <https://tender.telangana.gov.in>
DIPR R.O. No.: 272/PPCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:02-07-2026 Sd/- Chief Engineer, HMDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

Tender Notice No. DSL-TKD-WLU-Misc-26 Dated 01.07.2026

The Sr. DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work. The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.

Name of work	"Provision for Cleaning & washing of waterless urinals; Cleaning and washing of driver seat cover Set; Removal and reinstallation/retit of fire extinguisher, wooden wedges and spare BP-FP pipes/hoses; and Sand filling in Sanders of Electric Locomotive at Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad for 02 year."
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044.
Completion period	02 years
Approximate cost of work	Rs. 24,55,370.51/- Including GST (Rs. Twenty Four Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Three Hundred Seventy and Fifty one paise only including GST)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 49,100/- (Rs. Forty Nine Thousand One Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Website to download and upload e-tender document	www.ireps.gov.in
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	23.07.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date & Time of Tender opening	23.07.2026 after 12:00 Hrs.
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender.

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in. For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document. 2266/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHRAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)
Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 443/M-16/80
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT KALAN, DISTRICT-SHAHJAHANPUR" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
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Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 447/M-16/84
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT KACHHLA, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS
KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in, Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010
LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 22-06-2026, one person namely Lyaqat Ali S/O Mohd. Iqbal R/O Lowang Tehsil Bani District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Bani stating therein that on 19-06-2026 his wife namely Zahida Bano, age 30 years went missing from home. The complainant made best efforts to search for his wife but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 11 dated 22-06-2025 has been entered at Police Station Bani.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing lady, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL

- Name
- Husband
- Permanent Address
- Present Address
- Tehsil
- Police Station
- Age
- Height
- Complexion
- Built
- Eyes
- Languages known

Zahid Bano

Mohd. Iqbal

Lowang

Lowang

Bani

Bani

30 years

5 feet 04 inch

Wheatish

Normal

Oval

Black

Kashmiri/Hindi

PHOTOGRAPH



Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)

2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)

3. PCR Kathua-01922-234311(Phone/Fax)

4. Police Station Bani-9103007515

Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua

DIP/J-4849/26 Date: July 02 2026

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHRAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)
Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 442/M-16/79
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT ALLHAGANJ, DISTRICT-SHAHJAHANPUR" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHRAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)
Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 446/M-16/83
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT MUDIYA, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHRAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)
Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 444/M-16/81
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT SAIDPUR, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
NEAR MANOHAR BHUSHRAN INTER COLLEGE, JAL NIGAM COLONY, GANDHI NAGAR, BAREILLY (U.P.)
Mob.: 9473942568
Email: se4_upjnbl@yahoo.co.in

Letter No.: 445/M-16/82
Dated: 02.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online E-tenders for execution of Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation if required, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for Interception and Diversion Works of tapping drain "USED WATER MANAGEMENT AT KUNWARGAON, DISTRICT-BUDAUN" including successful testing and commissioning of said work on percentage rate "Turn-key basis" under SBM(U)-2.0 Programme. Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-tender documents will be available for download from Date 07.07.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on Date 10.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till Date- 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 24.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs. in the office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Bareilly in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00+GST@18%. Details are available On U.P. Govt. <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website "http://www.jn.upsdc.gov.in"

कार्यालय प्रधानाचार्य महर्षि देवरहा बाबा स्वशासी राज्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, देवरिया, उ.प्र.- 274001

विज्ञप्ति

महर्षि देवरहा बाबा स्वशासी राज्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, देवरिया के विभिन्न विभागों में विशिष्टतावार रिक्त आचार्य-14, सह-आचार्य-22, सहायक आचार्य-14 के रिक्त पदों पर नियमित नियुक्ति हेतु निर्धारित प्रपत्र पर आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। जिसका आवेदन पत्र अधोहस्ताक्षरी कार्यालय में रजिस्टर्ड डाक द्वारा समस्त प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वप्रमाणित छायाप्रति सहित दिनांक- 31.07.2026 को सायं 5.00 बजे तक प्राप्त किये जायेंगे। उपरोक्त पद हेतु इच्छुक अम्थर्थी जो नवीनतम एन0एम0सी0 मानकानुसार (T.E.Q. 2025) योग्यता रखते हों वह आवेदन पत्र कालेज की वेबसाइट mdbmc.ac पर देखी जा सकती है। विभावार पदों की संख्या एवं श्रेणी का विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्र०सं०	विशिष्टता	आचार्य		सह आचार्य		सहायक आचार्य		योग
		पदों की संख्या	श्रेणी	पदों की संख्या	श्रेणी	पदों की संख्या	श्रेणी	
01	आर्थोपेडिक्स	1	OBC	1	SC	-	-	2
02	आय्थामोलॉजी	1	SC	1	UR	-	-	2
03	आर्द्वक्सि एण्ड गाइनोकलॉजी	1	SC	-	-	1	OBC	2
04	इमरजेन्सी मेडिसिन	1	UR	1	OBC	1	UR	3
05	एनॉटमी	-	-	1	SC	-	-	1
06	एनेस्थिसियोलॉजी	1	OBC	2	1 UR 1 SC	1 OBC 1 SC	5	5
07	आटो-राइनो-लेरिगोलॉजी	1	UR	1	OBC	-	-	2
08	कम्प्युनिटी मेडिसिन	-	-	1	SC	3	1 EWS 1 OBC 1 UR	4
09	जनरल मेडिसिन	1	OBC	3	2 UR 1 OBC	2	1 SC 1 ST	6
10	जनरल सर्जरी	1	OBC	2	1 EWS 1 OBC	2	OBC	4
11	टयुबरकुलेसिस एण्ड रेस्पिरेटरी मेडिसिन/पल्मोनरी मेडिसिन	-	-	1	SC	-	-	1
12	डर्मटोलॉजी वेरेरोलॉजी एण्ड लेप्रोसी	-	-	1	UR	1	SC	2
13	डेन्टिस्ट्री	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
14	पीडियाट्रिक्स	1	EWS	1	OBC	-	-	2
15	पैथोलॉजी	1	SC	-	-	-	-	1
16	फार्माकोलॉजी	-	-	1	SC	-	-	1
17	फिजियोलॉजी	1	SC	-	-	-	-	1
18	फोरेन्सिक मेडिसिन	1	OBC	1	SC	1	SC	3
19	बायोकेमेस्ट्री	-	-	1	OBC	-	-	1
20	माइक्रोबायोलॉजी	1	EWS	1	EWS	1	SC	3
21	रेडियोडायग्नोसिस	1	OBC	1	OBC	1	SC	3
22	साइकियाट्री	-	-	1	EWS	-	-	1
योग		14		22		14		50

EWS अम्थर्थी के सम्बन्ध में भारत सरकार के कार्यालय झाप दिनांक-31.01.2019 के प्रस्तर 6.3 में निहित व्यवस्था के अनुसार कार्मिक अनुभाग-2 के संदर्भित कार्यालय झाप दिनांक 18.02.2019 के अनुसार "यदि किसी चयन वर्ष में आर्थिक रूप से कमजोर वर्गों के लिए चिन्हांकित पदों की रिक्तियों के सापेक्ष उपयुक्त अम्थर्थी उपलब्ध नहीं होते हैं, तो उक्त रिक्तियों को आगामी चयन वर्ष में बैंकलॉग के रूप में अप्रेनीत नहीं किया जायेगा और उक्त रिक्ति को अनारक्षित वर्ग के अर्ह अम्थर्थियों द्वारा भरा जायेगा" मान्य होगा।

01- आयु: उपर्युक्त पदों के लिए अम्थर्थी की आयु कैलेंडर वर्ष की 01 जुलाई 2026 को न्यूनतम उम्र 26 से कम एवं अधिकतम उम्र 62 वर्ष से अधिक नहीं होनी चाहिए।

वेतनमान:-

क-आचार्य-एकेडमिक लेवल-14 इन्ट्री. पे रू०-1,44,200.00

ख-सह आचार्य-एकेडमिक लेवल-13ए इन्ट्री पे रू०-1,31,400.00

ग-सहायक आचार्य-एकेडमिक लेवल-11 इन्ट्री पे रू०-68,900.00

(राज्य सरकार द्वारा राजकीय मेडिकल कालेजों में आचार्य, सह आचार्य एवं सहायक आचार्य को प्रदत्त वेतन/भत्ते मान्य होंगे)

02- आवेदन शुल्क :-

रुपये-1000.00 (एक हजार रुपये मात्र) का आवेदन शुल्क डिमाण्ड ड्राफ्ट के रूप में प्रधानाचार्य, महर्षि देवरहा बाबा स्वशासी राज्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय देवरिया के पक्ष में देय होगा।

03- चयन प्रक्रिया में प्रतिभाग करने हेतु किसी भी प्रकार का यात्रा भत्ता इत्यादि देय नहीं होगा।

04-पदों की संख्या घट या बढ़ सकती है।

05-इच्छुक अम्थर्थी निर्धारित आवेदन प्रपत्र को (वेबसाइट <http://mdbmc.ac.in> और www.updgme.com) से डाउनलोड करके पूर्ण रूप से भरकर, अपने समस्त प्रमाण पत्रों को सत्यापित करते हुए दिनांक 31.07.2026 को सायं 05:00 बजे तक प्रधानाचार्य महर्षि देवरहा बाबा स्वशासी राज्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय, देवरिया-274001 में केवल स्पीड पोस्ट/रजिस्टर्ड डाक के माध्यम से उपलब्ध कराया जाना सुनिश्चित करें।

06-अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय के पश्चात तथा अपूर्ण आवेदन पत्र स्वीकार नहीं किये जायेंगे।

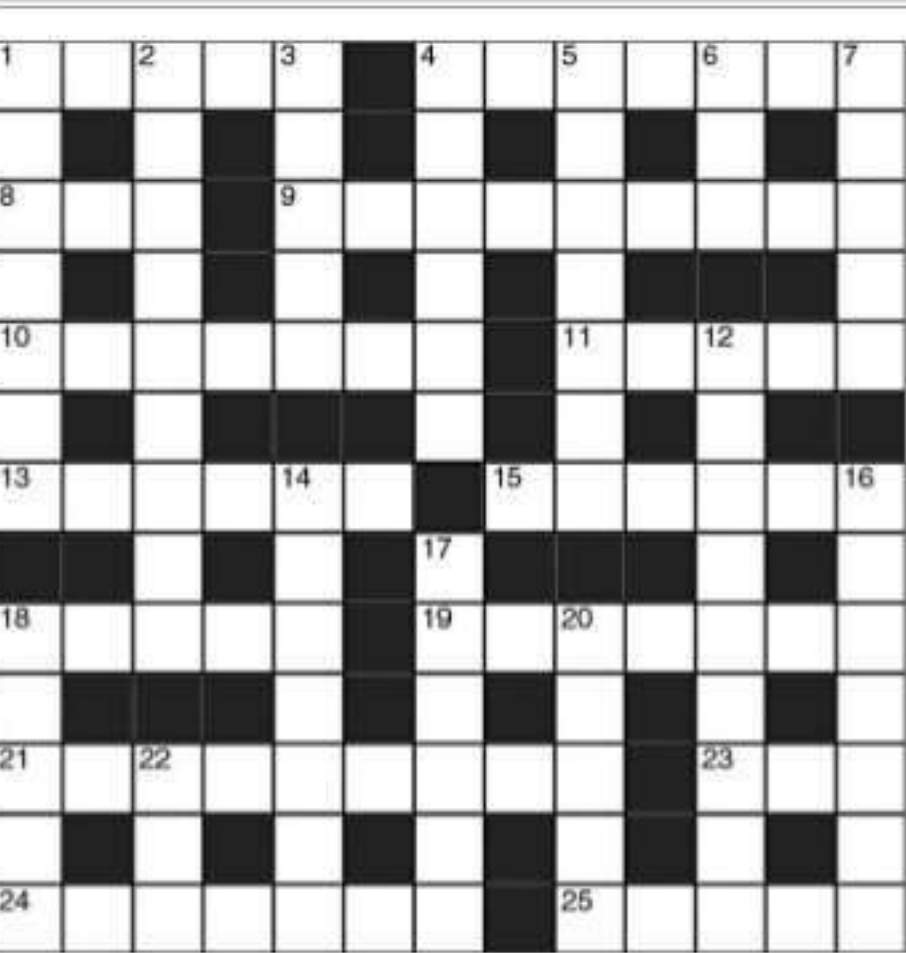
प्रधानाचार्य

पत्रांक: मे०का०दे०/विभाग०/2026-27/1554 दिनांक: 30.06.2026

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Scope provided by the morning and a little after (5)
- 4 Concerned to see the vehicle gets fresh fuel (7)
- 8 A brew the French accentuate (3)
- 9 The more there are, the fewer there are (9)
- 10 Quality perfume (7)
- 11 Refuse to make a stew ungracefully (5)
- 13 Good man maps out marks of official approval (6)
- 15 Current supplier has Monday off (6)
- 18 Strange job an instrumentalist may hold (5)
- 19 It's no good by all accounts (3,4)
- 21 An uninspiring way to die (9)
- 23 Robin has a sash for his middle (3)
- 24 Signed up in presentation for a match? (7)
- 25 Lily reveals a great deal to us (5)
- DOWN
- 1 She plays with a key in a lock (7)
- 2 No bait was ordered by the warrant officer (9)
- 3 Attendants in school (5)
- 4 Chews a sort of nut (6)
- 5 Landing strip harbours a fugitive (7)
- 6 Charge made to iron with energy (3)
- 7 Being upset Leslie misses the point of the yarn (5)
- 12 He's given unwarranted responsibility (9)
- 14 Stretch a point and look inside (7)
- 16 New ones may be expensive if stout perhaps (7)
- 17 A piece of wood on ship (6)
- 18 Cook and sew (5)
- 20 Live and prosper lacking nothing (5)
- 22 Diagram when reduced is a worthless thing (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6030 ACROSS: 1 Lasting out, 8 Sepia, 9 Tunisia, 10 Classic, 11 Blaze, 12 No dice, 14 As well, 17 Motel, 19 Laid out, 21 Tourist, 22 Exits, 23 Presenting DOWN: 2 Applaud, 3 Thaws, 4 Notice, 5 Omnibus, 6 Tessa, 7 Satellites, 8 Second mate, 13 Collide, 15 Erosion, 16 Clothe, 18 Thump, 20 Inert

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Some people like my ___ so much that they frame it upon the wall instead of using it. - Gordon Dickson (6)

BRVAE

DEBASE

EPSCI

DEGLOV

Some people like my advice so much that they frame it upon the wall instead of using it. - Gordon Dickson

SOLUTIONS: BRVAE: Brave, EPSCI: Spice/Epics, Seebled, Gloved

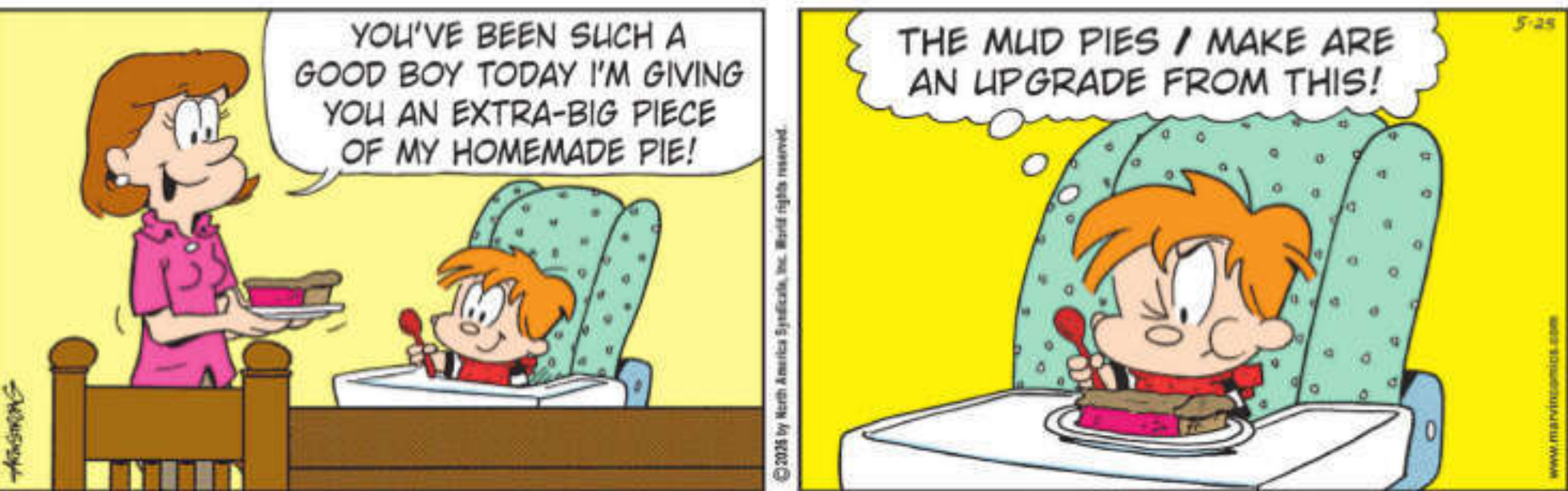
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6368

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6367

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a slightly accident-prone day for you, so pay attention. Plans might suddenly change today. Bright ideas might suddenly occur. Expect to see new places and faces. Tonight: Be friendly.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a tricky day with spending money. Try to restrict your spending to food and gas. A totally different influence will encourage you to make spontaneous financial decisions and impulsive purchases. Tonight: Someone will notice you.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Be careful, this is an accident-prone day. It makes you impulsive and quick to change your mind. Pay attention to everything you say and do. Tonight: Learn something new. Explore ideas.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): There's an electric energy that can make people say and do things they might regret today. Fortunately, the Sun in your sign gives you steady strength. Tonight: Check your finances.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today, you will be diplomatic and charming with others, because friends and groups might surprise you or catch you off guard in some way. Plans will change. You might meet someone new who is unusual. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Double-check all your dealings and communications with bosses, parents and VIPs today because sudden changes might take things in a direction you did not expect. It's a poor day for important decisions as well as spending money. Tonight: Get better organised.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Be aware that unexpected changes to travel plans are likely today. Double-check your agenda and travel details. Legal or medical matters also might create some surprises, along with school schedules. Take nothing for granted. Tonight: Socialise with someone.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Make friends with your bank account today because issues related to banking, finances, debt and inheritances are subject to sudden changes or goofy errors. Make sure you know what is happening. Tonight: Relax at home.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today friends, spouses, partners and even members of the general public might do something you didn't expect. Take a beat before you react. Keep your eyes open. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your work routine might be interrupted today due to technical problems or late deliveries. Give yourself extra time so you have wiggle room to deal with the unexpected. Restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Take care of your belongings.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Parents should be extra vigilant today to make sure that accidents with their kids don't happen. Social plans might suddenly change. They might be cancelled or you might receive a surprise invitation. Tonight: You're strong and confident.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Your home routine will be interrupted today. Small appliances might break down or a minor breakage could occur, or surprise company might appear at your door. This is a great time to party. Tonight: Enjoy some privacy.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Jubair, S/o** Sabuddin, **R/o** Masjid Wali Gali, Mirja Pur, Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P., has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 32666/2018, U/s. 379/411/482/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Khajuri Khas, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Jubair**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Jubair**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).. Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Jubair**, **FIR No. 32666/2018, U/s. 379/411/482/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Khajuri Khas, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Shruti Saraswat

Judicial Magistrate First Class -03, Room No. 22, First Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/8563/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Jawed S/o:** Abdul Haq, **R/o:** H.No. E-408, JJ Colony Bawana, **Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 428/2020, Dt. 19.08.2020, U/S: 324 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jawed**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jawed**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jawed**, of **FIR No. 428/2020, Dt. 19.08.2020, U/S: 324 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sahil Gupta

Judicial Magistrate First Class North Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8286/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Shankar, S/o:** Hari Singh, **R/o:** H.No. 4U, Ground Floor Kh. No. 09/24, Vikas Vihar, Extn Nihal Vihar, P.Chander Vihar, Nihal Vihar, **Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 917/2023, U/s 411/34 IPC, P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shankar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shankar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Shankar**, of **Case FIR No. 917/2023, U/s 411/34 IPC, P.S.: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.08.2026**.

By Order

Komal Garg

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (West) Room No. 22, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8892/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Collins S/o:** Okuwaye **R/o:** Near Aggarwal Chowk, Chander Vihar, New Delhi, Nihal Vihar, Outer District, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 828/2021, U/s: 14 Foreigners Act, PS: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Collins**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Collins**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Collins**, of **FIR No. 828/2021, U/s: 14 Foreigners Act, PS: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Komal Garg

Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 West District Room No. 292 Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8415/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

WANTED

General public is hereby informed that this person **Named:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** Approx. 40 years, **Height:** Approx. 5'10", **Build:** Thin, **Complexion:** Shallow, **Hair:** almost Bald, **Wearing:** Light grey Shirt and dark Greyish Pant. The person shown in the picture is wanted in connection of case **FIR No. 175/26, at P.S.: Sunlight Colony, Delhi**. However it has been learnt that the accused is generally referred as "**Lambu Kabadi**" as he reportedly earns his livelihood as a ragpicker. In this regard, **FIR No. 175/26, U/S 103(1) BNS Dtd. 14.05.2026** has been registered at **P.S.: Sunlight Colony, Delhi**. Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about the suspect but no clue has come to light so far. Any person having information regarding his identity, whereabouts, movements, or associates is requested to immediately inform the undersigned on following numbers or the nearest Police Station. Information provided will be treated with appropriate confidentiality in accordance with law.

SHO

P.S.: Sunlight Colony, Delhi

Ph.: 8750870928, 8750870988

DP/8916/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Arun Kumar @ Sethi, S/o:** Rajesh Kumar **R/o:** H.No. 100, Nai Bsati Village Bakner Narela, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 743/2021, U/s: 356/379/411 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Arun Kumar @ Sethi**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Arun Kumar @ Sethi**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Arun Kumar @ Sethi**, of **FIR No. 743/2021, U/s: 356/379/411 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.08.2026**.

By Order

Sahil Gupta

Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 North Court No. 06 1st Floor Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8847/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Saurabh S/o Rakesh Kumar R/o H. No. B-2/147, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 186/2016, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Saurabh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Saurabh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Saurabh** of case **FIR No. 186/2016, U/s 379/411 IPC, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **06.08.2026**.

By Order

Sanghmitra

Judicial Magistrate First Class-01 Room No. 54, 2nd Floor Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8944/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Chand Mohammad S/o** Lt. Khushid Alam **R/o** Jhuggi No A 594, Subhash Camp, Dakshinpuri New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 496/2025 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS Act PS: Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi**. and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Chand Mohammad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Chand Mohammad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Chand Mohammad** accused of **FIR No. 496/2025 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS Act PS: Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Akansha Gautam

JMFC-02, Room No. 513 Saket Courts New Delhi

DP/8818/SE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Bhola, S/o:** Puran Dass, **R/o:** 62, J.J. Colony, Indra Camp Part-2, Hasanpur Depot, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 320/2019, U/s 411 IPC, P.S.: G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bhola** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bhola** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Bhola** accused of case **FIR No. 320/2019, U/s 411 IPC, P.S.: G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Sanghmitra

Judicial Magistrate First Class - 01 Room No. 54, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/8938/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Guljar, S/o:** Shamsuddin, **R/o:** Plot No. 45-46, Aman Complex, Shankar Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad, U.P. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 574/2022, U/s 392/394/397/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Civil Lines, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Guljar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Guljar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Guljar** accused of case **FIR No. 574/2022, U/s 392/394/397/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Civil Lines, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Kartik Taparia

Judicial Magistrate First Class - 06 Room No. 247, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8863/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Jitendra S/o** Jile Singh **R/o** Ludhiyana Jagana Near Airport, Ravinder Complex, Ludhiyana City, Punjab, **Also at:** Village-Duhara Khera, Distt.-Jind, Haryana, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 86/2021, U/S 279/304A IPC, PS G.T.B. Enclave, Shahdara Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitendra** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitendra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Jitendra** the said accused of **FIR No. 86/2021, U/S 279/304A IPC, PS G.T.B. Enclave, Shahdara Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.08.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Sanghmitra

Judicial Magistrate First Class-01, Court No. -54, 2nd Floor, Shahdara Distt., Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8941/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

AUCTION NOTICE

It is submitted that Hon'b/e MACT Courts has directed initiation of steps for public auction of the offending vehicle No. **DL-8C-AF-5093 (Hyundai New Varna CRDI SX 1.6 S Silver Colour, Chasis No. MALCU41UMEM170969, Engine No. D4FBEM150321** in involved in **FIR No. 381/2020, U/s 279/304A IPC & 146/196 MV Act, PS Delhi Cantt., New Delhi**.

It is therefore requested that the information regarding auction is scheduled to be held on **05.07.2026 at 02:00 PM at Police Station Delhi Cantt., New Delhi**.

For further details, the contact number of the **SHO, Delhi Cantt. is: 9871581321**.

By Order - Sh. Shirish Aggarwal

PO-MACT-01

Room No. 04, Main Building

DP/8246/SW/2026 Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

● **RESULTS**

ROUND OF 32

Belgium 3-2 Senegal
Seattle Stadium

USA 2-0 Bosnia

San Francisco Bay Area

● **MATCH SCHEDULE**

ROUND OF 32

Switzerland v Algeria
Vancouver, 8.30 am

(Friday)

Australia v Egypt
Dallas, 11.30 pm

(Friday)

Argentina v Cape Verde
Miami, 3.30 am

(Saturday)

Colombia v Ghana
Kansas City, 7 am

(Saturday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Congo coach Sébastien Desabre at a media briefing. AP

Congo coach shocked by news of father's death

CONGO COACH Sébastien Desabre's historic journey with the team to knockouts ended on a sombre note after their 1-2 defeat to England on Wednesday, when an abrupt announcement of his father's death in the post-match press conference left him momentarily in shock. While the coach was speaking at the post-match press conference, the media officer interjected towards the end and announced the coach's bereavement. "Thank you but we are announcing that the coach has lost his father," the media officer announced in French. "So sincere condolences," he added before concluding the press conference. ENS

Three fans run on pitch during Belgium game

THREE PEOPLE ran onto the field during Wednesday's World Cup match between Belgium and Senegal in the round of 32, causing a stoppage of play. The people disrupted the game in the 32nd minute. Roughly a dozen security guards were deployed to get them off the field. Belgium defender Maxim De Cuyper held onto the ball amid the incident. The Red Devils overturned a two-goal deficit in the game and scored from the penalty spot deep into extra time to beat Senegal 3-2 in the biggest comeback of the World Cup so far and will face co-hosts USA in the next round. AP

STARS AND STRIPES SHINE

Tillman bends it for USA

The German-born American midfielder took the decisive free-kick with bloodied toes against Bosnia



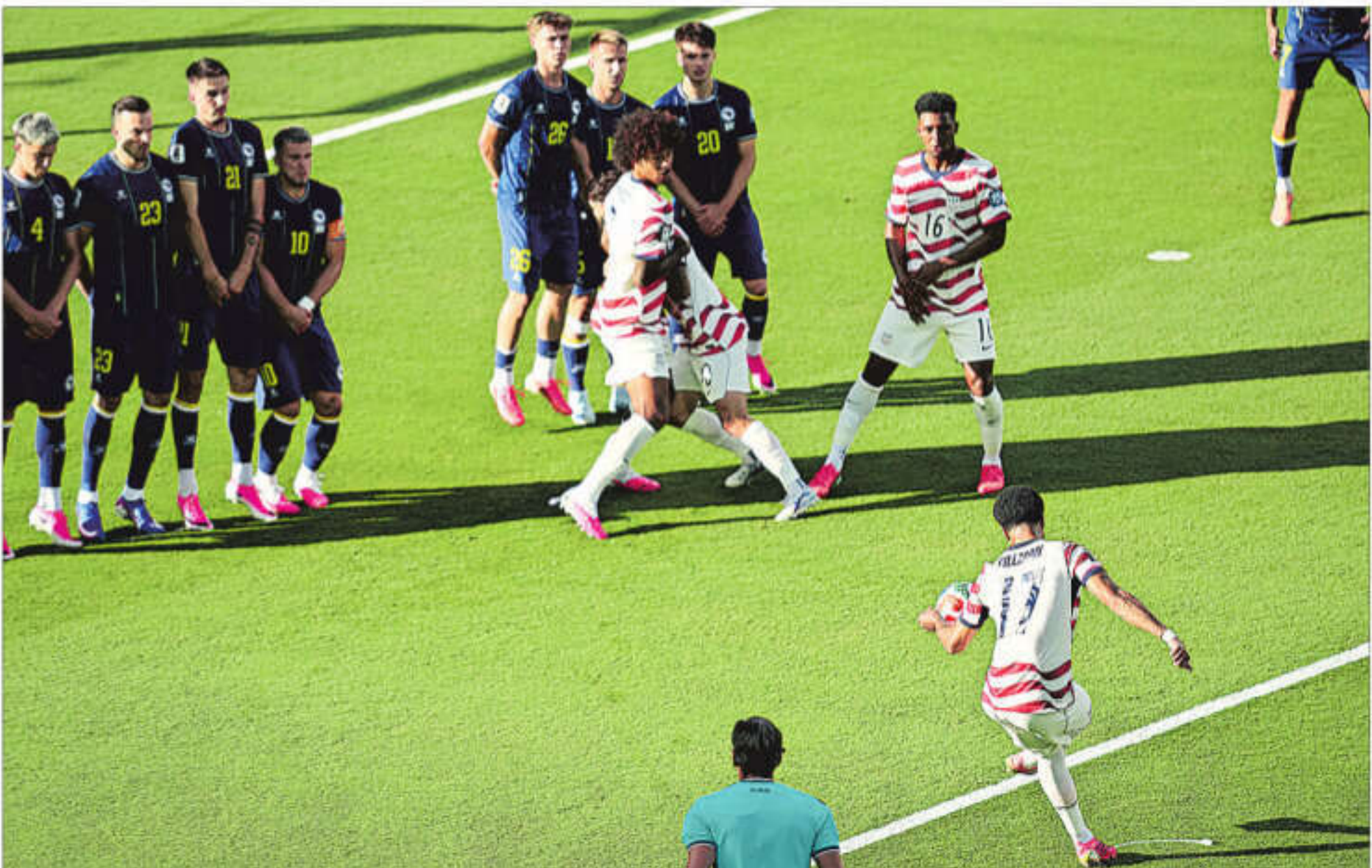
Sandip G
New York, July 2

HIS FRIENDS call Malik Tillman 'Tequila'. The mild-mannered midfielder is not a party animal, but he downed numerous shots of the Mexican drink the night PSV Eindhoven were crowned Dutch champions in 2024. The moniker travelled with him to Bayer Leverkusen and USMNT. An artificial intelligence spun meme has him holding a Tequila shot, wearing a sombrero. "Funny, how it has stuck along," he once told Bundesliga.com.

The goal he produced to punch USA's ticket to the round-of-16 with a 2-0 win over Bosnia and Herzegovina, was as strong and intoxicating for the fans as the drink he is named after. The co-hosts were scrambling towards a victory when their hero and first-half goalscorer Folarin Balogun was sent off for what the referee, in consultation with VAR, decided was a dangerous challenge on Tarik Muharemovic. The replays suggested it was accidental rather than malicious, but the referee's perspective differed.

The carnival in the stands stopped. Anxiety washed the fans, who rose from the seats and stood, chewing their nails, splitting their hair, clapping for every blunted Bosnia intrusion, exulting for every upfield thrust of theirs.

Then stepped up the hero.



United States' Malik Tillman takes a free-kick against Bosnia and Herzegovina. (Below) Tillman celebrates the conversion. AP

Son of a war hero.

Born in Nuremberg, Germany where his father was stationed. Ten minutes away from closure, US won a free-kick on the edge of the box, a likeable though not an ideal angle for a right-footed free-kick specialist. Christian Pulisic and the senior players had a brief chat before the lot and fate fell on Tillman. He took a deep breath at the top of his run-up, meditated for an eternity, before he walked towards the ball, steadily gathering momentum, and wrapped his instep around it.

The ball ripped, curled and bent away from the leapfrogging Bosnian goalkeeper Nikola Vasilj, and nestled in the net. He had to get it up and over the wall, then make the ball drop and then swerve away from the goalkeeper. The Santa Clara Stadium in California breathed again.

Tillman is a free-kick tragic, mining footage of dead-ball virtuosos like Juninho, David



Beckham and Andrea Pirlo, studying their technique and practising it during training. A coach told him about the legendary Brazilian free-kick artist Zico's practice of hanging a shirt in each top corner and challenging himself to take one of them down from 20 yards. Tillman meticulously instilled the method, and froze goalkeepers in the Dutch league with his masterfulness.

But for all the practice, he had to possess the nervelessness to execute at a critical juncture on the pitch.

Beckham said he loved the noise around him, Pirlo blanked himself out from the noise; Juninho would communicate with the ball, like it were a conduit.

Tillman's eyes were intense, his face a shrivelled flesh and bones of focus. He knew the mood of the night was at his feet. He wouldn't fail; his country wouldn't, and his close friend Balogun wouldn't be remembered as a fall guy. Balogun, though, is in the awkwardly stratified company of Zinedine Zidane, Ronaldinho and Garrincha, of scoring goals and being sent off in the same game in a World Cup.

Cut boot

The 24-year-old Tillman had to take the free-kick with a set of bloody toes too. His right boot was cut when landing heavily after a challenge. The socks were bloodied and he had to change the boots before he took the free-kick.

After the match he was asked about the curler. As opposed to gloating over his achievement, he calmly said he has to "practice his free kicks a bit more." His assessment of the game: "To be honest, I wasn't satisfied at halftime." It was a blur of edgy passing and cheap possession giveaways.

Scathing self-criticism is a trait former coaches have lauded him for. "He is never satisfied with himself," Mauricio Pochettino said a few days ago.

In his versatility, the manager sensed an opportunity to tweak his formation, though Tillman wasn't entirely convinced initially. From an advanced midfield role, he was pushed back in a box-to-box midfielder profile for better build-up and control. "I just asked [Pochettino] if he really sees me there, and then we had a good chat about this," he said. "And for me now, I think the two games showed that this position suits me really, really well."

Belgium: From a spot of bother to spot-kick victory

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 2

THERE IS a delicious irony in the image that will endure from Belgium's astonishing 3-2 victory over Senegal. Not the controversial penalty in the 120+4th minute. Not even the winning goal that sent Belgium into the World Cup last 16. It is Youri Tielemans embracing Leandro Trossard after heading in the equaliser in the 89th minute, moments after the pair had spent much of the second half arguing over a cross.

Belgium were staring at elimination. Senegal led 2-0, having struck through Habib Diarra in the first half and Ismaila Sarr either side of it. The Golden Generation's final World Cup challenge appeared to be ending in Seattle.

Then, frustration surfaced. In the second half, Tielemans had chosen to whip an early delivery into the box towards Romelu Lukaku instead of recycling possession through midfield. Trossard was furious

at what he saw as the wrong decision. By the cooling break, the disagreement had escalated into a confrontation that teammates, including Lukaku, had to separate.

Belgium seemed to be falling apart in yet another World Cup. But Lukaku gave them hope in the 86th minute with a close-range finish, as late as Belgium had ever trailed by two goals and survived at a World Cup. Then, three minutes later, Trossard drifted down the left and delivered the cross. Tielemans arrived late, as he has done throughout his career, and powered the header beyond the goalkeeper.

The very action they had argued about became Belgium's route back into the game.

Extra time brought one final twist. Deep into the additional period, Tielemans burst into the area and went down under a challenge from Lamine Camara. Senegal protested furiously as the referee consulted VAR. After a lengthy review, the spot-kick was awarded.



Despite arguing with teammate Trossard over passing the ball, Belgium's Tielemans (in pic) scored two goals, including the winner against Senegal. AP

At 120+4 minutes, with the match balanced on a knife-edge, Tielemans calmly slotted the penalty into the corner to complete one of the World Cup's most dramatic comebacks. It was a quintessential

Tielemans performance: understated, intelligent and decisive. That has been the story of his career.

When Belgium's celebrated Golden Generation emerged, the spotlight inevitably fell on Eden Hazard's genius, Kevin De Bruyne's vision, Thibaut Courtois' brilliance and Lukaku's goals.

Hailed as a prodigy

Tielemans, despite being hailed as a prodigy from the age of 16, often felt like the forgotten member of that remarkable group.

He has outlasted almost all of them. Now 29, he represents the bridge between Belgium's fading golden generation and the team trying to build its next chapter.

He debuted for Anderlecht as a teenager, became one of the youngest players ever to play in the Champions League and carried expectations that have crushed many gifted youngsters. Yet, unlike so many wonderkids, he simply kept

evolving.

His journey has not been linear. Monaco threatened to become a dead end before Leicester City revived his career. His thunderbolt in the 2021 FA Cup final secured the club's first major trophy, only for relegation to follow two years later. Again, Tielemans adapted.

At Aston Villa, Unai Emery has transformed him from an attack-minded No.10 into one of Europe's most complete midfield conductors. He presses, dictates tempo, controls transitions and still possesses the knack of arriving in the right place at the right time.

That professionalism has long defined him.

Away from the pitch, Tielemans has never cultivated celebrity. He is known instead for meticulous preparation, studying opponents, obsessing over recovery and embracing the less glamorous aspects of elite football.

Which is why Tuesday night's comeback felt so fitting.



Matt Damon's name on a wall at Harvard Square in Boston.

Hunting Matt Damon's goodwill spots in Boston

A scribble at Harvard Square is just the start point of the film star-inspired tour

SCRAWLED IN block letters on an off-white obscure wall in Harvard Square in Boston is a line: "Matt Damon was here!" Excited passersby stop, howl and snap photographs and selfies from various angles, as though they had discovered a hidden treasure.

Like urban myths, there are various versions. Some claim Damon, who was raised in the locale, himself wrote it. Some, in typical Bostonian wryness, would ask: "Who is Matt Damon?" A photographer turned portrait artist, chimes in: "Well if you ask me, he is here and everywhere. I am not that Hollywood-loving type, but a lot of people ask me about Matt's favourite restaurant or bar, or the cinema," he says.

Damon's mother was a professor at Cambridge, less than a mile away from Harvard.

In 1988, he enrolled at Harvard for an English major and left the institution, just 12 credits short of completing his degree to pursue acting. But before he left, he had scripted the first act of the movie that catapulted him to fame and hoarded academy awards, Good Will Hunting. In a lecture at Harvard in

2013, he recollected it: "I left with this document under my arm—this first 40 pages of a screenplay. He (prof Anthony Kubiak) gave me a straight A and wrote on the script, 'Don't give up on this. Wherever this goes, it's going somewhere. Stick with this.'"

It was not until 1994 that he completed the script, about a shy janitor who is a mathematical genius, with his close friend and actor Ben Affleck, also from Cambridge. Naturally, a lot of the background is Boston and Harvard Square. The elderly shopkeeper Antoine of the Hidden Treasures souvenirs, says curious tourists ask him whether he has seen Damon. "I tell them I have, and it could be true because I have seen thousands of kids here. But I don't remember their names, or faces. After he became famous, I can well say I have seen him. In an interview I noticed that he still retains the Boston accent," he says.

Movie buffs scour the locale for Damon collectibles, a tale, or just stroll along.

They search for the Bow and



Hollywood star Matt Damon.

Arrow Pub in Harvard Square, where Will (Damon) meets Skyler (Minnie Driver). Beside the storefront, he delivers the movie's most famous line to his friend Chuckie (Ben Affleck): Do you like apples? Well, I got her number. How do you like them apples (originally a line borrowed from Jack Nicholson's China Town)? Alas, Antoine says, the pub was shut down a while ago. "It's now Grafton Street, and they have redone the whole place. A lot of tourists come here asking for the Bows, shouting those apple lines," he says.

But the L Street Tavern in the Southie neighbourhood where Will frequented is still preserved. The park bench where Will and his professor Sean Maguire, enacted by Robin Williams, in Boston Public Garden, has a cult following by itself. It soon earned the name, The Goodwill Hunting Bench, too. The day Williams died, in 2014, fans of the movie lit candles and put flowers on it. Movie quotes and messages are inscribed on its side.

Hollywood pilgrims visit the famous cafe Au Bon Pain at Harvard Square too. Says Sarah, manning the cash: "It's kind of a tourist destination, people from every country have come here and asked, 'Is it where Good Will Hunting was shot?' And they are super excited."

Return to Harvard

In 2013, he returned to Harvard to receive the Harvard Artist Medal. At the end of the speech, he said emotionally. "Of all the accolades or movies, when anybody says my name, they say the name of this University, too, and that means a lot to me. I've always tried to live my life in a way that deserved the description of being a Harvard person."



● **ENGLAND'S OFF-FIELD CONDUCTOR**

Coach Tuchel's crucial interventions help England, Kane make comeback

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 2

IT IS always about him. Not his tactics, but his antics. His passport. His nationality. His perceived symbolism.

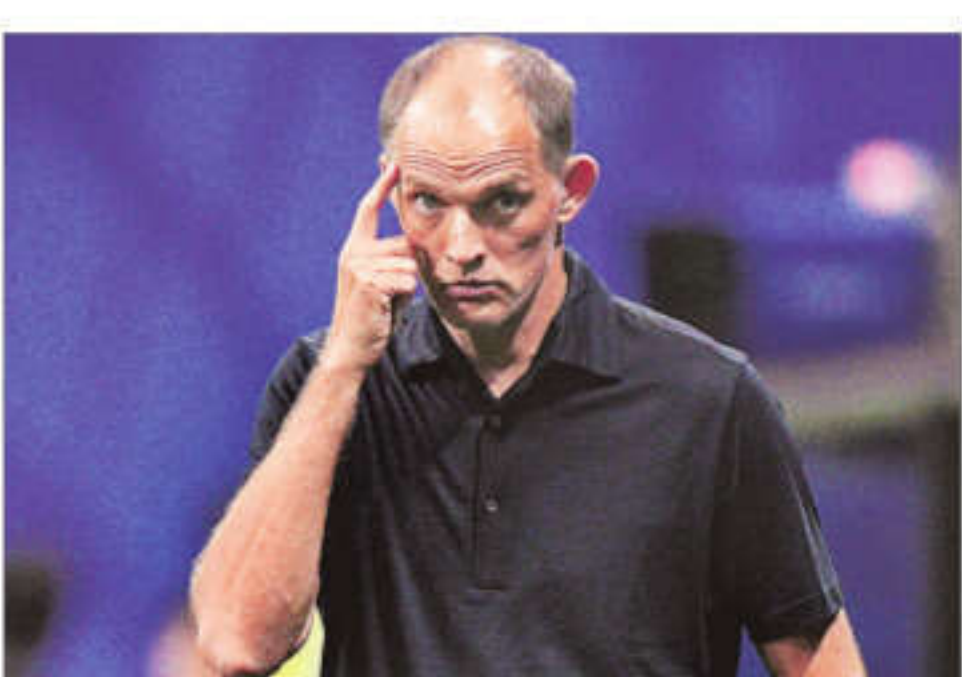
When Dallas Stadium's speakers blasted 'God Save the King,' ahead of England's 2026 FIFA World Cup opener against Croatia, almost every camera swivelled away from the players in one direction — towards manager Thomas Tuchel. The outcome of the match mattered. Whether England's German manager would sing the national anthem mattered more.

And yet, it is never about him. He could have made it so, with a performative speech after England's 2-1 win over DR Congo in the round of 32.

At the post-match press conference after the Congo match, he was informed that the occasion marked England's first World Cup victory by overturning a half-time deficit in six decades. Poetic as it may be, the previous instance was the 1966 final, against West Germany — the place Tuchel calls home. Tuchel attributed the triumph to everything under the sun, but him. His team's determination, the players' commitment, Harry Kane's finishing, and even his assistant Anthony Barry's tactical acumen. He is a self-proclaimed introvert, and it was reflected in the room.

But not on the touchline.

At the second hydration break, England had barely 25 minutes to rescue their World Cup. The turnaround began



Thomas Tuchel's substitutions made an impact against Congo. AP

with tactics. Congo had severed all central passing lines for England by gaining numerical supremacy in midfield. Ngál'ayel Mukau was handed a start with

a specific purpose — to suffocate channels. After the match, coach Sébastien Desabre revealed the plan was designed to neutralise the conductor of Tu-

● **The subs**

60TH MINUTE: Tuchel brings on Bukayo Saka and Anthony Gordon to replace Noni Madueke & Marcus Rashford. The plan — fresh legs against a tiring Congo.

70TH MINUTE: Tuchel brings on Eberechi Eze for Djed Spence, and then shifts Declan Rice to right-back. Plan — Capitalising on Rice's crossing prowess. Arsenal's corner specialist, Rice had attempted 20 crosses prior to the round of 32 match, as against Spence's two.

● **The impact**

75TH MINUTE: An Arsenal triangle of Saka, Eze and Rice combines down the right. Rice's pinpoint cross finds Gordon, whose knockdown is converted by Harry Kane. 1-1.

86TH MINUTE: Gordon is involved again, teeing up Kane to fire home the winner. 2-1. Second assist for the substitute, and with it, a historic win for England — the 1st time they overturned a half-time deficit at a World Cup since the 1966 final.

chel's orchestra. Not Kane. Not Bellingham. Elliot Anderson. No England player had attempted more line breaks in this World Cup than Anderson.

He was the origin of the attacks. With Anderson crowded out, England were funnelled wide, repeatedly relying on crosses. Especially from the right, with

Congo's left-back being a 32-year-old Arthur Masuaku, who had seen better days in this sport.

The change in plans necessitated a change in personnel. Djed Spence, who started in the right-back role in Reece James' absence, had only attempted two crosses in his 122 World Cup minutes. Declan Rice, meanwhile, had already delivered 20 — almost twice as many as any other England player. Rice shifted to right-back, and Spence departed for Eberechi Eze.

One swift move created two advantages. Being Arsenal's corner specialist, Rice's deliveries immediately offered greater quality, while Tuchel also assembled a triangle built on familiarity. Eze, Rice and Bu-

kayo Saka all play for the same club. The familiarity earned England a prized equalizer: Saka to Eze, Eze to Rice, Rice's cross finding Anthony Gordon before the ball eventually reached Kane. When asked about why Rice was shifted to the right, Tuchel said: "To have his quality from the side, and get more difficult crosses in there. That makes it more difficult to defend. We had more connection on the right. That opened up (the game)."

That aside, his timely alteration of wingers also paid dividends. Gordon and Saka injected life after replacing Marcus Rashford and Noni Madueke. The game was not perfect. England are not glamorous. But, they are getting the job done.

